MATH 714: PROBLEMS

YOUR NAME HERE

Abstract. Math 714 is the graduate course on *The Arithmetic Of Elliptic Curves* taught at UMass Amherst. I taught this class in the Fall of 2026. The students read ahead, and we used the lecture time to work on the problems in this document. Each part below is one problem set (corresponding to one meeting), with its summaries, definitions, results and problems. Each problem is preceded by the definitions and results it uses. Write your solution to each item in the Solution block under it.

DRAFT — last edited October 15, 2026

How to use this file.

- Fill in your name above, and compile with pdfLaTeX. Run it twice, so that the references and the table of contents are up to date. The file is self-contained: it needs no other file.
- Write your solutions inside the solution blocks, and keep the problem text.
- Problems are numbered $1, 2, \dots$ through the whole document: cite "Problem n" in a submission, and use `\cref` or `\ref` with labels for your own references. Definitions and results are numbered by section.

An example. A problem is a framed box with a title. Each item of the problem is followed by an empty solution block, as in the example below (it is not part of the problem set: it is printed as it appears in the file).

```
\begin{problem}[A toy problem]
  \label{prob:toy}
  \begin{enumerate}
    \item\label{it:toy-sum} Compute $1 + 2 + \dots + n$.
\begin{solution}
% Write your solution here.
\end{solution}
    \item Use \ref{it:toy-sum} to compute $1 + 2 + \dots + 100$.
\begin{solution}
% Write your solution here.
\end{solution}
  \end{enumerate}
\end{problem}
```

You write between `\begin{solution}` and `\end{solution}`, and these two lines must stay alone on their lines. A finished item looks like this:

```
\begin{solution}
\ans{$n(n+1)/2$.} Add the sum to itself in reverse order. Each of the
$n$ columns adds up to $n + 1$, so twice the sum is $n(n+1)$:
\[
  2\sum_{k=1}^{n} k = n(n+1).
\]
\begin{solremark}
```

Date: October 15, 2026.

```
Gauss is said to have found this as a schoolboy.
\end{solremark}
\end{solution}
```

Here `\ans{...}` states the answer in bold, in one line, before the argument. `\begin{solremark}` sets a side comment apart from the argument. Refer to a problem or to one of its items by label, as in `\Cref{prob:toy}` (which prints "Problem n") or `\ref{it:toy-sum}`, and never type a number by hand. Give your own labels a prefix such as `my:`, so that they do not clash with the labels of the problem sets.

A note on how this was made. The problems were chosen and curated by Santiago Arango-Piñeros. The first draft typesetting and the solutions were written by Claude, and then reviewed by the author. Corrections and recommendations are welcome: send them to

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Part 1. Selmer elliptic curves

The problems below study a single family of plane cubics and use it to reconstruct, by hand, some of the main results of [Sil09, §§III.1–III.4]: Weierstrass equations, the group law, the Riemann–Roch construction of a Weierstrass model, and a first endomorphism. Section 4 is a set of worked `Magma` examples to read and re-run afterwards, with three short variations to try at the end.

Standing notation.

- A field k with $\operatorname{char} k \neq 3$, an algebraic closure $\overline{k}$ of k, and $d \in k^\times$.
- The cubic form $F := X^3 + Y^3 - dZ^3$, the plane cubic $C_d := \{F = 0\} \subset \mathbb{P}^2_k$, and its rational point $O := (1 : -1 : 0)$.
- A primitive cube root of unity $\zeta \in \overline{k}$.
- A Selmer elliptic curve: a pair (C_d, O) of this shape, after [Sel51]. Section 5 explains the name.
- Projective coordinates X, Y, Z, as usual, and lowercase letters for affine coordinates.
- The base change $\overline{C}_d := C_d \times_k \overline{k}$.

1. Warm-up: a plane cubic and a rational point on it

Definition 1.1 (Elliptic curves [Sil09, §III.3])**.** An elliptic curve over k is a pair (E, O) with E a smooth, projective, geometrically irreducible curve of genus one over k and $O \in E(k)$ a fixed rational point.

Problem 1 (It is an elliptic curve)**.**

(1) Check that $O \in C_d(k)$.

SOLUTION.

(2) Compute the three partial derivatives of F and deduce that C_d is smooth, using $\operatorname{char} k \neq 3$ and $d \neq 0$. Where is each hypothesis used?

SOLUTION.

(3) Suppose instead that $\operatorname{char} k = 3$ (only for this problem). Show that over $\overline{k}$ the curve C_d is a *triple line*.[a]

SOLUTION.

(4) Show that a smooth plane curve is geometrically irreducible.[b]

SOLUTION.

(5) Conclude from the degree–genus formula that (C_d, O) is an elliptic curve over k.

SOLUTION.

[a] *Hint:* Frobenius.
[b] *Hint:* Bézout.

The group law in Problem 2(4) is the chord–tangent construction of [Sil09, §III.2].

Proposition 1.2 (The group law and Pic^0 [Sil09, Proposition III.3.4])**.** *The map* $P \mapsto [P - O]$ *identifies the chord–tangent group law on* $C_d(\overline{k})$ *with addition in* $\operatorname{Pic}^0 \overline{C}_d$.

Problem 2 (The base point is an inflection point)**.**

(1) Show that the line $Z = 0$ meets C_d in three *distinct* points of $C_d(\overline{k})$, and write them down. For which k are all three in $C_d(k)$?

SOLUTION.

(2) Compute the tangent line L to C_d at O, and show that $L \cap C_d = 3O$. (So O is an inflection point, or flex.)

SOLUTION.

(3) In a Weierstrass model, which line plays the role of L? What is different here?

SOLUTION.

(4) Let $\oplus$ denote the group law on C_d with identity O, defined by the chord–tangent construction. Using (2), show that for $P, Q, R \in C_d(\overline{k})$,

$$P \oplus Q \oplus R = O \iff P + Q + R \text{ is cut out on } C_d \text{ by a line.}$$

SOLUTION.

2. The group law

Problem 3 (Negation, and 2-torsion)**.**

(1) Show that $\ominus(X_0 : Y_0 : Z_0) = (Y_0 : X_0 : Z_0)$ for every point $(X_0 : Y_0 : Z_0) \in C_d(\overline{k})$. There are two things to check: that the right-hand side lies on C_d, and that it is the third intersection point of C_d with the line through O and $(X_0 : Y_0 : Z_0)$.

SOLUTION.

(2) Deduce that the nontrivial 2-torsion of C_d is cut out by the line $X = Y$, and that $\#C_d[2](\overline{k}) = 4$ when $\operatorname{char} k \neq 2$.

SOLUTION.

(3) Take $k = \mathbb{Q}$. For which d does C_d have a nontrivial rational 2-torsion point? Write it down, and give the smallest positive integer d for which this happens.

SOLUTION.

Part (2) of Problem 4 is its heart. Parts (4) and (5) are then mechanical. If time is short, take (2) on faith and come back to its proof, but do not skip (3): it is what makes (5) painless. The identity of (2) is the polarization of a cubic form. For a diagonal cubic the trilinear form can be written down by hand.

Problem 4 (The trilinear form, and the addition formulas)**.**

For vectors $P = (X_P, Y_P, Z_P)$, Q and R in $\overline{k}^3$, define

$$\langle P, Q, R\rangle \coloneqq X_P X_Q X_R + Y_P Y_Q Y_R - d\, Z_P Z_Q Z_R. \tag{2.1}$$

(1) Check that (2.1) is symmetric in P, Q, R, linear in each argument separately, and satisfies $\langle P, P, P\rangle = F(P)$.

SOLUTION.

(2) Prove the *expansion identity*: for scalars s, t,

$$F(sP + tQ) = s^3\langle P, P, P\rangle + 3s^2 t\,\langle P, P, Q\rangle + 3st^2\,\langle P, Q, Q\rangle + t^3\langle Q, Q, Q\rangle. \tag{2.2}$$

Where do the 3's come from?[a]

SOLUTION.

(3) Prove that $3\langle P, P, Q\rangle = \nabla F(P) \cdot Q$, and deduce that for $P \in C_d(\overline{k})$,

$$\langle P, P, Q\rangle = 0 \iff Q \text{ lies on the tangent line to } C_d \text{ at } P.$$

SOLUTION.

(4) Let $P_1 = (X_1 : Y_1 : Z_1)$ and $P_2 = (X_2 : Y_2 : Z_2)$ be distinct points of $C_d(\overline{k})$, and parametrize the line through them as $sP_1 + tP_2$. Using (2), show that the third intersection point is at $(s : t) = (B : -A)$ where $A = \langle P_1, P_1, P_2\rangle$ and $B = \langle P_1, P_2, P_2\rangle$, and hence that

$$P_1 \oplus P_2 = (BY_1 - AY_2 : BX_1 - AX_2 : BZ_1 - AZ_2). \tag{2.3}$$

Why can A and B not both vanish?

SOLUTION.

(5) Let $P = (X_0 : Y_0 : Z_0) \in C_d(\overline{k})$ and put $Q \coloneqq (Y_0^2 : -X_0^2 : 0)$. Verify that Q lies on the tangent to C_d at P, and use (2) and (3) to derive

$$[2]P = \big(-Y_0(2X_0^3 + Y_0^3) : X_0(X_0^3 + 2Y_0^3) : Z_0(X_0^3 - Y_0^3)\big). \tag{2.4}$$

SOLUTION.

(6) Check (2.4) against Problem 3: what does it give on the line $X = Y$? (The line $X = 0$ is taken up in Problem 6.)

SOLUTION.

(7) Where does the whole method break down if $\operatorname{char} k = 3$? Compare your answer with Problem 1(3).

SOLUTION.

[a] *Hint:* expand $\langle sP + tQ, sP + tQ, sP + tQ\rangle$ by trilinearity into eight terms and collect using symmetry.

Problem 5 (Arithmetic on C_7)**.**
Let $d = 7$, so that $P := (2 : -1 : 1) \in C_7(\mathbb{Q})$ because $2^3 + (-1)^3 = 7$.

(1) Compute $[2]P$ using (2.4), and simplify. Verify your answer by exhibiting an identity between cubes of integers.

SOLUTION.

(2) Compute $[3]P$ using (2.3) applied to P and $[2]P$, and verify it the same way.

SOLUTION.

(3) Compute $[4]P$.

SOLUTION.

(4) The three rational points you have found have numerators and denominators of rapidly increasing size. What does this suggest about the order of P in $C_7(\mathbb{Q})$? (You are not asked to prove it.)

SOLUTION.

In Problem 6, parts (1)–(3) are the general theory and (5)–(7) the payoff for our family. If time is short, take (3) on faith and go to (5)–(7). Part (4) is the most satisfying: two completely different counts turn out to agree. Part (1) uses Bézout's theorem [Har77, §I.7].

Proposition 2.1 (The Hessian criterion)**.** *Let $C = V(F) \subset \mathbb{P}^2_{\overline{k}}$ be a smooth plane curve of degree m over a field of characteristic 0 or > 3, and let*

$$H(F) = \det\left(\frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial X_i\, \partial X_j}\right)_{0\leqslant i,j\leqslant 2}.$$

Then a point $P \in C(\overline{k})$ is an inflection point if and only if $H(F)(P) = 0$. This is classical. Characteristic three is taken up in Problem 6(8) below.

Problem 6 (Inflection points and 3-torsion)**.**
(1) Let $C = V(F)$ be as in Proposition 2.1. Show that $H(F)$ is a form of degree $3(m-2)$, so of degree 3 when $m = 3$. Assuming C is a smooth plane cubic, explain why $C \not\subseteq V(H(F))$, and conclude from Bézout's theorem that C has exactly 9 inflection points *counted with multiplicity.*

SOLUTION.

(2) Now forget the Hessian. Let C be a smooth plane cubic over $\overline{k}$ and suppose $O \in C(\overline{k})$ is a flex, so that (C, O) is an elliptic curve with the group law of Problem 2(4). Show that

$$P \text{ is a flex} \iff [3]P = O,$$

so that the set of flexes is exactly $C[3](\overline{k})$.

Solution.

(3) Show that a smooth plane cubic over $\overline{k}$ always *has* a flex, without using the Hessian.[a] Deduce that, with no flex singled out, the set of flexes is a torsor under $\mathrm{Pic}^0(C)[3]$. In particular the number of flexes is $\#C[3](\overline{k})$.

Solution.

(4) Combine (2) and (3) with the structure of $C[3]$ in characteristic $\neq 3$ to conclude that a smooth plane cubic has exactly 9 flexes. What does comparing this with (1) tell you about the intersection $C \cap V(H(F))$?

Solution.

(5) Specialize to C_d. Compute $H(F)$ for $F = X^3 + Y^3 - dZ^3$ and deduce that, as subsets of $C_d(\overline{k})$,

$$C_d[3](\overline{k}) = (C_d \cap \{XYZ = 0\})\,(\overline{k}).$$

Write down all nine flexes.

Solution.

(6) Check (5) against the group law directly: use (2.4) to show that every point $P = (0 : Y_0 : Z_0) \in C_d(\overline{k})$ satisfies $[2]P = \ominus P$.

Solution.

(7) Which of the nine flexes lie in $C_d(k)$? Treat the three lines separately, and say what happens for $k = \mathbb{Q}$.

Solution.

(8) ($\star$) In characteristic three, $\#C[3](\overline{k})$ is 3 or 1 according as C is ordinary or supersingular, so a smooth plane cubic has 3 or 1 flexes. How is that compatible with (1)?

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* for any $P_0 \in C(\overline{k})$ the class $\mathcal{O}_C(1) - 3[P_0]$ has degree 0, and multiplication by 3 is surjective on $\mathrm{Pic}^0 C$.

In Problem 7 you may use the following two results. Part (4) asks what the classification of automorphism groups in [Sil09, §III.10] predicts.

Theorem 2.2 (Morphisms fixing O [Sil09, Theorem III.4.8])**.** *A morphism of elliptic curves taking O to O is a group homomorphism.*

Proposition 2.3 (Endomorphism rings [Sil09, §III.4])**.** *The endomorphism ring of an elliptic curve has no zero divisors.*

Problem 7 (Complex multiplication, $\star$)**.**
Let $\alpha(X : Y : Z) = (X : Y : \zeta Z)$, a map defined over $k(\zeta)$.

(1) Show that α maps C_d to itself and fixes O.

Solution.

(2) Conclude that α is a group homomorphism, hence an automorphism of the elliptic curve (C_d, O) over $k(\zeta)$.

Solution.

(3) Show that $\alpha^2+\alpha+1=0$ in $\mathrm{End}(C_d \times_k k(\zeta))$, the ring of endomorphisms of C_d defined over $k(\zeta)$.[a]

Solution.

(4) Deduce that $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta] \subseteq \mathrm{End}(C_d \times_k k(\zeta))$, so every Selmer curve has complex multiplication. What does the classification of automorphism groups then predict for $j(C_d)$ and for $\#\operatorname{Aut}(C_d)$ and $\#\operatorname{Aut}(C_d \times_k k(\zeta))$?

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* $\alpha^3=1$, and the endomorphism ring of an elliptic curve has no zero divisors.

3. From Riemann–Roch to a Weierstrass equation

This section reproduces, for our family, the proof of [Sil09, Proposition III.3.1]: every elliptic curve is isomorphic to a curve in Weierstrass form.

Problem 8 is the longest problem here. Parts (1)–(3) go quickly once you see that Proposition 3.2 converts "pole order at O" into "multiplicity of O in $h \cap C_d$". Part (5) is a two-line computation with a surprising answer, and (8) is worth coming back to. Weierstrass equations and their coefficients $a_1, \dots, a_6$ are as in [Sil09, §III.1].

Definition 3.1 (Riemann–Roch spaces)**.** For $D \in \operatorname{Div} C_d$,

$$\mathcal{L}(D) = \left\{ f \in k(C_d)^\times : \operatorname{div}(f) \geqslant -D \right\} \cup \{0\}, \qquad \operatorname{div}(f) \in \operatorname{Div} C_d.$$

This is a space of functions defined *over* k.

You may use the following two results without proof.

Proposition 3.2 (Bézout)**.** *For a nonzero linear form h, the scheme-theoretic intersection $h \cap C_d$ is an effective divisor of degree 3 in $\operatorname{Div} C_d$. Over $\overline{k}$ it becomes a sum of three points of $C_d(\overline{k})$ counted with multiplicity. Consequently, since $X+Y$ cuts out $3O$ by Problem 2(2),*

$$\operatorname{div}\left(\frac{h}{X+Y}\right) = (h \cap C_d) - 3O.$$

Proposition 3.3 (Riemann–Roch for genus one [Sil09, §II.5 and proof of Proposition III.3.1])**.** *For every $n \geqslant 1$ we have $\dim_k \mathcal{L}(nO) = n$. Since C_d is geometrically integral, $\mathcal{L}(D) \otimes_k \overline{k} = \mathcal{L}(D_{\overline{k}})$, so the dimension is the same whether computed over k or over $\overline{k}$.*

Problem 8 (The Weierstrass model of C_d)**.**
Consider the rational functions in $k(C_d)$

$$w \coloneqq \frac{Z}{X+Y}, \qquad v \coloneqq \frac{X-Y}{X+Y}.$$

For parts (2)–(6) and (8) assume $\operatorname{char} k \neq 2$. Part (7) replaces v by $X/(X+Y) = (1+v)/2$, which also makes sense in characteristic 2, and reaches a model valid whenever $\operatorname{char} k \neq 3$.

(1) Using Problem 2(1) and Proposition 3.2, compute $\operatorname{div}(w)$. Deduce that w has a pole of order exactly 2 at O and no other pole, so $w \in \mathcal{L}(2O)$. Where are its zeros, and what are they in the language of Problem 6?

Solution.

(2) Show that the line $X - Y = 0$ does not pass through O. Deduce that v has a pole of order exactly 3 at O, so $v \in \mathcal{L}(3O)$. Where are its zeros?

Solution.

(3) Using Proposition 3.3, explain why $\{1, w\}$ is a basis of $\mathcal{L}(2O)$ and $\{1, w, v\}$ is a basis of $\mathcal{L}(3O)$.

Solution.

(4) The seven functions $1, w, v, w^2, wv, w^3, v^2$ all lie in $\mathcal{L}(6O)$. Why must they satisfy a non-trivial linear relation over k? List their pole orders at O. Which two collide, and why does that force the relation to involve both?

Solution.

(5) Find the relation.[a]

Solution.

(6) Let $E_1 \colon y_1^2 = x_1^3 - 432d^2$. Show that the relation of (5) says that there is a morphism $\varphi_1 \colon C_d \to E_1$ with $\varphi_1^* x_1 = 12dw$ and $\varphi_1^* y_1 = 36dv$. Write down φ_1 and its inverse explicitly.

Solution.

(7) Where exactly did you use $\operatorname{char} k \neq 2$? Show that there is instead a morphism φ_2 with $\varphi_2^* x_2 = 3dw$ and $\varphi_2^* y_2 = 9dX/(X + Y)$ to

$$E_2 \colon y_2^2 - 9d\, y_2 = x_2^3 - 27d^2, \tag{3.1}$$

which is a Weierstrass equation valid whenever $\operatorname{char} k \neq 3$. Which of $a_1, \dots, a_6$ are nonzero?

Solution.

(8) ($\star$) The relation in (5) has no w^2, wv, w or v term, although a general Weierstrass equation allows all four. Explain why, using the automorphisms $\sigma = \ominus$ of Problem 3 and α of Problem 7.[b]

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* work on the affine chart $X + Y = 1$, where $X = (1 + v)/2$ and $Y = (1 - v)/2$, and expand $X^3 + Y^3$.
[b] *Hint:* compute $\sigma^* w$, $\sigma^* v$, $\alpha^* w$, $\alpha^* v$. Then use (4) to argue that the relation spans a one-dimensional space, so it is a simultaneous eigenvector.

4. Worked examples in Magma

Most of you have never opened `Magma`, so this section is written as worked examples rather than exercises: read them, then re-run them yourself and change things. Every line of output below is reproduced from `Magma` V2.28-8 [BCP97], with whitespace tidied and one long type name elided. Three short variations to try on your own are collected at the end.

Warning 4.1 (Closed points in `Magma`)**.** A closed point P of C_d is a point of the scheme C_d. Its residue field $k(P)$ is a finite extension of k, and $\deg P := [k(P) : k]$. The closed points of degree one are the rational points, and a closed point P with $k(P)/k$ separable corresponds to an orbit of $\deg P$ points of $C_d(\overline{k})$ under $\operatorname{Gal}(k^{\mathrm{sep}}/k)$. The divisor group $\operatorname{Div} C_d$ is the free abelian group on the closed points [Poo06, §1.9], whereas [Sil09, §II.3] works with points of $C_d(\overline{k})$ and Galois-invariant divisors on $\overline{C}_d$. `Magma` follows the first convention: `Places` returns closed points, `Divisor` builds elements of $\operatorname{Div} C_d$, and `RiemannRochSpace` returns $\mathcal{L}(D)$ as a k-vector space.

Each example continues the previous one. Begin with

```
QQ := Rationals();
P2<X,Y,Z> := ProjectiveSpace(QQ,2);
d := 7;
C := Curve(P2, X^3 + Y^3 - d*Z^3);
O := C![1,-1,0];
```

The notation `P2<X,Y,Z>` names the coordinates so that we can write equations in them, and `C!` coerces a list of three numbers into a rational point of `C`. Typing `O := (1:-1:0);` does not work.

Example 4.2 (Setting up, and a trap)**.** First, Problem 1:

```
IsNonSingular(C);  // true
Genus(C);          // 1
O;                 // (-1 : 1 : 0)
```

The last line is worth a pause. We asked for $(1:-1:0)$ and got $(-1:1:0)$: a point of $\mathbb{P}^2(\mathbb{Q})$ is defined only up to scaling, and Magma normalizes the representative it stores, here by -1.

Now ask for the Weierstrass model. The second return value `mp` is the isomorphism from `C` to `E`.

```
E, mp := EllipticCurve(C, O);
E;
// Elliptic Curve defined by y^2 - 9/49*y = x^3 - 27/2401 over Rational Field
jInvariant(E);                          // 0
E eq EllipticCurve([0,0,0,0,-432*d^2]);   // false
```

That `false` looks alarming, since Problem 8(6) says the answer should be $E_1\colon y_1^2 = x_1^3 - 432d^2$. It is not a contradiction: `eq` compares Weierstrass *coefficients*, and by [Sil09, Proposition III.3.1(b)] a Weierstrass model is unique only up to the changes of variables $x = u^2x' + r$, $y = u^3y' + su^2x' + t$. The right question is whether the curves are isomorphic, and against which model:

```
Eours := EllipticCurve([0,0,-9*d,0,-27*d^2]);
Eours;                          // y^2 - 63*y = x^3 - 1323
bool, iso := IsIsomorphic(Eours, E);
bool;                           // true
IsomorphismData(iso);           // [ 0, 0, 0, 1/7 ]
```

So $r = s = t = 0$ and $u = 1/7 = 1/d$: Magma found exactly the model E_2 of Problem 8(7), with x_2 and y_2 divided by d^2 and d^3. The two maps agree as well,

```
DefiningEquations(mp);   // [ 3/7*Z, 9/49*X, X + Y ]
```

against our $(3dZ : 9dX : X + Y)$, the ratios being d^2 and d^3 exactly as $u = 1/d$ demands. The moral: for elliptic curves, `eq` is almost never the question you mean to ask.

We can even watch this happen for all d at once, by working over the function field $\mathbb{Q}(d)$ instead of over $\mathbb{Q}$:

```
Fd<D> := FunctionField(Rationals());
P2d<Xd,Yd,Zd> := ProjectiveSpace(Fd,2);
Cd := Curve(P2d, Xd^3 + Yd^3 - D*Zd^3);
Ed, mpd := EllipticCurve(Cd, Cd![1,-1,0]);
```

```
Ed;
// Elliptic Curve defined by y^2 - 9/D^2*y = x^3 - 27/D^4
DefiningEquations(mpd);
// [ 3/D*Zd, 9/D^2*Xd, Xd + Yd ]
```

which is (3.1) rescaled by $u = d$, as an identity in d.

Finally, the predictions of Problem 7(4):

```
#AutomorphismGroup(E);                    // 2
K<zeta> := CyclotomicField(3);
#AutomorphismGroup(BaseChange(E,K));      // 6
```

Example 4.3 (The addition formulas, checked)**.** A `Magma` `function` takes arguments and returns a value. Here both are sequences of three coordinates, so that (2.3) and (2.4) can be typed almost verbatim.

```
dbl := function(P)
  x := P[1]; y := P[2]; z := P[3];
  return [-y*(2*x^3+y^3), x*(x^3+2*y^3), z*(x^3-y^3)];
end function;

add := function(P1,P2)
  A := P1[1]^2*P2[1] + P1[2]^2*P2[2] - d*P1[3]^2*P2[3];
  B := P1[1]*P2[1]^2 + P1[2]*P2[2]^2 - d*P1[3]*P2[3]^2;
  return [B*P1[2]-A*P2[2], B*P1[1]-A*P2[1], B*P1[3]-A*P2[3]];
end function;

P := [2,-1,1];
Q := dbl(P);      C!Q;   //  (5/3 : 4/3 : 1)
R := dbl(Q);      C!R;   //  (-1256/183 : 1265/183 : 1)
S := add(P,Q);    C!S;   //  (-17/38 : 73/38 : 1)
```

These are the rational points of Problem 5. Coercing through `C!` normalizes them, which is why $(15 : 12 : 9)$ prints as $(5/3 : 4/3 : 1)$. Now transport everything to E through `mp` and compare with `Magma`'s own group law:

```
EP := mp(C!P);
mp(C!Q) eq 2*EP;          // true
mp(C!S) eq 3*EP;          // true
mp(C!R) eq 4*EP;          // true
```

Three `true`s: formulas derived from nothing but (2.1) and a 3×3 determinant agree with a general-purpose implementation.

Example 4.4 (Riemann–Roch, mechanically)**.** `Magma` can carry out Problem 8 without being told the answer. The generators `x` and `y` of `FunctionField(C)` are the affine coordinates X/Z and Y/Z of C_d (not Weierstrass coordinates), so our two functions are built from those.

```
FF<x,y> := FunctionField(C);   // x = X/Z,  y = Y/Z
w := 1/(x+y);                  // Z/(X+Y)
v := (x-y)/(x+y);              // (X-Y)/(X+Y)
pl0 := Place(0);
```

```
Valuation(w, pl0);              // -2
Valuation(v, pl0);              // -3
```

Those are the pole orders of Problem 8(1), (2). A valuation of -2 is a pole of order 2. As in Warning 4.1, `Place(0)` is the closed point O and `Divisor` builds an element of $\operatorname{Div} C_d$, so everything here happens over $\mathbb{Q}$. Next, Proposition 3.3 itself:

```
D := Divisor(pl0);
for n in [1..6] do print n, Dimension(RiemannRochSpace(n*D)); end for;
// 1 1
// 2 2
// 3 3
// 4 4
// 5 5
// 6 6
```

Now ask for a basis of $\mathcal{L}(2O)$ without suggesting one:

```
V2, m2 := RiemannRochSpace(2*D);
[m2(b) : b in Basis(V2)];       // [ x^2 - y*x + y^2, 1 ]
```

which looks nothing like our w. But $X^3+Y^3=(X+Y)(X^2-XY+Y^2)$, and on C_d the left side is dZ^3, so

$$\frac{X^2-XY+Y^2}{Z^2}=\frac{dZ^3}{Z^2(X+Y)}=d\,\frac{Z}{X+Y}=d\,w,$$

and indeed

```
(x^2 - x*y + y^2) eq d*w;       // true
```

Finally the relation. We list the seven functions of Problem 8(4), express each in a basis of $\mathcal{L}(6O)$ (that is what `@@` does, applying the inverse of the map `mV`), and take the kernel of the resulting matrix.

```
V, mV := RiemannRochSpace(6*D);
fns := [FF!1, w, v, w^2, w*v, w^3, v^2];
[-Valuation(f, pl0) : f in fns];   // [ 0, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 6 ]
M := Matrix([Eltseq(f @@ mV) : f in fns]);
K := Kernel(M);
Dimension(K);                      // 1
Basis(K);                          // [ ( 1  0  0  0  0  -28  3) ]
```

The pole orders are $0,2,3,4,5,6,6$: seven functions, six available orders, the collision at 6 forcing the relation exactly as in Problem 8(4). And the kernel is one-dimensional, spanned by the vector reading

$$1-28w^3+3v^2=0,$$

which is $3v^2+1=4dw^3$ at $d=7$. We got it by hand from a factorization. `Magma` got it from linear algebra in a Riemann–Roch space.

Now try these. Each one is a small edit to Example 4.2 or Example 4.3, and in each case the worksheet already tells you what the answer must be.

(1) Set `d := 2`. Problem 3(3) predicts a rational point of order two. Find it, verify with the group law that it has order two, and compute its image under φ_1 by hand.

Solution.

(2) Set `d := 8`. Problem 6(7) predicts rational 3-torsion. Find the two rational 3-torsion points other than O, use your `dbl` function to check that $[2]P = \ominus P$, and compute $\varphi_1(P)$ by hand.

Solution.

(3) Use `IsIsomorphic` to decide whether $C_1 \simeq C_8$ and whether $C_1 \simeq C_2$ over $\mathbb{Q}$. Pass it the *Weierstrass* models: on the plane curves themselves Magma answers `For genus 0 or 1 curves the basefield must be finite`. Reconcile the answers with the cubic-twist criterion of Section 5.

Solution.

5. Where the name comes from

Selmer [Sel51] studied the general diagonal cubic $aX^3 + bY^3 + cZ^3 = 0$, and produced the standard counterexample to the Hasse principle: the curve $3X^3+4Y^3+5Z^3 = 0$ has real points and $\mathbb{Q}_p$-points for every prime p, but no rational point. Such a curve is a torsor under its Jacobian [Poo17, §5.12], and that Jacobian is a Selmer curve in our sense:

$$\mathrm{Jac}(aX^3 + bY^3 + cZ^3) \simeq \big(y^2 = x^3 - 432(abc)^2\big).$$

Two ways to test this in Magma: the curve $X^3 + 2Y^3 + 3Z^3 = 0$ *does* have the rational point $(1 : 1 : -1)$, so it is its own Jacobian and should be isomorphic to C_6, that is to $y^2 = x^3 - 432 \cdot 6^2$; and for Selmer's own curve one can call `Jacobian(GenusOneModel(3*X^3 + 4*Y^3 + 5*Z^3))` and compare with $y^2 = x^3 - 432 \cdot 60^2$. Both come out `true`.

Finally, by Problem 8(6) together with the classification of twists of $y^2 = x^3 + A$ [Sil09, §X.5], for $\mathrm{char}\, k \neq 2, 3$ the curves C_d and $C_{d'}$ are isomorphic over k exactly when $d/d' \in (k^\times)^3$, so the family is parametrized by $k^\times/(k^\times)^3$. These are the cubic twists of $X^3 + Y^3 = Z^3$, and they are the natural first examples for the descent machinery of [Sil09, §X] and [Poo17, Ch. 8].

Part 2. The Weil pairing, endomorphisms and automorphisms

Section 6 shows that the determinant of the mod N Galois representation is the cyclotomic character. Section 7 exhibits an endomorphism ring that is an order in a definite quaternion algebra, the third case of the classification [Sil09, Theorem III.9.3], on a single curve over $\mathbb{F}_9$. Section 8 computes the automorphism groups of order 12 and 24 in characteristic 3 and 2, the two cases of [Sil09, Theorem III.10.1] in which the group is not cyclic.

Reading. [Sil09, §§III.8–III.10], with [Sil09, Appendix A.1] for the automorphism groups in characteristic 2 and 3. For the quaternion background: [Voi21, Definition 2.2.1] for the algebra $(a, b \mid \mathbb{Q})$, [Voi21, §§3.2–3.3] for the standard involution, the reduced trace and the reduced norm, [Voi21, Main Theorem 5.4.4 and §14.1] for split and definite algebras, and [Voi21, Definitions 10.2.1 and 10.4.1] for orders and maximal orders. Proposition 7.6, Theorem 7.7 and Proposition 7.8 are the results we actually use.

Magma. If you have no local installation, every block below runs in the free online calculator, which caps how long a single job may take.

Standing notation.

- A field k, with an algebraic closure $\overline{k}$ and the separable closure $k^{\mathrm{sep}} \subseteq \overline{k}$.
- Multiplication by m, written $[m]$, and the dual $\hat{\varphi}$ of an isogeny φ.
- The q-power Frobenius endomorphism $\mathsf{F} \in \mathrm{End}(E)$ of a curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Beware that φ_ℓ already means the map induced by φ on $T_\ell(E)$, so the Frobenius *endomorphism* is F and never φ_q.

6. The Weil pairing and the cyclotomic character

Fix $N \geqslant 2$ with $\mathrm{char}\, k \nmid N$, so that $E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \cong (\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})^2$.

Definition 6.1 (The Weil pairing)**.** We write

$$e_N \colon E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \times E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \to \mu_N(k^{\mathrm{sep}})$$

for the Weil pairing.

Definition 6.2 (Galois representations)**.** We write

$$\bar{\rho}_{E,N} \colon \mathrm{Gal}_k \to \mathrm{Aut}\big(E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}})\big) \cong \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})$$

for the mod N Galois representation, the isomorphism depending on a choice of basis, and $\rho_{E,\ell}$ for the ℓ-adic representation on $T_\ell(E)$.

Proposition 6.3 (Properties of the Weil pairing [Sil09, Propositions III.8.1 and III.8.2])**.** *The Weil pairing e_N is*

(1) bilinear;
(2) alternating: $e_N(T,T) = 1$, so $e_N(S,T) = e_N(T,S)^{-1}$;
(3) non-degenerate: if $e_N(S,T) = 1$ for all $S \in E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}})$, then $T = O$;
(4) Galois equivariant: $\sigma\big(e_N(S,T)\big) = e_N(\sigma(S), \sigma(T))$ for $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_k$;
(5) compatible: $e_{NN'}(S,T) = e_N([N']S, T)$;
(6) adjoint for isogenies: $e_N(\varphi S, T) = e_N(S, \hat{\varphi} T)$.

These properties are.

Proposition 6.4 (The determinant of φ_ℓ [Sil09, Proposition III.8.6])**.** *Let $\varphi \in \mathrm{End}(E)$ and let $\ell \neq \mathrm{char}\, k$ be a prime. Then $\det \varphi_\ell = \deg \varphi$.*

Problem 9 (The determinant is the cyclotomic character)**.**

(1) Let $\zeta \in \mu_N(k^{\mathrm{sep}})$ be primitive. Show that for each $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_k$ there is a unique $\chi_N(\sigma) \in \mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z}$ with $\sigma(\zeta) = \zeta^{\chi_N(\sigma)}$, that $\chi_N(\sigma)$ is a unit, and that the resulting map $\chi_N \colon \mathrm{Gal}_k \to (\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})^\times$ is a homomorphism independent of the choice of ζ. This is the mod N cyclotomic character.

Solution.

(2) Let S, T be a basis of $E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}})$ and put $\zeta \coloneqq e_N(S,T)$. Show that ζ is a *primitive* N-th root of unity, using only parts (1)–(3) of Proposition 6.3.

Solution.

(3) Write $\sigma(S) = aS + cT$ and $\sigma(T) = bS + dT$, so that $\bar{\rho}_{E,N}(\sigma) = \left[\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{smallmatrix}\right]$ in the basis S, T. Expand $e_N(\sigma(S), \sigma(T))$ and deduce

$$\det \bar{\rho}_{E,N} = \chi_N.$$

Solution.

(4) Take $k = \mathbb{Q}$. Show that $\det \bar{\rho}_{E,N}$ is surjective for *every* elliptic curve E over $\mathbb{Q}$, that $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_N) \subseteq \mathbb{Q}\big(E[N]\big)$, and that $\det \bar{\rho}_{E,N}(c) = -1$ for c a complex conjugation: the representation is odd.

Solution.

(5) Take $k = \mathbb{F}_q$ with q prime to N. Show that $\det \bar{\rho}_{E,N}(\mathsf{F}) = q$, and check this against the identity $\det \varphi_\ell = \deg \varphi$.

Solution.

(6) Check (5) numerically in `Magma`, taking $N = 3$, $q = 5$ and $E\colon y^2 = x^3 + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_5$.

```
q := 5;  N := 3;
E := EllipticCurve([GF(q) | 0, 1]);      // y^2 = x^3 + 1
#E;                                      // 6
Ek := ChangeRing(E, GF(q^2));
#Ek, AbelianGroup(Ek);                   // 36, Z/6 + Z/6
T3 := [P : P in Points(Ek) | N*P eq Ek!0];
#T3;                                     // 9
S := [P : P in T3 | P ne Ek!0][1];
T := [P : P in T3 | P ne Ek!0 and P ne S and P ne -S][1];
zeta := WeilPairing(S, T, N);  Order(zeta);    // 3: a primitive cube root
Frob := func<P | P eq Ek!0 select Ek!0 else Ek![P[1]^q, P[2]^q]>;
WeilPairing(Frob(S), Frob(T), N) eq zeta^q;    // true
```

Two lines carry the mathematics. That `Order(zeta)` is 3 is (2). That the last line is `true` is $\det \bar{\rho}_{E,3}(\mathsf{F}) = q$, which is (5) on this curve. Note that `Frob` raises both coordinates to the q-th power: that is the q-power Frobenius, an endomorphism because E is defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Now write the matrix of F in the basis S, T and read its determinant off:

```
[ <a, b> : a, b in [0..2] | a*S + b*T eq Frob(S) ];   // [ <1, 0> ]
[ <a, b> : a, b in [0..2] | a*S + b*T eq Frob(T) ];   // [ <0, 2> ]
GF(3)!q;                                             // 2
```

Check that a different choice of basis moves the matrix but not the determinant.

Solution.

Remark 6.5. Part (3) of Problem 9 gives back [Sil09, Corollary III.8.1.1]: if $E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \subseteq E(k)$, then $\bar{\rho}_{E,N}$ is trivial, so χ_N is trivial, so every $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_k$ fixes a primitive N-th root of unity, and $\mu_N(k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \subseteq k$.

A word, for the curious, on the example in Problem 9(6): choosing it was half of that part. We want $q \not\equiv 1 \pmod N$, so that χ_N is *not* trivial and the check has content. By Remark 6.5 that already forces $E[N](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \not\subseteq E(\mathbb{F}_q)$, so the N-torsion becomes rational only over an extension. The curve $E\colon y^2 = x^3 + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_5$ has $\#E(\mathbb{F}_5) = 6$ and $E(\mathbb{F}_{25}) \cong (\mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z})^2$, so all of $E[3](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_5)$ is already rational over the quadratic extension: small enough to list, large enough to have something to say.

7. A quaternionic endomorphism ring

The classification of [Sil09, Theorem III.9.3] puts the endomorphism ring of an elliptic curve in one of three cases: $\mathbb{Z}$, an order in an imaginary quadratic field, or an order in a definite quaternion algebra over $\mathbb{Q}$. The first two are easy to exhibit: a generic curve has endomorphism ring $\mathbb{Z}$, and $y^2 = x^3 + x$ has $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ inside its endomorphism ring. Here is an example of the third, on the smallest curve that has one.

Definition 7.1 (The quaternion algebra D [Voi21, Definition 2.2.1])**.** Let $D := (-1,-3 \mid \mathbb{Q})$, the quaternion algebra with $i^2 = -1$, $j^2 = -3$ and $ij = -ji$. Its reduced discriminant is the product of the primes p at which $D \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_p$ is not split.

Definition 7.2 (Definite quaternion algebras [Voi21, Main Theorem 5.4.4 and §14.1])**.** A quaternion algebra B over $\mathbb{Q}$ is definite when $B \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{R}$ is Hamilton's $\mathbb{H}$ rather than $M_2(\mathbb{R})$, equivalently when its reduced norm is a positive definite quadratic form in the four coordinates. Otherwise B is indefinite.

Definition 7.3 (Orders and the reduced discriminant [Voi21, §15.2])**.** Orders are as in [Voi21, Definition 10.2.1]. The reduced discriminant $\operatorname{discrd}(\mathcal{O})$ of an order $\mathcal{O} \subseteq D$ is the positive integer with $\operatorname{discrd}(\mathcal{O})^2 = \left|\det\left(\operatorname{trd}(\alpha_k\alpha_l)\right)_{k,l}\right|$ for a $\mathbb{Z}$-basis $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_4$ of $\mathcal{O}$.

Proposition 7.4 (The characteristic polynomial of Frobenius [Sil09, §V.2])**.** *Let E be an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$ with F its q-power Frobenius, $a := q+1-\#E(\mathbb{F}_q)$, and $\ell \nmid q$ a prime. Then F satisfies $\mathsf{F}^2 - [a]\mathsf{F} + [q] = 0$ in $\operatorname{End}(E)$: by [Sil09, Proposition III.8.6] the characteristic polynomial of F_ℓ is $T^2 - aT + q$, and every $\varphi \in \operatorname{End}(E)$ satisfies $\varphi^2 - [\operatorname{tr}\varphi_\ell]\varphi + [\deg\varphi] = 0$ in $\operatorname{End}(E)$, not merely on $T_\ell(E)$.*

Corollary 7.5 (Factoring through a separable isogeny [Sil09, Corollary III.4.11])**.** *If $\varphi\colon E_1 \to E_2$ is separable and $\psi\colon E_1 \to E_3$ is an isogeny with $\ker\varphi \subseteq \ker\psi$, then $\psi = \lambda \circ \varphi$ for a unique isogeny $\lambda\colon E_2 \to E_3$.*

Proposition 7.6 (Where D is split [Voi21, Exercise 11.11 and §14.1])**.** *The algebra $D \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_p$ is split for every prime $p \neq 3$, and $D \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_3$ is not. So D is a division algebra, and its reduced discriminant is 3.*

Theorem 7.7 (Maximal orders [Voi21, Theorem 15.5.5])**.** *An order $\mathcal{O} \subseteq D$ is maximal if and only if $\operatorname{discrd}(\mathcal{O}) = 3$.*

Proposition 7.8 (The index and the discriminant [Voi21, §15.2])**.** *If $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}'$ are orders of D, then $\operatorname{discrd}(\mathcal{O}) = [\mathcal{O}' : \mathcal{O}]\operatorname{discrd}(\mathcal{O}')$.*

For the rest of this section

$$E\colon y^2 = x^3 - x \quad \text{over } \mathbb{F}_3,$$

so that the generic E of Proposition 7.4 is this curve, with $q = 3$.

Problem 10 ($\operatorname{End}(E_{\mathbb{F}_9})$ is a maximal order in a quaternion algebra)**.**
Every part below has a hand computation and a check to run in `Magma`. The curve is small enough that $[i]$ and F can be verified on all sixteen points of $E(\mathbb{F}_9)$.

(1) Check that E is an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_3$, list $E(\mathbb{F}_3)$, and deduce that $a = 0$ and that

$$\mathsf{F}^2 = [-3].$$

Record also that every point of $E[2](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_3)$ lies in $E(\mathbb{F}_3)$: this is what makes part (5) work.

```
E3 := EllipticCurve([GF(3) | -1, 0]);    // prints as y^2 = x^3 + 2*x
Points(E3);
#E3;                                     // 4
3 + 1 - #E3;                             // 0        (so a = 0)
jInvariant(E3);                          // 0
```

`Magma` hands you the point count and the j-invariant. The identity $\mathsf{F}^2 = [-3]$ is yours to deduce, from Proposition 7.4. Read $E[2](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_3) \subseteq E(\mathbb{F}_3)$ off the list of rational points — which points of $y^2 = f(x)$ have order 2?

Solution.

(2) Show that x^2+1 is irreducible over $\mathbb{F}_3$, so that $\mathbb{F}_9 = \mathbb{F}_3(i)$ with $i^2 = -1$. Show that

$$[i](x, y) := (-x, iy)$$

defines an endomorphism of $E_{\mathbb{F}_9}$, and that $[i]^2 = [-1]$. Why is a morphism $E \to E$ fixing O automatically a group homomorphism? Mind Warning 7.9 before you start typing.

```
F9 := GF(9);  i := Sqrt(F9!(-1));
i^2, MinimalPolynomial(i);                // 2 ($.1^2 + 1), and 2 = -1
E9 := ChangeRing(E3, F9);  #E9;           // 16
imap := func<P | P eq E9!0 select E9!0 else E9![-P[1], i*P[2]]>;
forall{P : P in Points(E9) | imap(P) in Points(E9)};        // [i] is well defined
forall{<P,Q> : P, Q in Points(E9) | imap(P+Q) eq imap(P)+imap(Q)};  // additive
forall{P : P in Points(E9) | imap(imap(P)) eq -P};          // [i]^2 = [-1]
// all true
```

The second `forall` is additivity, checked on all 16^2 pairs. That is a proof only because the curve is finite, and it is no answer to the question above: additivity is not a coincidence to be confirmed point by point but a consequence of fixing O.

Solution.

(3) Show that $\mathsf{F}[i] = -[i]\mathsf{F}$. Conclude that $\mathrm{End}(E_{\mathbb{F}_9})$ is not commutative, so that $E_{\mathbb{F}_9}$ falls into the third case of the classification.

```
Frob := func<P | P eq E9!0 select E9!0 else E9![P[1]^3, P[2]^3]>;
forall{P : P in Points(E9) | Frob(Frob(P)) eq -3*P};              // Frob^2 = [-3]
forall{P : P in Points(E9) | Frob(imap(P)) eq -imap(Frob(P))};    // Frob[i] = -[i]Frob
// both true
```

The first line verifies the $\mathsf{F}^2 = [-3]$ you deduced in (1) from the characteristic polynomial, which is worth having independently. For the second, do the computation by hand as well: it comes down to a single fact about i^3.

Solution.

(4) Deduce that

$$\mathrm{End}(E_{\mathbb{F}_9}) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Q} \cong D = (-1, -3 \mid \mathbb{Q}).$$

Write down the reduced norm of D and check that D is definite. How does the reduced norm compare with the degree of an endomorphism?

```
D<ii,jj> := QuaternionAlgebra<Rationals() | -1, -3>;
RamifiedPrimes(D), Discriminant(D);      // [ 3 ] 3
IsDefinite(D);                           // true
Trace(jj), Norm(jj);                     // 0 3
```

The two arguments are the squares of the generators, so the algebra `Magma` builds is the D of Definition 7.1. Here `Trace` and `Norm` on a quaternion algebra are the reduced trace and the reduced norm, and the pair they return for `jj` should be recognizable as $(\mathrm{tr}\,\mathsf{F}, \deg \mathsf{F})$. All of this is about D alone. That D is the *whole* of $\mathrm{End}(E_{\mathbb{F}_9}) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ is the one claim here `Magma` cannot be asked, and it needs a rank count.

Solution.

(5) Show that $\frac{1+\mathsf{F}}{2}$ and $\frac{i+i\mathsf{F}}{2}$ lie in $\mathrm{End}(E_{\mathbb{F}_9})$.[a] Then show that

$$\mathcal{O} \coloneqq \mathbb{Z} + \mathbb{Z}i + \mathbb{Z}\frac{1+\mathsf{F}}{2} + \mathbb{Z}\frac{i+i\mathsf{F}}{2}$$

is an order of D, compute $\mathrm{discrd}(\mathcal{O})$, and conclude with Theorem 7.7 that $\mathrm{End}(E_{\mathbb{F}_9}) = \mathcal{O}$ is a maximal order.

```
OO := QuaternionOrder([D!1, ii, jj, ii*jj]);
Discriminant(OO);                          // 12
O  := QuaternionOrder([D!1, ii, (1+jj)/2, (ii+ii*jj)/2]);
Discriminant(O), IsMaximal(O);             // 3 true
```

`QuaternionOrder` takes a $\mathbb{Z}$-basis and `Discriminant` of an order is its reduced discriminant, so the two lists above are the $\mathbb{Z}$-bases of $\mathcal{O}_0$ and $\mathcal{O}$. Do not reach for `Index` to compare the two orders: Magma has no index for quaternion orders, and answers `Runtime error in 'Index': Bad argument types`. Recover $[\mathcal{O} : \mathcal{O}_0]$ from the two discriminants instead, by Proposition 7.8, and check it against the determinant of the change of basis.

The first sentence of this part is where the real work is, and none of the code touches it: $\frac{1+\mathsf{F}}{2}$ is a quotient in a ring with no division, and only the kernel argument puts it in $\mathrm{End}(E_{\mathbb{F}_9})$.

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* use Corollary 7.5 with $\varphi = [2]$.

Warning 7.9 ($\mathbb{F}_9$ does not come with i)**.** `GF(9)` does *not* come with i. Magma's default generator of $\mathbb{F}_9$ is a root of the Conway polynomial $x^2 + 2x + 2$, so writing `F9<i> := GF(9)` gives an i with $i^2 = i + 1$, not $i^2 = -1$, and every check in Problem 10 would silently fail. Construct the square root of -1 explicitly, and confirm it: `MinimalPolynomial` of the element you build must be $x^2 + 1$, and `i^2` must print as 2, which is -1 in $\mathbb{F}_9$.

8. Automorphisms in characteristic 2 and 3

For $\mathrm{char}\, k = 2, 3$ the geometric automorphism group of an elliptic curve may be non-abelian, which is the subject of Problem 11. In the following statements, E is an elliptic curve over k, given by a Weierstrass equation with coefficients a_1, a_2, a_3, a_4, a_6.

Definition 8.1 (Changes of variables)**.** A change of variables preserving a Weierstrass equation is a substitution

$$x = u^2x' + r, \qquad y = u^3y' + u^2sx' + t, \qquad u \in \overline{k}^\times,\ r, s, t \in \overline{k}. \tag{8.1}$$

For such u, r, s, t we write

$$\Psi_{u,r,s,t}(x, y) \coloneqq (u^2x + r,\ u^3y + u^2sx + t).$$

Theorem 8.2 (The automorphism group [Sil09, Theorem III.10.1])**.** *The group* $\mathrm{Aut}(E_{\overline{k}})$ *is finite, of order*

$$\#\,\mathrm{Aut}(E_{\overline{k}}) = \begin{cases} 2 & \text{if } j(E) \neq 0, 1728, \\ 4 & \text{if } j(E) = 1728 \text{ and } \mathrm{char}\, k \neq 2, 3, \\ 6 & \text{if } j(E) = 0 \text{ and } \mathrm{char}\, k \neq 2, 3, \\ 12 & \text{if } j(E) = 0 = 1728 \text{ and } \mathrm{char}\, k = 3, \\ 24 & \text{if } j(E) = 0 = 1728 \text{ and } \mathrm{char}\, k = 2. \end{cases}$$

Corollary 8.3 (The cyclic cases [Sil09, Corollary III.10.2])**.** *If* $\operatorname{char} k \neq 2, 3$*, then* $\operatorname{Aut}(E_{k^{\mathrm{sep}}}) \cong \mu_n(k^{\mathrm{sep}})$ *with* $n = \#\operatorname{Aut}(E_{\overline{k}})$*, via* $[\zeta](x, y) := (\zeta^2 x, \zeta^3 y)$*. In particular, the geometric automorphism group is cyclic in that case.*

Proposition 8.4 (The action on the coefficients [Sil09, Proposition III.3.1(b) and Table 3.1])**.** *Under a change of variables* (8.1) *the coefficients transform by*

$$\begin{aligned} ua_1' &= a_1 + 2s, \\ u^2 a_2' &= a_2 - sa_1 + 3r - s^2, \\ u^3 a_3' &= a_3 + ra_1 + 2t, \\ u^4 a_4' &= a_4 - sa_3 + 2ra_2 - (t + rs)a_1 + 3r^2 - 2st, \\ u^6 a_6' &= a_6 + ra_4 + r^2 a_2 + r^3 - ta_3 - t^2 - rta_1. \end{aligned} \tag{8.2}$$

A substitution (8.1) *carries* E *to the curve with coefficients* a_i'*, so it is a change of coordinates from* E *to itself exactly when* $a_i' = a_i$ *for every* i*, and then* $\Psi_{u,r,s,t}$ *is the automorphism of* E *that it defines. Setting* $a_i' = a_i$ *in* (8.2) *therefore turns those five lines into five equations in the four unknowns* u, r, s, t*, whose solutions are exactly the elements of* $\operatorname{Aut}(E_{\overline{k}})$*.*

The whole point of this section is visible in (8.2): observe the 2's and 3's in the coefficients. The characteristic enters through the terms $2s$, $2t$ and $3r$. Away from 2 and 3 they are invertible multiples of s, t and r, which determines those three and leaves u as the only free parameter: that is why the group is cyclic there. In characteristic 3 the term $3r$ vanishes, in characteristic 2 the terms $2s$ and $2t$ do, and the parameters they no longer pin down are what make the two groups of Problem 11 large, and non-cyclic.

Problem 11 (The two non-cyclic cases)**.**
As in Problem 10, each part pairs a hand computation with a check in `Magma`. Here the machine is best at naming the group, which is the trickiest thing to do by hand.

(1) Let $\operatorname{char} k = 3$. Show that every short Weierstrass equation $y^2 = x^3 + Ax + B$ has $j = 0$, and explain why a curve with $j \neq 0$ in characteristic 3 needs an $a_2 x^2$ term. So the case "$j = 0 = 1728$, $\operatorname{char} k = 3$" of Theorem 8.2 is exactly the short-Weierstrass one. The first claim is a one-line sweep over the whole family:

```
{ jInvariant(EllipticCurve([GF(3) | A, B])) : A, B in GF(3) | A ne 0 };  // { 0 }
jInvariant(EllipticCurve([GF(3) | 0, 1, 0, 0, -1]));   // 1
```

The condition `A ne 0` is what keeps the equation non-singular: work out what $\Delta \neq 0$ becomes for $y^2 = x^3 + Ax + B$ once $27 = 0$, and you will find that B drops out. The set that comes back has one element, which is the first claim. The second line is a curve with an $a_2 x^2$ term, and its j-invariant is not in that set.

Solution.

(2) Let $\operatorname{char} k = 3$ and $E\colon y^2 = x^3 - x$. Using (8.2), show first that $s = t = 0$, and then that (8.1) is an automorphism of E if and only if

$$u^4 = 1 \qquad \text{and} \qquad r^3 - r = 0,$$

i.e. $u \in \mu_4(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_3) \subseteq \mathbb{F}_9^\times$ and $r \in \mathbb{F}_3$. Conclude $\#\operatorname{Aut}(E_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_3}) = 12$, and that all 12 are already defined over $\mathbb{F}_9$. Where did r become free, and what would have forced $r = 0$ if $\operatorname{char} k \neq 3$? Two counts settle both claims at once:

```
E3 := EllipticCurve([GF(3) | -1, 0]);
#AutomorphismGroup(E3), #AutomorphismGroup(ChangeRing(E3, GF(9)));   // 6 12
```

Predict both numbers from your conditions on u and r before running it. Over $\mathbb{F}_3$ the fourth roots of unity are only ± 1, while r already ranges over all of $\mathbb{F}_3$. Over $\mathbb{F}_9$ all four roots of unity appear. The second number being 12, and being reached over $\mathbb{F}_9$ rather than over some larger field, is exactly the claim that all twelve automorphisms are defined there.

Solution.

(3) Write $\varphi_{u,r} \coloneqq \Psi_{u,r,0,0}$, so that $\varphi_{u,r}(x,y) = (u^2x + r, u^3y)$. Compute $\varphi_{u',r'} \circ \varphi_{u,r}$ and deduce

$$\mathrm{Aut}(E_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_3}) \cong \mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z} \rtimes \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z},$$

where $\mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z} = \mathbb{F}_3$ is the group of translations r, where $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z} = \mu_4(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_3)$ is the group of the u, and where u acts on r by $r \mapsto u^2 r$. Since $u^4 = 1$ forces $u^2 = \pm 1$, that action is not faithful: it factors through the squaring map $\mu_4(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_3) \twoheadrightarrow \{\pm 1\} = \mathrm{Aut}(\mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z})$, so ± 1 act trivially and $\pm i$ act by $r \mapsto -r$. Show this group is non-abelian with a *unique* element of order 2, and deduce that it is neither cyclic, nor dihedral, nor A_4: it is the dicyclic group of order 12. Which automorphism is the unique involution? `AutomorphismGroup` returns a polycyclic group and `IdentifyGroup` gives its label in the small-groups database.

```
G3 := AutomorphismGroup(ChangeRing(E3, GF(9)));
IdentifyGroup(G3), GroupName(G3);        // <12, 1>  C3:C4
IsAbelian(G3), IsCyclic(G3);             // false false
{* Order(g) : g in G3 *};                // {* 1, 2, 3^^2, 4^^6, 6^^2 *}
```

The last line is the multiset of element orders. Say how it rules out the dihedral group and A_4 — how many involutions does each of those have? — and match its single element of order 2 against the automorphism you named.

Solution.

(4) Let $\mathrm{char}\, k = 2$ and $E\colon y^2 + y = x^3$. Using (8.2), show that $a_1' = a_1$ automatically, that $a_2' = 0$ forces $r = s^2$, and then that (8.1) is an automorphism if and only if

$$u^3 = 1, \qquad s^4 = s, \qquad t^2 + t = s^6.$$

Deduce that $s \in \mathbb{F}_4$, count the solutions, and conclude $\#\,\mathrm{Aut}(E_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_2}) = 24$, all defined over $\mathbb{F}_4$. The same two counts as in (2):

```
E2 := EllipticCurve([GF(2) | 0, 0, 1, 0, 0]);          // y^2 + y = x^3
#AutomorphismGroup(E2), #AutomorphismGroup(ChangeRing(E2, GF(4)));   // 2 24
```

Predict both first. Over $\mathbb{F}_2$ the three conditions bite hard: $u^3 = 1$ leaves only $u = 1$, and of the values $s \in \mathbb{F}_2$ one of them makes $t^2 + t = s^6$ unsolvable in $\mathbb{F}_2$. The gap between the two numbers here is much wider than in characteristic 3, and that gap is the content of "all defined over $\mathbb{F}_4$".

Solution.

(5) Write $\psi_{s,t} \coloneqq \Psi_{1,s^2,s,t}$ for the automorphisms with $u = 1$, so that $\psi_{s,t}(x, y) = (x + s^2, y + sx + t)$. Show that

$$\psi_{s',t'} \circ \psi_{s,t} = \psi_{s+s',\, t+t'+s's^2}, \qquad \psi_{s,t}^2 = \psi_{0,s^3},$$

and deduce that these 8 automorphisms form a copy of the quaternion group Q_8. For the remaining factor, let $\omega \in \mathbb{F}_4$ be a primitive cube root of unity and $\varphi_\omega \coloneqq \Psi_{\omega,0,0,0}$, which has order 3. Check that conjugation by it is

$$\varphi_\omega \circ \psi_{s,t} \circ \varphi_\omega^{-1} = \psi_{\omega s,\, t},$$

so φ_ω normalizes Q_8, fixes its center $\langle \psi_{0,1} \rangle$, and cycles the three pairs $\pm i, \pm j, \pm k$ — the order-3 automorphism of Q_8. Since $\langle \varphi_\omega \rangle \cap Q_8 = 1$, conclude that

$$\mathrm{Aut}(E_{\overline{\mathbb{F}}_2}) \cong Q_8 \rtimes \mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z} \cong \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_3).$$

As before:

```
G2 := AutomorphismGroup(ChangeRing(E2, GF(4)));
IdentifyGroup(G2), GroupName(G2);        // <24, 3>  SL(2,3)
{* Order(g) : g in G2 *};                 // {* 1, 2, 3^^8, 4^^6, 6^^8 *}
```

Exactly one element of order 2 again. Explain why that alone pins down Q_8 among the groups of order 8, and why it does *not* by itself pin down $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_3)$ among the groups of order 24 — what extra fact did you use?

Solution.

Remark 8.5 (Both groups are unit groups)**.** Automorphisms are the units of the endomorphism ring, $\mathrm{Aut}(E_{\overline{k}}) = \mathrm{End}(E_{\overline{k}})^\times$. In characteristic 2 and 3 the curve with $j = 0$ has $\mathrm{End}(E_{\overline{k}})$ a maximal order in the quaternion algebra over $\mathbb{Q}$ that is not split exactly at p and ∞ [Sil09, Theorem V.3.1], [Voi21, Theorem 42.1.9]. For $p = 3$ that order is the one computed in Problem 10(5), and its unit group is the dicyclic group of order 12 of Problem 11(3). For $p = 2$ it is the Hurwitz order $\mathbb{Z} + \mathbb{Z}i + \mathbb{Z}j + \mathbb{Z}\frac{1+i+j+ij}{2}$ in $(-1, -1 \mid \mathbb{Q})$ [Voi21, §11.1], whose unit group is the binary tetrahedral group of order 24 of Problem 11(5). This explains the shape of Theorem 8.2: when $\mathrm{End}(E_{\overline{k}})$ is commutative it is $\mathbb{Z}$ or an imaginary quadratic order, whose unit groups are the cyclic groups of orders 2, 4 and 6, giving its first three lines, while a non-commutative $\mathrm{End}(E_{\overline{k}})$ is a quaternion order, and its unit group need not be, and here is not, cyclic.

Both counts can be recovered from the orders alone, with no elliptic curve anywhere in the computation:

```
for d in [-1, -3] do
  Dd := QuaternionAlgebra<Rationals() | -1, d>;
  Od := MaximalOrder(Dd);
  print RamifiedPrimes(Dd), #UnitGroup(Od);
end for;
// [ 2 ] 24     <- Hurwitz order, characteristic 2
// [ 3 ] 12     <- the endomorphism ring of Problem 10, characteristic 3
```

So the 24 and the 12 of Theorem 8.2 are the unit counts of the two maximal quaternion orders.

Looking ahead. Curves whose Frobenius has $a = 0$, like the one of section 7, have a name and a theory of their own. They come later in the course, with Hasse's bound and the structure of End over

$\mathbb{F}_q$. In characteristic 0 the third case of the classification never occurs, and $\mathrm{End}(E_{\overline{k}}) \neq \mathbb{Z}$ becomes complex multiplication. The oddness of $\rho_{E,\ell}$ from Problem 9(4) is the first hint of modularity.

Part 3. Differentials, dual isogenies, and the Tate module

Here are three computations by hand, on the invariant differential, the dual isogeny and the Tate module. Each compares the multiplicative group $\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}$ with the elliptic curve

$$E\colon y^2 = x^3 - x, \qquad \omega_E := \frac{\mathrm{d}x}{2y}.$$

Throughout, k is a field with $\mathrm{char}\, k \neq 2$, $\overline{k}$ an algebraic closure and $k^{\mathrm{sep}} \subseteq \overline{k}$ the separable closure. Here $\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}} = \mathbb{P}^1_k \smallsetminus \{0, \infty\}$ has coordinate t and invariant differential $\omega_{\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}} := \mathrm{d}t/t$.

Reading. [Sil09, §§III.4–III.7], and [Sil09, §III.8] for the Weil pairing of Proposition 11.1.

A formula. We use the following duplication formula on E, derived in Problem 12(5): if $x \in k(E)$ is the x-coordinate and $[2]\colon E \to E$ is multiplication by 2, then

$$[2]^* x := x \circ [2] = \frac{(x^2+1)^2}{4(x^3 - x)}. \tag{8.3}$$

9. Invariant differentials

Problem 12 (Poles and pullbacks)**.**

(1) Rewrite $\omega_{\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}}$ in the coordinate $s := 1/t$ near ∞, and compute $\mathrm{div}(\omega_{\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}})$ on $\mathbb{P}^1_k$. Compute $[m]^*\omega_{\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}}$ for $[m](t) = t^m$, $m \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Solution.

(2) Show that $\omega_E = \mathrm{d}y/(3x^2 - 1)$, and that y and $3x^2 - 1$ have no common zero on E. Deduce that ω_E has no zeros or poles on $E \smallsetminus \{O\}$.

Solution.

(3) Using $\mathrm{ord}_O\, x = -2$ and $\mathrm{ord}_O\, y = -3$, show that $\mathrm{ord}_O\, \omega_E = 0$.

Solution.

(4) Compute $[-1]^*\omega_E$ from $[-1](x, y) = (x, -y)$, and compare with $[-1]^*\omega_{\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}}$.

Solution.

(5) We derive (8.3) by hand. Here $x, y \in k(E)$ are functions. For a point $P \in E(\overline{k})$ write $x_P := x(P)$ and $y_P := y(P)$ for its coordinates.

(a) Let $P \in E(\overline{k})$ with $y_P \neq 0$. Show that the tangent line to E at P has slope $\lambda_P = (3x_P^2 - 1)/(2y_P)$, and use that its third point of intersection with E is $-[2]P$ to show that $x([2]P) = \lambda_P^2 - 2x_P$.

Solution.

(b) Let $\lambda := (3x^2 - 1)/(2y) \in k(E)$, so that $\lambda(P) = \lambda_P$. Explain why (5)(a) gives the identity $[2]^* x = \lambda^2 - 2x$ of functions in $k(E)$, and simplify it using $y^2 = x^3 - x$.

Solution.

(6) Solve this part in `Magma`, working in the function field $\mathbb{Q}(E) = \mathbb{Q}(x)[y]/(y^2 - x^3 + x)$. Compute $[2]^*x$ and $[2]^*y$ from the function λ of (5), check (8.3), and show that

$$[2]^*x - e = \frac{g_e(x)^2}{4(x^3 - x)}, \qquad g_0 = x^2 + 1, \quad g_1 = x^2 - 2x - 1, \quad g_{-1} = x^2 + 2x - 1,$$

for $e \in \{0, 1, -1\}$. Show that $[2]^*y = \pm(x^2+1)(x^4-6x^2+1)/(8y^3)$ and $[2]^*\omega_E = \pm 2\omega_E$. Which sign is the correct one?

Solution.

10. Dual isogenies

Consider the elliptic curves

$$E_1 \colon y_1^2 = x_1^3 - x_1, \qquad E_2 \colon y_2^2 = x_2^3 + 4x_2, \qquad E_3 \colon y_3^2 = x_3^3 - 16x_3,$$

so that $E_1 = E$, and write $\omega_i \coloneqq \mathrm{d}x_i/(2y_i)$ for the invariant differential of E_i. Consider the maps

$$\begin{aligned}
\varphi \colon E_1 \to E_2, \quad (x_1, y_1) &\mapsto \left(\frac{x_1^2 - 1}{x_1}, \ \frac{y_1(x_1^2+1)}{x_1^2} \right), \\
\psi \colon E_2 \to E_3, \quad (x_2, y_2) &\mapsto \left(\frac{y_2^2}{x_2^2}, \ \frac{y_2(x_2^2-4)}{x_2^2} \right), \\
\iota \colon E_3 \to E_1, \quad (x_3, y_3) &\mapsto \left(\frac{x_3}{4}, \ \frac{y_3}{8} \right).
\end{aligned}$$

The maps φ and ψ are special cases of [Sil09, Example III.4.5], which treats $y^2 = x^3 + ax^2 + bx$ in general, so they are isogenies. Also ι is an isomorphism. That example computes the kernels and the dual, but not the constants c_α of Definition 10.1: that is part (2) of Problem 13.

Definition 10.1 (The constant c_α)**.** For an isogeny $\alpha \colon E_i \to E_j$, define c_α by $\alpha^*\omega_j = c_\alpha\, \omega_i$.

Problem 13 (A 2-isogeny and its dual)**.**

(1) Check that φ lands on E_2. Show that $\ker\varphi = \{O_1, (0,0)\}$, that $\varphi(\pm 1, 0) = (0,0)$, and that $\deg\varphi = 2$.[a]

Solution.

(2) Compute c_φ.

Solution.

(3) Check that ψ lands on E_3 and that ι lands on E_1, and compute c_ψ and c_ι.

Solution.

(4) Show that $(\iota \circ \psi \circ \varphi)^* x_1 = [2]^* x_1$, so that $\iota \circ \psi \circ \varphi = \pm[2]$. Use (2) and (3) to decide the sign, and conclude that $\hat\varphi = \iota \circ \psi$, that $c_\varphi c_{\hat\varphi} = \deg\varphi$, and that $\ker\hat\varphi = \varphi(E_1[2](\overline{k}))$.

Solution.

(5) Is there an isogeny $\mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m} \to \mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m}$ of degree 2? If so, does it have a dual?

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* write y_1 in terms of $\varphi^* y_2$ and x_1, and find a quadratic equation for x_1 over $\varphi^* k(E_2)$.

11. The Tate module

We first describe the Tate module of $\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}$, the familiar case, and then repeat each step for E. What links the two is the Weil pairing, which you may use without proof.

Proposition 11.1 (The Weil pairing [Sil09, Proposition III.8.1])**.** *Let $m \geqslant 1$ with $\operatorname{char} k \nmid m$. There is a pairing*

$$e_m \colon E[m](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \times E[m](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \to \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}})$$

that is bilinear, alternating ($e_m(P,P) = 1$), non-degenerate, and Galois equivariant: $\sigma\big(e_m(P,Q)\big) = e_m(\sigma(P), \sigma(Q))$ for every $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_k$. Here $E[m](k^{\mathrm{sep}}) = E[m](\overline{k})$, since $\operatorname{char} k \nmid m$. It follows that if (P,Q) is a basis of $E[m](k^{\mathrm{sep}})$ over $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$, then $e_m(P,Q)$ is a primitive m-th root of unity, and if σ acts on this basis by the matrix $A \in \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z})$, then $\sigma\big(e_m(P,Q)\big) = e_m(P,Q)^{\det A}$.

Problem 14 (The 2-power torsion of $y^2 = x^3 - x$)**.**
Regard E as a curve over $\mathbb{Q}$, fix $\overline{\mathbb{Q}} \subset \mathbb{C}$, and recall that $E[m](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ is the kernel of $[m]$ on $E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$. Let σ be complex conjugation, acting on $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ and on $E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ coordinatewise.

(1) Recall that $T_2(\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}) \coloneqq \varprojlim_n \mu_{2^n}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$, with transition maps $\zeta \mapsto \zeta^2$. Find a $\mathbb{Z}_2$-basis of $T_2(\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}})$, and write down its first three terms. How does σ act on $\mu_4(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$, and on $T_2(\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}})$?

Solution.

(2) List $E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$. Using Problem 12(6), find the x-coordinates of all $P \in E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ with $[2]P \in E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \smallsetminus \{O\}$, and conclude that $\#E[4](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) = 16$.

Solution.

(3) Show that $P_2 \coloneqq (i, 1-i)$ and $Q_2 \coloneqq (1+\sqrt{2}, 2+\sqrt{2})$ are points of $E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$, with $[2]P_2 = (0,0)$ and $[2]Q_2 = (1,0)$. Show that (P_2, Q_2) is a basis of $E[4](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ over $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$, and that $E[4](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \subseteq E(\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_8))$. Compare with $\mu_8(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ and Proposition 11.1.

Solution.

(4) Show that σ restricts to a group automorphism of $E[4](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$. Compute $P_2 + (1,0)$, and write $\sigma(P_2)$ and $\sigma(Q_2)$ in the basis (P_2, Q_2). Compare the determinant of the resulting matrix in $\mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z})$ with the action of σ on $\mu_4(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ found in (1), and explain the agreement using Proposition 11.1.

Solution.

(5) Let $(P_n)_n$ and $(Q_n)_n$ be compatible sequences, $[2]P_{n+1} = P_n$ and $[2]Q_{n+1} = Q_n$, starting with $P_1 = (0,0)$, $Q_1 = (1,0)$ and P_2, Q_2 as above. Explain why they form a $\mathbb{Z}_2$-basis of $T_2(E)$, and compare with (1).

Solution.

12. Magma examples

Example 12.1 (The isogenies of Problem 13)**.** We check in the function field of E_1 that φ and ψ land where they should, that $\iota \circ \psi \circ \varphi = [2]$, and compare with Magma's own 2-isogeny.

```
E := EllipticCurve([-1,0]);                    // y^2 = x^3 - x
Kx<x> := FunctionField(Rationals());
R<t> := PolynomialRing(Kx);
F<y> := ext<Kx | t^2 - (x^3 - x)>;                          // x = x_1, y = y_1
x2 := F!((x^2 - 1)/x);  y2 := y*(x^2 + 1)/x^2;              // phi^*x_2, phi^*y_2
```

```
y2^2 eq x2^3 + 4*x2;                                        // true
x3 := y2^2/x2^2;  y3 := y2*(x2^2 - 4)/x2^2;                 // (psi o phi)^*x_3, ^*y_3
y3^2 eq x3^3 - 16*x3;                                       // true
lam := (3*x^2 - 1)/(2*y);  xd := lam^2 - 2*x;  yd := -(y + lam*(xd - x));
x3/4 eq xd and y3/8 eq yd;                                  // true: [2]
phi := TwoIsogeny(E![0,0]);
aInvariants(Codomain(phi));                                 // [ 0, 0, 0, 4, 0 ]
phi(E![1,0]);                                               // (0 : 0 : 1)
DualIsogeny(phi);
// ... taking (x : y : 1) to ((1/4*x^2 + 1) / x : (1/8*x^2*y - 1/2*y) / x^2 : 1)
```

Magma's dual is $\iota \circ \psi$ written out in the coordinates x_2, y_2 of E_2: $\big((x_2^2+4)/(4x_2),\ y_2(x_2^2-4)/(8x_2^2)\big)$.

Example 12.2 (Division polynomials and $E[4](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$)**.** For $m \geqslant 2$, `DivisionPolynomial(E,m)` vanishes exactly at the x-coordinates of $E[m](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \smallsetminus \{O\}$. Its degree is $(m^2-1)/2$ for odd m and $(m^2+2)/2$ for even m, and its factors for $m = 4$ are x, $x \pm 1$ and the g_e of Problem 12(6).

```
[ Degree(DivisionPolynomial(E,m)) : m in [2..8] ];
// [ 3, 4, 9, 12, 19, 24, 33 ]
Factorization(DivisionPolynomial(E,4));
// x - 1, x, x + 1, x^2 - 2*x - 1, x^2 + 1, x^2 + 2*x - 1
Q8<z> := CyclotomicField(8);  i := z^2;  s := z + z^7;  // s^2 = 2
E8 := BaseChange(E, Q8);
P2 := E8![i, 1-i];  Q2 := E8![1+s, 2+s];
2*P2, 2*Q2;                          // (0 : 0 : 1) (1 : 0 : 1)
#DivisionPoints(E8!0, 4);            // 16
E8![-i, 1+i] eq 3*P2 + 2*Q2;         // true: complex conjugation
```

Example 12.3 (Characteristic p)**.** Reducing modulo p, the p-division polynomial collapses, because $\#E[p](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p) \in \{1, p\}$.

```
for p in [3,5,7,13] do
  Ep  := ChangeRing(E, GF(p));
  psi := DivisionPolynomial(Ep, p);
  print p, IsSupersingular(Ep), Degree(psi), Factorization(psi);
end for;
//  3 true   0  []
//  5 false 10  [ <x^2 + 2, 5> ]
//  7 true   0  []
// 13 false 78  [ <x^6 + 11*x^4 + 5*x^2 + 11, 13> ]
```

For $p = 3, 7$ the curve is supersingular and $E[p](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p) = 0$. In general, $y^2 = x^3 - x$ is supersingular exactly when $p \equiv 3 \pmod 4$. For $p = 5, 13$ the division polynomial is the p-th power of a polynomial of degree $(p-1)/2$, whose roots are the x-coordinates of the $p-1$ non-zero points of $E[p](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p) \cong \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$. The exponent p is the inseparable degree of $[p]$. The same computation for $\mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}$ is $t^p - 1 = (t-1)^p$.

Looking ahead. The Weil pairing of Proposition 11.1 also gives $\det \varphi_\ell = \deg \varphi$ for the map φ_ℓ induced by an isogeny on Tate modules ([Sil09, Proposition III.8.6]). Formal groups make c_φ an honest derivative. And Frobenius factors $[p]$ in characteristic p.

Part 4. The zeta function of an elliptic curve

Section 13 defines the zeta function of a curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$ as a generating function for its numbers of rational points, and shows that it is also an Euler product over the closed points of the curve. Section 14 computes the zeta function of an elliptic curve E from the action of Frobenius on the Tate module, proves the Riemann hypothesis for it, and deduces Hasse's bound $|\#E(\mathbb{F}_q) - q - 1| \leqslant 2\sqrt{q}$. Section 15 shows that the zeta function, equivalently the single number $\#E(\mathbb{F}_q)$, is a complete isogeny invariant.

Reading. [Sil09, §V.2], with [Sil09, §§III.7–III.8] for the Tate module, and [Poo06, §§2.2.1 and 3.4–3.5] for closed points and the Euler product. Three of the problems are exercises from [Sil09, Chapter V]: Problem 16 is Exercise 5.3, Problem 19 is Exercise 5.13 and Problem 21 is Exercise 5.4.

`Magma`**.** If you have no local installation, every block below runs in the free online calculator.

Standing notation.

- A power $q = p^r$ of a prime p, and the Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q} = \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q/\mathbb{F}_q)$.
- The automorphism $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}$, $t \mapsto t^q$, of $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q$, which generates $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}$ topologically. Its fixed field in $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q$ is $\mathbb{F}_q$, and that of σ^n is $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$.
- In sections 14 and 15, an elliptic curve E over $\mathbb{F}_q$, given by a Weierstrass equation with coefficients in $\mathbb{F}_q$.
- The ring $\mathrm{End}(E)$ of the endomorphisms of E *defined over* $\mathbb{F}_q$.
- The q-power Frobenius endomorphism

$$\mathsf{F}\colon E \to E, \qquad (x, y) \mapsto (x^q, y^q).$$

- The integers

$$a := q + 1 - \#E(\mathbb{F}_q), \qquad a_n := q^n + 1 - \#E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n}) \quad (n \geqslant 1), \qquad a_0 := 2,$$

  so that $a_1 = a$.
- For a prime $\ell \neq p$, the Tate module $T_\ell(E) = \varprojlim_n E[\ell^n](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$, a free $\mathbb{Z}_\ell$-module of rank 2, and the map $\psi_\ell \in \mathrm{End}\big(T_\ell(E)\big)$ induced by $\psi \in \mathrm{End}(E)$.

13. Zeta functions and closed points

Let C be a smooth projective curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$. The zeta function of C (Definition 13.2) packages the numbers of rational points over all the extensions of $\mathbb{F}_q$ into one power series. The exponential in it looks odd: the more obvious series is $\sum_n \#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})T^n$. Problem 15 explains the choice. It is [Poo06, Proposition 3.4.3 and Exercise 3.7]. In [Poo06] the ground field is perfect throughout, as $\mathbb{F}_q$ is.

Definition 13.1 (Closed points [Poo06, Definition 2.2.1])**.** A closed point P of C is an integral subvariety of dimension 0. Its residue field $\mathbb{F}_q(P)$ is a finite extension of $\mathbb{F}_q$, and its degree is $\deg P := [\mathbb{F}_q(P) : \mathbb{F}_q]$.

Definition 13.2 (The zeta function)**.** The zeta function of C is

$$Z(C/\mathbb{F}_q; T) := \exp\Big(\sum_{n \geqslant 1} \#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})\frac{T^n}{n}\Big) \in \mathbb{Q}[[T]],$$

so that $\#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ is the coefficient of T^{n-1} in $\frac{d}{dT}\log Z(C/\mathbb{F}_q; T)$.

Proposition 13.3 (Closed points are Galois orbits [Poo06, Remark 2.2.2])**.** *Sending a point of $C(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$ to its image is a surjection from $C(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$ onto the set of closed points of C, whose fibers are the $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}$-orbits. The orbit over a closed point P has $\deg P$ elements: a point of $C(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$ over P is an $\mathbb{F}_q$-embedding $\mathbb{F}_q(P) \hookrightarrow \overline{\mathbb{F}}_q$, and there are $\deg P$ of these.*

Problem 15 (The Euler product)**.**
For $d \geqslant 1$, let N_d be the number of closed points of C of degree d.

(1) Show that a point of $C(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$ lies in $C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ if and only if σ^n fixes it. Deduce that a $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}$-orbit of size d is contained in $C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ if $d \mid n$, and is disjoint from it otherwise.

Solution.

(2) Show that N_d is finite, and that

$$\#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n}) = \sum_{d|n} dN_d \qquad \text{for every } n \geqslant 1.$$

Solution.

(3) Deduce the identity of formal power series

$$Z(C/\mathbb{F}_q; T) = \prod_P \big(1 - T^{\deg P}\big)^{-1} = \prod_{d \geqslant 1} (1 - T^d)^{-N_d},$$

the first product running over the closed points P of C. Why is the product well defined? Conclude that $Z(C/\mathbb{F}_q; T) \in 1 + T\mathbb{Z}[[T]]$, which is not obvious from the exponential.

Solution.

(4) Invert (2): show that $N_d = \frac{1}{d} \sum_{e|d} \mu(d/e)\, \#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^e})$, where μ is the Möbius function. So the numbers of rational points over the extensions of $\mathbb{F}_q$ and the numbers of closed points of each degree determine each other.

Solution.

(5) Take $C = \mathbb{P}^1$. Show that $Z(\mathbb{P}^1/\mathbb{F}_q; T) = 1/\big((1-T)(1-qT)\big)$. The closed points of $\mathbb{P}^1$ are the point at infinity, of degree 1, and the closed points of $\mathbb{A}^1$, which are the monic irreducible polynomials $f \in \mathbb{F}_q[t]$, with $\deg P = \deg f$. Deduce that the number of monic irreducible polynomials of degree d over $\mathbb{F}_q$ is $\frac{1}{d} \sum_{e|d} \mu(d/e) q^e$. How many are there of degree 2 over $\mathbb{F}_2$, and which are they?

Solution.

(6) Put $\zeta_C(s) \coloneqq Z(C/\mathbb{F}_q; q^{-s})$ and $NP \coloneqq \#\mathbb{F}_q(P)$. Show that $\zeta_C(s) = \prod_P \big(1 - NP^{-s}\big)^{-1}$, and compare with the Euler product $\zeta(s) = \prod_p (1 - p^{-s})^{-1}$ of the Riemann zeta function.

Solution.

Remark 13.4 (The Weil conjectures for curves)**.** Let C be a smooth projective curve of genus g over $\mathbb{F}_q$. The Weil conjectures (proved for curves by Weil) say:

(1) (Rationality) $Z(C/\mathbb{F}_q; T) = P(T)/\big((1-T)(1-qT)\big)$ with $P \in \mathbb{Z}[T]$ of degree $2g$ and $P(0) = 1$.
(2) (Functional equation) $Z\big(C/\mathbb{F}_q; 1/(qT)\big) = q^{1-g} T^{2-2g} Z(C/\mathbb{F}_q; T)$.
(3) (Riemann hypothesis) $P(T) = \prod_{i=1}^{2g} (1 - \alpha_i T)$ with $|\alpha_i| = \sqrt{q}$ for every i.

For $C = \mathbb{P}^1$, of genus 0, Problem 15(5) gives all three with $P = 1$. We prove them for $g = 1$ in section 14.

14. The zeta function of an elliptic curve

Problem 16 is [Sil09, Exercise 5.3].

Problem 16 (Traces and determinants)**.**
Let A be a square matrix over a field K of characteristic 0. We prove, in two ways, that

$$\exp\Big(\sum_{n\geqslant 1}\operatorname{tr}(A^n)\frac{T^n}{n}\Big)=\frac{1}{\det(1-AT)} \qquad \text{in } K[[T]]. \tag{14.1}$$

(1) Let $f,g\in 1+TK[[T]]$. Show that f and g are units of $K[[T]]$, so that their logarithmic derivatives f'/f and g'/g are defined, and that if $f'/f=g'/g$, then $f=g$.[a] Where do you use that K has characteristic 0? Give a counterexample in characteristic p.

Solution.

(2) Show that both sides of (14.1) lie in $1+TK[[T]]$, compute their logarithmic derivatives, and conclude with (1).[b]

Solution.

(3) Give a second proof: triangularize A over an algebraic closure $\bar{K}$ of K, reduce (14.1) to the case of a 1×1 matrix $A=(\lambda)$, and prove that case with (1), applied over $\bar{K}$.

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* compute the derivative of f/g.
[b] *Hint:* for $M(T)$ an invertible matrix over $K[[T]]$, $\frac{d}{dT}\det M(T)=\det M(T)\,\operatorname{tr}\big(M(T)^{-1}M'(T)\big)$.

Problem 17 is the proof of [Sil09, Theorems V.2.3.1 and V.2.4], arranged around Problem 16. In the following results, E is an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$ and $\ell\neq p$ is a prime.

Proposition 14.1 (Frobenius is purely inseparable [Sil09, Proposition II.2.11])**.** *The Frobenius endomorphism* F *is purely inseparable of degree* q*.*

Corollary 14.2 ($1-\mathsf{F}$ is separable [Sil09, Corollary III.5.5])**.** *The endomorphism* $1-\mathsf{F}$ *is separable.*

Theorem 14.3 (Kernels of separable isogenies [Sil09, Theorem III.4.10(c)])**.** *A nonzero separable isogeny* ψ *satisfies* $\#\ker\psi=\deg\psi$*, where* $\ker\psi$ *is taken in* $E(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$*.*

Proposition 14.4 (Determinant and trace on $T_\ell(E)$ [Sil09, Proposition III.8.6])**.** *For* $\psi\in\operatorname{End}(E)$*,* $\det\psi_\ell=\deg\psi$ *and* $\operatorname{tr}\psi_\ell=1+\deg\psi-\deg(1-\psi)$*.*

Theorem 14.5 (Endomorphisms act faithfully on $T_\ell(E)$ [Sil09, Theorem III.7.4])**.** *The map* $\psi\mapsto\psi_\ell$ *is an injective ring homomorphism* $\operatorname{End}(E)\to\operatorname{End}\big(T_\ell(E)\big)$*.*

Problem 17 (The zeta function of E)**.**
(1) Show that $\sigma(Q)=\mathsf{F}(Q)$ for every $Q\in E(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$. Deduce that the closed points of E of degree d are the F-orbits of size d in $E(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$, and that $E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})=\ker(1-\mathsf{F}^n)$.

Solution.

(2) Show that F^n is the q^n-power Frobenius endomorphism of E over $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$, and deduce that

$$\#E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})=\deg(1-\mathsf{F}^n)=\det(1-\mathsf{F}_\ell^n)=1-\operatorname{tr}(\mathsf{F}_\ell^n)+q^n.$$

Where does the argument use that $1-\mathsf{F}^n$ is separable?

Solution.

(3) Taking $n = 1$, show that the characteristic polynomial of F_ℓ is $T^2 - aT + q$. In particular it has integer coefficients and does not depend on ℓ.

SOLUTION.

(4) Use Problem 16 to show that

$$Z(E/\mathbb{F}_q; T) = \frac{\det(1 - \mathsf{F}_\ell T)}{(1-T)(1-qT)} = \frac{1 - aT + qT^2}{(1-T)(1-qT)}.$$

By Problem 15, this is also $\prod_P (1 - T^{\deg P})^{-1}$ over the closed points P of E.

SOLUTION.

(5) Verify the functional equation $Z\big(E/\mathbb{F}_q; 1/(qT)\big) = Z(E/\mathbb{F}_q; T)$ of Remark 13.4.

SOLUTION.

Problem 18 (The Riemann hypothesis and Hasse's bound)**.**
Let $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{C}$ be the roots of $T^2 - aT + q$, so that $1 - aT + qT^2 = (1 - \alpha T)(1 - \beta T)$.

(1) For $r, s \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $s \neq 0$, show that $\det(r/s - \mathsf{F}_\ell) = \deg(r - s\mathsf{F})/s^2 \geqslant 0$. Deduce that $T^2 - aT + q$ is nonnegative on $\mathbb{R}$, and hence that $\beta = \bar{\alpha}$ and $|\alpha| = |\beta| = \sqrt{q}$. This is the Riemann hypothesis of Remark 13.4. With ζ_E as in Problem 15(6), show that every zero of $\zeta_E(s)$ satisfies $\mathrm{Re}(s) = 1/2$, and that $\zeta_E(s) = \zeta_E(1 - s)$.

SOLUTION.

(2) Show that $a_n = \alpha^n + \beta^n$ for every $n \geqslant 0$. Deduce Hasse's bound

$$|\#E(\mathbb{F}_q) - q - 1| \leqslant 2\sqrt{q},$$

and more generally $|a_n| \leqslant 2q^{n/2}$ for every $n \geqslant 1$.

SOLUTION.

(3) Conversely, suppose only that there is a constant c with $|a_n| \leqslant c\, q^{n/2}$ for all $n \geqslant 1$. Show that the power series $\sum_{n \geqslant 1} a_n T^n = \frac{\alpha T}{1 - \alpha T} + \frac{\beta T}{1 - \beta T}$ converges for $|T| < q^{-1/2}$, and deduce that $|\alpha| = |\beta| = \sqrt{q}$. So the Riemann hypothesis is equivalent to a Hasse bound over every extension of $\mathbb{F}_q$, even with a worse constant.

SOLUTION.

Problem 19 is [Sil09, Exercise 5.13].

Problem 19 (A recurrence)**.**

(1) Show that the single number $\#E(\mathbb{F}_q)$ determines $\#E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ for every $n \geqslant 1$.

SOLUTION.

(2) Prove that

$$a_{n+2} = a_1 a_{n+1} - q a_n \qquad \text{for all } n \geqslant 0.$$

(Recall the convention $a_0 = 2$.)

SOLUTION.

(3) Here is the recurrence on $y^2 = x^3 + x + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_{101}$:

```
q := 101;  E := EllipticCurve([GF(q) | 1, 1]);          // y^2 = x^3 + x + 1
a := [TraceOfFrobenius(ChangeRing(E, GF(q^n))) : n in [1..6]];
a;                                  // [ -3, -193, 882, 16847, -139623, -1282678 ]
b := [2, a[1]];
for n in [1..5] do Append(~b, a[1]*b[n+1] - q*b[n]); end for;
b[2..7] eq a;                       // true
```

Here `TraceOfFrobenius(E)` is a. Compute a_2 by hand from $a_1 = -3$. Check Hasse's bound for a_6 over $\mathbb{F}_{101^6}$.

Solution.

Problem 20 (A zeta function by hand)**.**
Let E be the elliptic curve $y^2 + xy = x^3 + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_2$ (its discriminant is 1).

(1) List the rational points of $E(\mathbb{F}_2)$, and find a.

Solution.

(2) Write down $Z(E/\mathbb{F}_2; T)$, and check the Riemann hypothesis for it directly.

Solution.

(3) Use Problem 19 to predict $\#E(\mathbb{F}_4)$ and $\#E(\mathbb{F}_8)$. Check the first by listing the rational points of $E(\mathbb{F}_4)$, where $\mathbb{F}_4 = \{0, 1, \omega, \omega^2\}$ with $\omega^2 = \omega + 1$.[a]

Solution.

(4) Use Problem 15(4) to find the numbers N_1, N_2, N_3 of closed points of E of degree 1, 2 and 3. Deduce that every $\mathbb{F}_8$-rational point of E is $\mathbb{F}_2$-rational. Is $\#E(\mathbb{F}_8)$ close to the edge of the Hasse interval?

Solution.

(5) Check the Euler product of Problem 15(3) against (2) up to the term in T^2.

Solution.

(6) Check, where `Places(E, d)` lists the closed points of degree d:

```
E := EllipticCurve([GF(2) | 1, 0, 0, 0, 1]);            // y^2 + xy = x^3 + 1
[#ChangeRing(E, GF(2^n)) : n in [1..8]];     // [ 4, 8, 4, 16, 44, 56, 116, 288 ]
[#Places(E, d) : d in [1..6]];               // [ 4, 2, 0, 2, 8, 8 ]
ZetaFunction(E);              // (2*$.1^2 + $.1 + 1)/(2*$.1^2 - 3*$.1 + 1)
```

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* for $x \neq 0$, substitute $y = xz$.

15. Isogenous curves

Problem 21 is [Sil09, Exercise 5.4]. Let E_1 and E_2 be elliptic curves over $\mathbb{F}_q$, with q-power Frobenius endomorphisms F_1 and F_2 and traces $a(E_1)$, $a(E_2)$.

Definition 15.1 (Isogenies and Galois-equivariant maps)**.** We write $\mathrm{Hom}(E_1, E_2)$ for the isogenies $E_1 \to E_2$ *defined over* $\mathbb{F}_q$. The Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}$ acts on each Tate module $T_\ell(E_i)$, and we write $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}}\big(T_\ell(E_1), T_\ell(E_2)\big)$ for the $\mathbb{Z}_\ell$-linear maps that commute with this action.

Theorem 15.2 (Tate's isogeny theorem [Sil09, Theorem III.7.7(a)]). *Let $\ell \neq p$ be prime. The natural map*

$$\mathrm{Hom}(E_1, E_2) \otimes \mathbb{Z}_\ell \to \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}}\big(T_\ell(E_1), T_\ell(E_2)\big)$$

is an isomorphism.

Corollary 15.3 (Isogenies form a free module [Sil09, Corollary III.7.5]). *The group* $\mathrm{Hom}(E_1, E_2)$ *is a free $\mathbb{Z}$-module of finite rank, being a subgroup of the free module of.*

Problem 21 (Isogenous curves have the same number of rational points).

(1) Let $\varphi\colon E_1 \to E_2$ be a nonzero isogeny defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Show that $\varphi \circ \mathsf{F}_1 = \mathsf{F}_2 \circ \varphi$, and deduce that $\#E_1(\mathbb{F}_q) = \#E_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$.

Solution.

(2) Deduce that $Z(E_1/\mathbb{F}_q; T) = Z(E_2/\mathbb{F}_q; T)$.

Solution.

For the converse, suppose that $\#E_1(\mathbb{F}_q) = \#E_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$, so that $\mathsf{F}_{1,\ell}$ and $\mathsf{F}_{2,\ell}$ have the same characteristic polynomial $f(T) = T^2 - aT + q$ (Problem 17(3)). Fix a prime $\ell \neq p$ and put $V_i \coloneqq T_\ell(E_i) \otimes \mathbb{Q}_\ell$.

(3) Show that a $\mathbb{Z}_\ell$-linear map $T_\ell(E_1) \to T_\ell(E_2)$ commutes with the action of $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{F}_q}$ if and only if it intertwines $\mathsf{F}_{1,\ell}$ and $\mathsf{F}_{2,\ell}$.

Solution.

(4) Suppose $a^2 \neq 4q$. Show that $\mathsf{F}_{1,\ell}$ is not a scalar, that V_1 has a basis $v, \mathsf{F}_{1,\ell}v$, and that $V_1 \cong \mathbb{Q}_\ell[T]/(f)$ as $\mathbb{Q}_\ell[T]$-modules, with T acting by $\mathsf{F}_{1,\ell}$. Deduce that there is a nonzero $\mathbb{Z}_\ell$-linear map $T_\ell(E_1) \to T_\ell(E_2)$ intertwining the two Frobenius maps.

Solution.

(5) Suppose $a^2 = 4q$. Show that q is a square, that $a/2 \in \mathbb{Z}$, and that $\mathsf{F}_i = [a/2]$ in $\mathrm{End}(E_i)$ for $i = 1, 2$.[a] Deduce that every $\mathbb{Z}_\ell$-linear map $T_\ell(E_1) \to T_\ell(E_2)$ intertwines the two Frobenius maps.

Solution.

(6) Use Theorem 15.2 to conclude that E_1 and E_2 are isogenous over $\mathbb{F}_q$.

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* compute $\deg(\mathsf{F}_i - [a/2])$ with Proposition 14.4.

Remark 15.4. Together with Problem 17(4), Problem 21 says that for elliptic curves E_1, E_2 over $\mathbb{F}_q$ the following are equivalent: E_1 and E_2 are isogenous over $\mathbb{F}_q$; $\#E_1(\mathbb{F}_q) = \#E_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$; $Z(E_1/\mathbb{F}_q; T) = Z(E_2/\mathbb{F}_q; T)$; and E_1 and E_2 have the same number of closed points of each degree (Problem 15(4)).

Looking ahead. By Problem 18(1), $\alpha = \sqrt{q}\, e^{i\theta}$ for a unique $\theta \in [0, \pi]$, and $a = 2\sqrt{q}\cos\theta$. Fix an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}$, reduce it modulo every prime p of good reduction, and let θ_p be the angle of the reduction over $\mathbb{F}_p$. How are the θ_p distributed in $[0, \pi]$ as p varies? That is the Sato–Tate conjecture. The product over the primes of good reduction of the factors $(1 - a_p p^{-s} + p^{1-2s})^{-1}$, the reciprocals of the numerators of the ζ-functions of the reductions, is, up to finitely many factors, the L-function of the curve, the subject of the Birch and Swinnerton-Dyer conjecture.

Part 5. Supersingular curves and the trace of Frobenius

Section 16 proves that an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$ is supersingular if and only if p divides its trace of Frobenius, and works out what this says over $\mathbb{F}_p$, over $\mathbb{F}_2$ and $\mathbb{F}_3$, and over $\mathbb{F}_8$. Section 17 shows that $E(\mathbb{F}_q) \cong \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/mn\mathbb{Z}$ with $m \mid q-1$, and pins down m for a supersingular curve over $\mathbb{F}_p$. Section 18 shows that an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}$ is ordinary modulo infinitely many primes.

Reading. [Sil09, §§V.3–V.4], with [Sil09, §V.2] for the trace of Frobenius, [Sil09, §III.6] for the torsion subgroups and [Sil09, §III.8] for the Weil pairing. The three problems are exercises from [Sil09, Chapter V]: Problem 22 is Exercise 5.10, Problem 23 is Exercise 5.6 and Problem 24 is Exercise 5.11.

`Magma`**.** If you have no local installation, every block below runs in the free online calculator.

Standing notation.

- A power $q = p^e$ of a prime p.
- The p^r-power Frobenius morphism $\mathsf{F}^r \colon C \to C^{(p^r)}$ of a curve C over a field of characteristic p, for $r \geqslant 1$, which raises coordinates to the p^r-th power. For an elliptic curve E, its dual isogeny $\mathsf{V}^r \colon E^{(p^r)} \to E$ is the Verschiebung.
- The q-power Frobenius *endomorphism* of an elliptic curve E over $\mathbb{F}_q$. Since $E^{(q)} = E$, the morphism
$$\mathsf{F}^e \colon E \to E, \qquad (x, y) \mapsto (x^q, y^q),$$
is an endomorphism of E, with dual $\mathsf{V}^e \in \mathrm{End}(E)$. Here $\mathrm{End}(E)$ consists of the endomorphisms defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$.
- The group $E[m](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$ of m-torsion points of E with coordinates in $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q$, for $m \geqslant 1$.
- The supersingular elliptic curves E over $\mathbb{F}_q$: those with $E[p^r](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q) = 0$ for one, equivalently every, $r \geqslant 1$ [Sil09, Theorem V.3.1 and the definition after it]. The others are ordinary. Silverman also says that a supersingular curve has "Hasse invariant 0" and an ordinary one "Hasse invariant 1". That is the phrasing of Exercise 5.11.

16. Supersingularity and the trace of Frobenius

This section is [Sil09, Exercise 5.10]. Part (5) is a little stronger than [Sil09, Exercise 5.10(e)], and part (6) needs the stronger form. By Deuring's theorem [Sil09, Theorem V.3.1], a supersingular curve is one whose Verschiebung is purely inseparable, whose endomorphism ring over $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q$ is an order in a quaternion algebra, and whose formal group has height 2. None of these is easy to read off from a Weierstrass equation. Over a finite field there is a criterion that is: count the rational points.

Definition 16.1 (Trace of Frobenius)**.** Let E be an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$. The trace of Frobenius of E is
$$a \coloneqq q + 1 - \#E(\mathbb{F}_q).$$

Definition 16.2 (Separable degree)**.** For an isogeny ψ, $\deg_s \psi$ denotes its separable degree.

In the following results, E is an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$, with $q = p^e$, and a is its trace of Frobenius.

Proposition 16.3 (Frobenius is purely inseparable [Sil09, Proposition II.2.11])**.** *For $r \geqslant 1$, the Frobenius morphism F^r is purely inseparable of degree p^r.*

Corollary 16.4 (Purely inseparable isogenies [Sil09, Corollary II.2.12])**.** *A purely inseparable isogeny $\psi \colon E \to E'$ of degree p^r factors as $\psi = \lambda \circ \mathsf{F}^r$ with $\lambda \colon E^{(p^r)} \to E'$ an isomorphism.*

Theorem 16.5 (Kernels and separable degree [Sil09, Theorem III.4.10(a)])**.** *A nonzero isogeny ψ satisfies $\#\ker\psi = \deg_s \psi$, the kernel taken on points with coordinates in $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q$.*

Corollary 16.6 (Separability of $[m]+[n]\mathsf{F}^e$ [Sil09, Corollary III.5.5]). *For $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, the endomorphism $[m]+[n]\mathsf{F}^e$ is separable if and only if $p \nmid m$.*

Theorem 16.7 (Dual isogenies [Sil09, Theorem III.6.2(a)]). *Every isogeny ψ satisfies $\hat{\psi}\circ\psi = [\deg\psi]$ and $\psi\circ\hat{\psi} = [\deg\psi]$. So $\mathsf{V}^e \circ \mathsf{F}^e = \mathsf{F}^e \circ \mathsf{V}^e = [q]$.*

Corollary 16.8 (The degree of $[m]$ [Sil09, Corollary III.6.4(a)]). *For $m \in \mathbb{Z}$, the multiplication-by-m map has degree $\deg[m] = m^2$.*

Corollary 16.9 (The p-power torsion [Sil09, Corollary III.6.4(c)]). *Either $E[p^r](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q) = 0$ for every $r \geqslant 1$, or $E[p^r](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q) \cong \mathbb{Z}/p^r\mathbb{Z}$ for every $r \geqslant 1$.*

Theorem 16.10 (The characteristic polynomial of Frobenius [Sil09, Theorem V.2.3.1(b)]). *The Frobenius endomorphism satisfies $(\mathsf{F}^e)^2 - [a]\mathsf{F}^e + [q] = 0$ in $\mathrm{End}(E)$.*

Theorem 16.11 (Hasse's bound [Sil09, Theorem V.1.1]). *The trace of Frobenius satisfies $|a| \leqslant 2\sqrt{q}$.*

Problem 22 (Supersingularity and the trace of Frobenius).
Let E be an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$.
(1) Show that $\mathsf{V}^e = [a] - \mathsf{F}^e$ in $\mathrm{End}(E)$, and deduce that V^e is separable if and only if $p \nmid a$. Show that $\ker \mathsf{V}^e$ has $\#E[q](\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q)$ elements, so that $\deg_s \mathsf{V}^e \in \{1, q\}$. Conclude that

$$E \text{ is supersingular} \iff a \equiv 0 \pmod{p}.$$

Solution.

(2) Suppose $q = p \geqslant 5$. Show that E is supersingular if and only if $\#E(\mathbb{F}_p) = p + 1$. Where is $p \geqslant 5$ used?

Solution.

(3) Every elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_3$ is isomorphic to one given by $y^2 = x^3 + a_2x^2 + a_4x + a_6$. `Magma` lists the isomorphism classes, with $\#E(\mathbb{F}_3)$, a and whether E is supersingular:

```
K := GF(3);  reps := [];
for a2, a4, a6 in K do
  ok, E := IsEllipticCurve([K | 0, a2, 0, a4, a6]);
  if ok and not exists{F : F in reps | IsIsomorphic(E, F)} then
    Append(~reps, E);
  end if;
end for;
#reps;                                                    // 8
for E in reps do
  printf "%o  %o  %o  %o\n", aInvariants(E), #E,
         TraceOfFrobenius(E), IsSupersingular(E);
end for;
// [ 0, 0, 0, 1, 0 ]  4  0  true
// [ 0, 0, 0, 2, 0 ]  4  0  true
// [ 0, 0, 0, 2, 1 ]  7  -3  true
// [ 0, 0, 0, 2, 2 ]  1  3  true
// [ 0, 1, 0, 0, 1 ]  6  -2  false
// [ 0, 1, 0, 0, 2 ]  3  1  false
// [ 0, 2, 0, 0, 1 ]  5  -1  false
// [ 0, 2, 0, 0, 2 ]  2  2  false
```

Which column decides supersingularity, by part (1)? Count the rational points of $y^2 = x^3 - x + 1$ and of $y^2 = x^3 - x - 1$ by hand, and explain why part (2) fails for $p = 3$.

SOLUTION.

(4) The same over $\mathbb{F}_2$, where a Weierstrass equation needs all five coefficients:

```
K := GF(2);  reps := [];
for a1, a2, a3, a4, a6 in K do
  ok, E := IsEllipticCurve([K | a1, a2, a3, a4, a6]);
  if ok and not exists{F : F in reps | IsIsomorphic(E, F)} then
    Append(~reps, E);
  end if;
end for;
#reps;                                                          // 5
for E in reps do
  printf "%o  %o  %o  %o\n", aInvariants(E), #E,
         TraceOfFrobenius(E), IsSupersingular(E);
end for;
// [ 0, 0, 1, 0, 0 ]  3  0  true
// [ 0, 0, 1, 1, 0 ]  5  -2  true
// [ 0, 0, 1, 1, 1 ]  1  2  true
// [ 1, 0, 0, 0, 1 ]  4  -1  false
// [ 1, 0, 1, 0, 1 ]  2  1  false
```

Count the rational points of the three supersingular curves by hand. Which coefficient decides supersingularity over $\mathbb{F}_2$, and what does the analogue of part (2) say for $p = 2$?

SOLUTION.

(5) Suppose $p \mid a$. Use Corollary 16.4 to write $\mathsf{V}^e = \lambda \circ \mathsf{F}^e$ with $\lambda \in \mathrm{Aut}(E)$, deduce that $[a] = ([1] + \lambda) \circ \mathsf{F}^e$, and conclude that $q \mid a^2$. So

$$a \equiv 0 \pmod{p} \iff q \mid a^2 \iff p^{\lceil e/2 \rceil} \mid a.$$

SOLUTION.

(6) Show that no elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_8$ has exactly 7 or exactly 11 rational points. `Magma` collects the values of $\#E(\mathbb{F}_8)$ over all Weierstrass equations, and the corresponding traces:

```
K := GF(8);  counts := {};
for a1, a2, a3, a4, a6 in K do
  ok, E := IsEllipticCurve([a1, a2, a3, a4, a6]);
  if ok then Include(~counts, #E); end if;
end for;
counts;                          // { 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, 10, 12, 13, 14 }
{ 9 - n : n in counts };         // { -5, -4, -3, -1, 0, 1, 3, 4, 5 }
```

Which integers in the Hasse interval are missing, and which traces belong to supersingular curves? Predict both from parts (1) and (5) before you look.

SOLUTION.

Remark 16.12 (The traces of supersingular curves)**.** The identity $a^2 = \deg([1] + \lambda) \cdot q$ of Problem 22(5) says more than $q \mid a^2$. Since $a^2 \leqslant 4q$, the integer $d := \deg([1] + \lambda)$ is at most 4, so a

supersingular curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$ has

$$a^2 \in \{0,\ q,\ 2q,\ 3q,\ 4q\}\,,$$

and only the values with dq a perfect square can occur. Over $\mathbb{F}_8$ these are $a^2 \in \{0, 16\}$, as found above; over $\mathbb{F}_p$ with $p \geqslant 5$ only $a = 0$; over $\mathbb{F}_3$ also $a^2 = 9 = 3q$, and over $\mathbb{F}_2$ also $a^2 = 4 = 2q$, the cases of parts (3) and (4). Which of the five values occur, over which q, is a theorem of Waterhouse. We do not need it.

17. The group structure of $E(\mathbb{F}_q)$

This section is [Sil09, Exercise 5.6].

In the following results, E is an elliptic curve over a field K and $m \geqslant 1$ is an integer with $\operatorname{char} K \nmid m$.

Corollary 17.1 (The m-torsion points [Sil09, Corollary III.6.4(b)])**.** *The group $E[m](\overline{K})$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$.*

Corollary 17.2 (Rational torsion and roots of unity [Sil09, Corollary III.8.1.1])**.** *If every m-torsion point of $E(\overline{K})$ is K-rational, then K contains the m-th roots of unity.*

Problem 23 (The group structure of $E(\mathbb{F}_q)$)**.**
Let E be an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$.

(1) Show that there are integers $m, n \geqslant 1$ with $p \nmid m$ and $E(\mathbb{F}_q) \cong \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/mn\mathbb{Z}$.[a]

Solution.

(2) With m as in part (1), show that $q \equiv 1 \pmod{m}$.

Solution.

(3) Suppose $q = p \geqslant 5$ and E is supersingular. Show that $m = 1$ or $m = 2$, and that $m = 1$ if $p \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$.

Solution.

(4) Both values of m occur when $p \equiv 3 \pmod{4}$. Over $\mathbb{F}_7$ the curves $y^2 = x^3 + x$ and $y^2 = x^3 - x$, both with $j = 1728$, are supersingular. Here `Invariants(AbelianGroup(E))` returns $[m, mn]$, or $[mn]$ when $m = 1$:

```
E1 := EllipticCurve([GF(7) | 1, 0]);  E2 := EllipticCurve([GF(7) | -1, 0]);
IsSupersingular(E1), IsSupersingular(E2);                    // true true
Invariants(AbelianGroup(E1));                                // [ 8 ]
Invariants(AbelianGroup(E2));                                // [ 2, 4 ]
[ j : j in GF(13) | IsSupersingular(EllipticCurveFromjInvariant(j)) ];  // [ 5 ]
E3 := EllipticCurveFromjInvariant(GF(13)!5);  aInvariants(E3);   // [ 1, 0, 0, 7, 2 ]
Invariants(AbelianGroup(E3));                                // [ 14 ]
Invariants(AbelianGroup(QuadraticTwist(E3)));                // [ 14 ]
```

Explain the two values of m over $\mathbb{F}_7$ from the rational points of order 2 of each curve, and the value over $\mathbb{F}_{13}$ from part (3).

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* decompose the finite abelian group $E(\mathbb{F}_q)$ into its ℓ-primary parts, and count the cyclic factors of each with Corollary 17.1 for $\ell \neq p$ and Corollary 16.9 for $\ell = p$.

18. Infinitely many ordinary primes

This section is [Sil09, Exercise 5.11], with "ordinary" for "Hasse invariant 1". Silverman's exercise asks for infinitely many ordinary primes. The curve of part (4) and its supersingular primes are [Sil09, Example V.4.6]. The proof uses results that we have not proved.

Definition 18.1 (Reduction modulo p)**.** Let E be an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}$, given by a Weierstrass equation with coefficients in $\mathbb{Z}$ and discriminant $\Delta \in \mathbb{Z}$. For a prime $p \nmid \Delta$, reducing the coefficients modulo p gives a Weierstrass equation over $\mathbb{F}_p$ with nonzero discriminant, hence an elliptic curve E_p over $\mathbb{F}_p$.

Definition 18.2 (Supersingular and ordinary primes)**.** A prime $p \nmid \Delta$ is supersingular or ordinary for E according as E_p is.

Definition 18.3 (Primes that split completely)**.** Let $L/\mathbb{Q}$ be a finite Galois extension. A prime p splits completely in L if $p\mathcal{O}_L$ is a product of $[L:\mathbb{Q}]$ distinct prime ideals of the ring of integers $\mathcal{O}_L$.

In the following results, E, Δ and E_p are as in Definition 18.1, and $L/\mathbb{Q}$ is a finite Galois extension.

Proposition 18.4 (Reduction modulo p [Sil09, Proposition VII.2.1])**.** *Let $p \nmid \Delta$. Every point of $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ can be written $[X:Y:Z]$ with $X, Y, Z \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ not all divisible by p, and reducing the coordinates modulo p gives a group homomorphism $E(\mathbb{Q}_p) \to E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$.*

Proposition 18.5 (Reduction of torsion [Sil09, Proposition VII.3.1(b)])**.** *Let $p \nmid \Delta$ and let $m \geqslant 1$ with $p \nmid m$. The restriction of the reduction homomorphism $E(\mathbb{Q}_p) \to E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$ to the m-torsion points of $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ is injective.*

Proposition 18.6 (Completions at a completely split prime [Neu99])**.** *Let p be a prime that splits completely in L. For each prime $\mathfrak{p}$ of L above p the completion $L_\mathfrak{p}$ is $\mathbb{Q}_p$, so that L embeds in $\mathbb{Q}_p$.*

Theorem 18.7 (Chebotarev density theorem [Neu99])**.** *Infinitely many primes split completely in L: they have density $1/[L:\mathbb{Q}]$ among all primes.*

Problem 24 (Infinitely many ordinary primes)**.**
Fix a prime $\ell \geqslant 3$, and let $L \coloneqq \mathbb{Q}(E[\ell])$ be the field generated over $\mathbb{Q}$ by the affine coordinates of the nonzero ℓ-torsion points of $E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$.

(1) Show that L is a finite Galois extension of $\mathbb{Q}$, and that L contains the ℓ-th roots of unity.

Solution.

(2) Let $p \nmid \ell\Delta$ be a prime that splits completely in L. Show that $\ell^2 \mid \#E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$ and that $p \equiv 1 \pmod{\ell}$.

Solution.

(3) Show that every prime $p \geqslant 5$ with $p \nmid \ell\Delta$ that splits completely in L is ordinary for E, and conclude. Where did you use $\ell \geqslant 3$?

Solution.

(4) Take the curve $E\colon y^2 + y = x^3 - x^2 - 10x - 20$, of discriminant -11^5, and $\ell = 3$. By part (2), a prime $p \neq 3, 11$ that splits completely in $\mathbb{Q}(E[3])$ has all nine 3-torsion points of $E_p(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p)$ rational. `Magma` lists the supersingular primes below 100 and the primes below 3000 with that property:

```
E := EllipticCurve([0, -1, 1, -10, -20]);          // y^2 + y = x^3 - x^2 - 10x - 20
Discriminant(E);                                    // -161051
```

```
good := [p : p in PrimesUpTo(3000) | p ne 11];
[p : p in good | p lt 100 and IsSupersingular(ChangeRing(E, GF(p)))];
// [ 2, 19, 29 ]
full := function(p, l)       // are all the l-torsion points of E_p rational?
  I := Invariants(AbelianGroup(ChangeRing(E, GF(p))));
  return #I eq 2 and I[1] mod l eq 0;
end function;
split := [p : p in good | p ne 3 and full(p, 3)];  split;
// [ 337, 523, 1087, 2437, 2719, 2749 ]
[p mod 3 : p in split];                                    // [ 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1 ]
[IsSupersingular(ChangeRing(E, GF(p))) : p in split];
// [ false, false, false, false, false, false ]
[p : p in good | p lt 300 and p ne 5 and full(p, 5)];      // and the same for l = 5:
// [ 31, 41, 61, 71, 101, 131, 151, 181, 191, 211, 241, 251, 271, 281 ]
```

Check the output against parts (2) and (3), and compare the list of supersingular primes with the list in the example cited before this problem. The last line runs the same test for $\ell = 5$: which primes below 300 appear, and what does that suggest about the field $\mathbb{Q}(E[5])$? (The rational point $(5, 5)$ of E has order 5.)

Solution.

Remark 18.8 (Supersingular primes)**.** The other direction is much harder. For the curve of Problem 24(4), D. H. Lehmer found exactly 27 odd supersingular primes below 31500 [Sil09, Example V.4.6]. For an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}$ without complex multiplication, the supersingular primes have density 0 (Serre, Elkies), and yet there are infinitely many of them (Elkies) [Sil09, Theorems V.4.7 and V.4.9]. The Lang–Trotter conjecture predicts that about $c\sqrt{x}/\log x$ of them lie below x [Sil09, Conjecture V.4.8]. For a curve with complex multiplication, such as $y^2 = x^3 + x$, the supersingular primes have density 1/2 [Sil09, Examples V.4.4 and V.4.5].

Part 6. Reduction modulo p and a bound on the torsion

The aim is a `Magma` script, written from scratch, that bounds the torsion subgroup of an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}$ using only the local theory of [Sil09, §§VII.1–VII.3]. Section 19 shows that reduction modulo an odd prime of good reduction is injective on the rational torsion points, section 20 turns this into two bounds, and section 21 tests them against the LMFDB. Each problem prints a piece of the script with its output. You prove the mathematics behind it.

Standing notation.

- An elliptic curve E over $\mathbb{Q}$, given by a Weierstrass equation with coefficients $a_1, \dots, a_6 \in \mathbb{Z}$ and discriminant Δ.
- The torsion subgroup $T \coloneqq E(\mathbb{Q})_{\mathrm{tors}}$.
- A prime p is good if $p \nmid \Delta$. Then reducing the equation modulo p gives an elliptic curve E_p over $\mathbb{F}_p$.
- For an abelian group G, $G[m]$ is the subgroup killed by m.
- A finite abelian group G is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/n_1\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/n_2\mathbb{Z}$ for at most one pair of integers $1 \leqslant n_1 \mid n_2$. When it is, we write $n_1(G)$ and $n_2(G)$ for them.

19. Reduction is injective on torsion

Everything in this section is in [Sil09, §§VII.1–VII.3]. The curve of Problem 25 is from Application VII.3.5 there.

In the following definition and results, p is a good prime for E.

Definition 19.1 (Reduction modulo p)**.** We regard $E(\mathbb{Q})$ as a subgroup of $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)$, and write $P \mapsto \bar{P}$ for the reduction map $E(\mathbb{Q}_p) \to E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$ and $E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ for its kernel.

Proposition 19.2 (Minimality [Sil09, Remark VII.1.1])**.** *The equation is minimal at p, because $v_p(\Delta) = 0 < 12$. So E_p is the reduction of E modulo p.*

Proposition 19.3 (Reduction is a homomorphism [Sil09, Proposition VII.2.1 and the discussion after it])**.** *The reduction map $E(\mathbb{Q}_p) \to E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$ is a surjective group homomorphism. Its kernel $E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ consists of O and the $(x, y) \in E(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ with $v_p(x) < 0$.*

Proposition 19.4 (Torsion prime to p [Sil09, Proposition VII.3.1])**.** *If $p \nmid m$, then $E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)[m] = \{O\}$, and the reduction map above restricts to an injection $E(\mathbb{Q}_p)[m] \hookrightarrow E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$.*

Theorem 19.5 (Torsion of p-power order [Sil09, Theorem VII.3.4(b)])**.** *Let $P \in E(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ have exact order p^n with $n \geqslant 1$, and let $r := \lfloor 1/(p^n - p^{n-1}) \rfloor$. Then $p^{2r} x(P) \in \mathbb{Z}_p$. In particular $x(P) \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ unless $p = 2$ and $n = 1$.*

Problem 25 (Injectivity of reduction on torsion)**.**

(1) Let $p \geqslant 3$ be a good prime. Show that the reduction map

$$E(\mathbb{Q}) \hookrightarrow E(\mathbb{Q}_p) \to E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$$

is injective on T. In particular T is finite, and isomorphic to a subgroup of $E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$.[a]

Solution.

(2) The prime 2 is different: even if $p = 2$ is good, $T \to E_2(\mathbb{F}_2)$ need not be injective. Take for instance the curve $E\colon y^2 + xy = x^3 + 4x + 1$:

```
E := EllipticCurve([1, 0, 0, 4, 1]);            // y^2 + xy = x^3 + 4x + 1
Factorization(Integers()!Discriminant(E));      // [ <5, 2>, <13, 2> ]
P := E![-1/4, 1/8];  2*P eq E!0;                // true
```

So 2 is a good prime and $P = (-1/4, 1/8)$ is a rational point of order 2. Show that $\bar{P} = O$ in $E_2(\mathbb{F}_2)$. Which hypothesis of Proposition 19.4 and Theorem 19.5 fails, and what does Proposition 19.4 still give at $p = 2$?

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* a nonzero torsion point in $E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ has a multiple of prime order in $E_1(\mathbb{Q}_p)$.

20. Two bounds

This section is [Sil09, Application VII.3.2], and its three curves are [Sil09, Examples VII.3.3.1–VII.3.3.3].

Problem 26 (The order bound)**.**
The first piece of the script computes the greatest common divisor b of the orders $\#E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$ over the good odd primes $p \leqslant N$:

```
// b = gcd of #E_p(F_p) over the good odd primes p <= N (there must be one)
OrderBound := function(E, N)
  Delta := Integers()!Discriminant(E);
  good := [p : p in PrimesUpTo(N) | p gt 2 and Delta mod p ne 0];
  return GCD([#ChangeRing(E, GF(p)) : p in good]);
end function;
E1 := EllipticCurve([0, 0, 1, -1, 1]);          // y^2 + y = x^3 - x + 1
Discriminant(E1);                               // -611
[#ChangeRing(E1, GF(p)) : p in [3, 5, 7]];      // [ 1, 8, 6 ]
OrderBound(E1, 30);                             // 1
E2 := EllipticCurve([0, 3]);                    // y^2 = x^3 + 3
Discriminant(E2);                               // -3888
[#ChangeRing(E2, GF(p)) : p in [5, 7, 11, 13]]; // [ 6, 13, 12, 9 ]
OrderBound(E2, 30);                             // 1
```

(1) Deduce that both curves have trivial torsion, and that $y^2 = x^3 + 3$ has infinitely many rational points.

Solution.

(2) `OrderBound` skips the primes dividing the discriminant of the equation it is given. Compare two equations for the first curve, with $N = 7$:

```
E4 := EllipticCurve([0, 0, 27, -81, 729]);      // y^2 + 27y = x^3 - 81x + 729
Discriminant(E1), Discriminant(E4);             // -611 -324710451
IsIsomorphic(E1, E4);                           // true
OrderBound(E1, 7), OrderBound(E4, 7);           // 1 2
```

Here $-324710451 = -3^{12} \cdot 611$. Find a change of variables between the two equations. Explain why a non-minimal equation can make the script skip a prime it could have used, but never makes it use one it should not.

Solution.

Corollary 20.1 (The m-torsion [Sil09, Corollary III.6.4])**.** *Let E be an elliptic curve over a field K, and $m \geqslant 1$. If $\operatorname{char} K \nmid m$, then $E[m](\overline{K}) \cong (\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z})^2$. If $\operatorname{char} K = p > 0$, then $E[p^e](\overline{K})$ is cyclic for every $e \geqslant 1$.*

Problem 27 (The structure bound)**.**
The curve $y^2 = x^3 + x$ shows that the orders are not the whole story. `Invariants` returns $[n_1(G), n_2(G)]$ for $G = E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$, omitting $n_1(G)$ when it is 1, and returns $[\,]$ when G is trivial:

```
E3 := EllipticCurve([1, 0]);                    // y^2 = x^3 + x
Discriminant(E3);                               // -64
OrderBound(E3, 30);                             // 4
[Invariants(AbelianGroup(ChangeRing(E3, GF(p)))) : p in [3, 5, 7, 11, 13]];
// [ [ 4 ], [ 2, 2 ], [ 8 ], [ 12 ], [ 2, 10 ] ]
```

(1) Let G be a finite subgroup of $E(\overline{K})$, for an elliptic curve E over a field K. Show that $n_1(G)$ and $n_2(G)$ are defined, and that $n_2(G)$ is the exponent of G. Show that $\#E[n_1(G)](\overline{K}) = n_1(G)^2$, and that an integer $m \geqslant 1$ with $\#E[m](\overline{K}) = m^2$ satisfies $E[m](\overline{K}) \subseteq G$ if and only if $m \mid n_1(G)$. Deduce that $n_1(H) \mid n_1(G)$ and $n_2(H) \mid n_2(G)$ for every subgroup $H \subseteq G$.[a]

Solution.

(2) Let b_1 and b_2 be the greatest common divisors of $n_1(E_p(\mathbb{F}_p))$ and of $n_2(E_p(\mathbb{F}_p))$ over the good odd primes $p \leqslant N$. Show that $n_1(T) \mid b_1$, $n_2(T) \mid b_2$ and $b_1 b_2 \mid b$. This is the second piece of the script:

```
// [b1, b2]: n1(T) | b1 and n2(T) | b2
StructureBound := function(E, N)
  Delta := Integers()!Discriminant(E);
  good := [p : p in PrimesUpTo(N) | p gt 2 and Delta mod p ne 0];
  b1 := 0;  b2 := 0;
  for p in good do
    I := Invariants(AbelianGroup(ChangeRing(E, GF(p))));
    b1 := GCD(b1, #I eq 2 select I[1] else 1);
    b2 := GCD(b2, #I eq 0 select 1 else I[#I]);
  end for;
  return [b1, b2];
end function;
StructureBound(E3, 30);                          // [ 1, 2 ]
P := E3![0, 0];  2*P eq E3!0;                    // true
```

Conclude that $T = \{O, (0,0)\} \cong \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ for $y^2 = x^3 + x$. Why does b stay at 4 however large N is?

Solution.

(3) Show that a rational point P is a torsion point if and only if $b_2 P = O$, and that rational torsion points generating a subgroup of order $b_1 b_2$ generate T.

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* for a prime ℓ, the group $G[\ell]$ lies in $E[\ell](\overline{K})$. Use Corollary 20.1.

21. How good are the bounds? The LMFDB

The L-functions and modular forms database [LMF25] lists millions of elliptic curves over $\mathbb{Q}$ with their torsion subgroups, computed by methods beyond [Sil09, Chapter VII]. We use it as the answer key.

Proposition 21.1 (Reduction of isogenies [Mil20, proof of Theorem V.4.1])**.** *An isogeny over $\mathbb{Q}$ reduces to an isogeny over $\mathbb{F}_p$ at every good prime p of both equations.*

Proposition 21.2 (Isogenous curves over $\mathbb{F}_p$ [Sil09, Exercise 5.4(a)])**.** *Isogenous curves over $\mathbb{F}_p$ have the same number of rational points.*

Problem 28 (Testing the bounds)**.**

(1) Here are the curves of smallest conductor with each torsion structure that occurs over $\mathbb{Q}$, with their LMFDB labels, a-invariants and torsion structures ([1] for the trivial group):

```
curves := [<"11.a1", [0, -1, 1, -7820, -263580], [1]>,
  <"14.a2", [1, 0, 1, -171, -874], [2]>,
  <"19.a2", [0, 1, 1, -9, -15], [3]>, <"15.a4", [1, 1, 1, -80, 242], [4]>,
  <"11.a2", [0, -1, 1, -10, -20], [5]>, <"14.a6", [1, 0, 1, 4, -6], [6]>,
  <"26.b2", [1, -1, 1, -3, 3], [7]>, <"15.a8", [1, 1, 1, 35, -28], [8]>,
  <"54.b2", [1, -1, 1, -14, 29], [9]>, <"66.c3", [1, 0, 0, -45, 81], [10]>,
  <"90.c7", [1, -1, 1, -122, 1721], [12]>, <"15.a2", [1, 1, 1, -135, -660], [2, 2]>,
  <"15.a5", [1, 1, 1, -10, -10], [2, 4]>, <"30.a6", [1, 0, 1, -19, 26], [2, 6]>,
  <"210.e6", [1, 0, 0, -1070, 7812], [2, 8]>];
for c in curves do
  E := EllipticCurve(c[2]);
  printf "%-7o LMFDB %-9o order bound %-3o structure bound %o\n",
    c[1], c[3], OrderBound(E, 50), StructureBound(E, 50);
end for;
// 11.a1   LMFDB [ 1 ]     order bound 5   structure bound [ 1, 5 ]
// 14.a2   LMFDB [ 2 ]     order bound 6   structure bound [ 1, 6 ]
// 19.a2   LMFDB [ 3 ]     order bound 3   structure bound [ 1, 3 ]
// 15.a4   LMFDB [ 4 ]     order bound 8   structure bound [ 1, 4 ]
// 11.a2   LMFDB [ 5 ]     order bound 5   structure bound [ 1, 5 ]
// 14.a6   LMFDB [ 6 ]     order bound 6   structure bound [ 1, 6 ]
// 26.b2   LMFDB [ 7 ]     order bound 7   structure bound [ 1, 7 ]
// 15.a8   LMFDB [ 8 ]     order bound 8   structure bound [ 1, 8 ]
// 54.b2   LMFDB [ 9 ]     order bound 9   structure bound [ 1, 9 ]
// 66.c3   LMFDB [ 10 ]    order bound 10  structure bound [ 1, 10 ]
// 90.c7   LMFDB [ 12 ]    order bound 12  structure bound [ 1, 12 ]
// 15.a2   LMFDB [ 2, 2 ]  order bound 8   structure bound [ 2, 4 ]
// 15.a5   LMFDB [ 2, 4 ]  order bound 8   structure bound [ 2, 4 ]
// 30.a6   LMFDB [ 2, 6 ]  order bound 12  structure bound [ 2, 6 ]
// 210.e6  LMFDB [ 2, 8 ]  order bound 16  structure bound [ 2, 8 ]
```

Check that no bound contradicts the LMFDB. Where is each bound attained?

Solution.

(2) The curves 15.a4 and 15.a8 are isogenous:

```
E := EllipticCurve([1, 1, 1, -80, 242]);        // 15.a4
F := EllipticCurve([1, 1, 1, 35, -28]);          // 15.a8
good := [p : p in PrimesUpTo(50) | p ne 3 and p ne 5];
[#ChangeRing(E, GF(p)) : p in good] eq [#ChangeRing(F, GF(p)) : p in good];
// true
[<p, Invariants(AbelianGroup(ChangeRing(E, GF(p)))),
     Invariants(AbelianGroup(ChangeRing(F, GF(p))))> : p in [7, 11, 13]];
// [ <7, [ 2, 4 ], [ 8 ]>, <11, [ 2, 8 ], [ 16 ]>, <13, [ 16 ], [ 2, 8 ]> ]
```

Using Propositions 21.1 and 21.2, explain why the order bound cannot separate isogenous curves, and why the structure bound separates these two.

Solution.

(3) The LMFDB lists $(5, -2)$ as a torsion generator of 15.a4:

```
E := EllipticCurve([1, 1, 1, -80, 242]);  P := E![5, -2];        // 15.a4
[k*P eq E!0 : k in [1..4]];                        // [ false, false, false, true ]
```

Prove that $T \cong \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ for 15.a4 without trusting the LMFDB. Can you do the same for 11.a1, 14.a2 or 15.a2?

SOLUTION.

(4) Find these curves yourself: on https://www.lmfdb.org/EllipticCurve/Q/, search by "torsion structure", such as `[2,4]`, and sort by conductor. On a curve's page, find its equation, discriminant, torsion subgroup and bad primes. Pick a curve of your own and compute both bounds.

SOLUTION.

Remark 21.3 (Beyond the local theory)**.** Over $\mathbb{Q}$ the bounds complete to an algorithm. For $y^2 = x^3 + Ax + B$ with $A, B \in \mathbb{Z}$, a rational torsion point $P \neq O$ has integer coordinates, and either $2P = O$ or $y(P)^2 \mid 4A^3 + 27B^2$ (Nagell–Lutz, [Sil09, Corollary VIII.7.2]). This leaves finitely many candidates, and the test $b_2 P = O$ decides which are torsion points. Mazur proved that $E(\mathbb{Q})_{\mathrm{tors}}$ is one of the fifteen groups in the listing [Sil09, Theorem VIII.7.5].

Part 7. Good and bad reduction: examples

An elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}_p$ has good, multiplicative or additive reduction, and multiplicative reduction is split or nonsplit [Sil09, §VII.5]. The problems below run through concrete curves of each kind: Problem 29 reads the type off an equation, Problem 30 counts the rational points of the singular reduction, and Problem 31 changes the type by twisting the curve or extending the field. Problem 32 ($\star$) goes further: the curves Frey attached to solutions of $A + B = C$ have no additive reduction at all.

Standing notation.

- A prime p, with $v = v_p$ its valuation on $\mathbb{Q}_p$, extended to $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$.
- An elliptic curve E over $\mathbb{Q}_p$, given by a Weierstrass equation with coefficients in $\mathbb{Z}_p$, with discriminant Δ and invariants c_4, c_6 [Sil09, §III.1].
- When the equation is minimal, E_p is its reduction modulo p, a Weierstrass cubic over $\mathbb{F}_p$.
- We write
$$a_p \coloneqq p + 1 - \#E_p(\mathbb{F}_p),$$
counting the singular point too.

22. Reading off the type

The following definition and results hold for every prime p, and are used throughout. In them, K is $\mathbb{Q}_p$ or a finite extension of it, with normalized valuation v_K, ring of integers $\mathcal{O}_K$ and residue field k, and E is an elliptic curve over K given by a Weierstrass equation with coefficients in $\mathcal{O}_K$.

Definition 22.1 (Reduction types [Sil09, §VII.5])**.** Suppose that the equation is minimal, and consider its reduction, a Weierstrass cubic over k. Then E has good reduction if the reduction is nonsingular, multiplicative reduction if the reduction has a node, and additive reduction if it has a cusp. Multiplicative reduction is split if the slopes of the tangent lines at the node lie in k, and nonsplit otherwise.

Proposition 22.2 (Discriminant and c_4 [Sil09, §III.1])**.** *For an equation $y^2 = x^3 + a_2x^2 + a_4x + a_6$ (that is, $a_1 = a_3 = 0$),*

$$\Delta = -16\big(4a_2^3a_6 - a_2^2a_4^2 - 18a_2a_4a_6 + 4a_4^3 + 27a_6^2\big), \qquad c_4 = 16\big(a_2^2 - 3a_4\big), \tag{22.1}$$

which follow from the formulas of.

Proposition 22.3 (Minimal equations [Sil09, Remark VII.1.1])**.** *Any other Weierstrass equation for E has discriminant $u^{-12}\Delta$ and invariant $u^{-4}c_4$ for some $u \in K^\times$. So if $v_K(\Delta) < 12$ or $v_K(c_4) < 4$, the equation is minimal.*

Proposition 22.4 (Singular Weierstrass cubics [Sil09, Proposition III.1.4(a)])**.** *A Weierstrass cubic over a field with $\Delta = 0$ has exactly one singular point over an algebraic closure. It is a node, with two distinct tangent lines, if $c_4 \neq 0$, and a cusp, with one tangent line, if $c_4 = 0$.*

Proposition 22.5 (Criteria for the reduction type [Sil09, Proposition VII.5.1])**.** *Suppose that the equation is minimal. Then E has good reduction if $v_K(\Delta) = 0$, multiplicative reduction if $v_K(\Delta) > 0$ and $v_K(c_4) = 0$, and additive reduction if $v_K(\Delta) > 0$ and $v_K(c_4) > 0$.*

Proposition 22.6 (Extending the field [Sil09, Proposition VII.5.4(b)])**.** *Let L be a finite extension of K with ramification index e, so that $v_L = e\,v_K$ on K. If E has good, respectively multiplicative, reduction, then so does E_L.*

Proposition 22.7 (Potential good reduction [Sil09, Proposition VII.5.5])**.** *There is a finite extension L of K such that E_L has good reduction if and only if $j(E) \in \mathcal{O}_K$.*

Problem 29 (Reading off the type)**.**
Let $p \geqslant 5$, and let $\varepsilon \in \mathbb{Z}$ be a non-square modulo p. For each equation, decide whether it is minimal at p, and find the reduction type of the curve over $\mathbb{Q}_p$: good, split multiplicative, nonsplit multiplicative, or additive.

Solution.

(1) $y^2 = x^3 + x^2 + p$.

Solution.

(2) $y^2 = x^3 + \varepsilon x^2 + p$.

Solution.

(3) $y^2 = x^3 + p$.

Solution.

(4) $y^2 = x^3 + p^6$.

Solution.

(5) $y^2 = x^3 + x^2 + p^{12}$.

Solution.

(6) Here is `Magma`'s opinion at $p = 7$ and $\varepsilon = 3$. For each curve it prints the valuation of the minimal discriminant, the Kodaira symbol of the reduction (I_0 for good reduction, I_n with $n \geqslant 1$ for multiplicative, anything else for additive), and the polynomial $1 - a_7T$, or $1 - a_7T + 7T^2$ in the case of good reduction.

```
R<T> := PolynomialRing(Integers());
p := 7; eps := 3;                          // 3 is not a square modulo 7
```

```
Info := function(a)
  E := EllipticCurve(a); L := LocalInformation(E, p);
  return <L[2], L[5], R!EulerFactor(E, p)>;
end function;
Info([0, 1, 0, 0, p]);                    // <1, I1, -T + 1>
Info([0, eps, 0, 0, p]);                  // <1, I1, T + 1>
Info([0, 0, 0, 0, p]);                    // <2, II, 1>
Info([0, 0, 0, 0, p^6]);                  // <0, I0, 7*T^2 + 4*T + 1>
Info([0, 1, 0, 0, p^12]);                 // <12, I12, -T + 1>
```

Check that it agrees with your answers. Note the values of a_7 at the curves with bad reduction. Problem 30 explains them.

SOLUTION.

23. Counting rational points on the singular reduction

Definition 23.1 (The nonsingular locus)**.** When the equation of E is minimal, the nonsingular locus E_p^{ns} is E_p minus its singular point, if it has one.

Problem 30 (Counting with lines through the singular point)**.**
Let E be an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}_p$ with bad reduction, and let S be the singular point of its reduction E_p.

(1) Show that $S \in E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$, and that $S \neq O$.[a]

SOLUTION.

(2) Show that a change of variables over $\mathbb{F}_p$ moves S to $(0,0)$ and puts E_p in the form

$$y^2 + a_1xy = x^3 + a_2x^2,$$

and that the tangent lines at S are the lines $y = \alpha x$ with $g(\alpha) = 0$, where $g(t) \coloneqq t^2 + a_1t - a_2$.

SOLUTION.

(3) Let $t \in \mathbb{F}_p$. Show that the line $y = tx$ meets E_p at S and, if $g(t) \neq 0$, at exactly one more $\mathbb{F}_p$-rational point $P_t = \big(g(t), t\,g(t)\big)$, and nowhere else in the affine plane. Show that $t \mapsto P_t$ is a bijection from $\{t \in \mathbb{F}_p : g(t) \neq 0\}$ onto $E_p^{\mathrm{ns}}(\mathbb{F}_p) - \{O\}$.

SOLUTION.

(4) Deduce that $\#E_p^{\mathrm{ns}}(\mathbb{F}_p) = p + 1 - r$, where r is the number of roots of g in $\mathbb{F}_p$, and hence that

$$a_p = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{for split multiplicative reduction,} \\ -1 & \text{for nonsplit multiplicative reduction,} \\ 0 & \text{for additive reduction.} \end{cases}$$

Compare with the output in Problem 29(6).

SOLUTION.

(5) Check (4) by hand for $y^2 = x^3 + x^2$ and $y^2 = x^3 + 2x^2$ over $\mathbb{F}_5$.

SOLUTION.

[a] *Hint:* what does the Frobenius automorphism of $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$ do to a singular point?

24. Changing the curve, changing the field

Problem 31 (Twists and extensions)**.**
Let $p \geqslant 5$. For $d \in \mathbb{Q}_p{}^\times$ and $E\colon y^2 = x^3 + a_2x^2 + a_4x + a_6$, the quadratic twist of E by d is

$$E^d\colon y^2 = x^3 + da_2x^2 + d^2a_4x + d^3a_6.$$

(1) Show that $(x, y) \mapsto (dx, d^{3/2}y)$ is an isomorphism $E \to E^d$ over $\mathbb{Q}_p(\sqrt{d})$, and that $\Delta(E^d) = d^6\Delta(E)$, $c_4(E^d) = d^2c_4(E)$ and $j(E^d) = j(E)$.

Solution.

From now on, $E\colon y^2 = x^3 + x^2 + p$ is the curve of Problem 29(1), with split multiplicative reduction.

(2) Let $\varepsilon \in \mathbb{Z}$ be a non-square modulo p. Show that E^ε has nonsplit multiplicative reduction, and that $a_p(E^\varepsilon) = -a_p(E)$. Since $\mathbb{Q}_p(\sqrt{\varepsilon})$ is an unramified extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, what does this say about which features of the reduction are preserved by unramified extensions?

Solution.

(3) Show that $E^p\colon y^2 = x^3 + px^2 + p^4$ has additive reduction. Over which quadratic extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$ does it acquire multiplicative reduction? Show that it has good reduction over no finite extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$.

Solution.

(4) Let $E_3\colon y^2 = x^3 + p$, and let L be a finite extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$ with ramification index e. Show that E_3 has good reduction over L if and only if $6 \mid e$.[a]

Solution.

(5) Show that $y^2 = x^3 + px$ has additive reduction, and good reduction over L as in (4) if and only if $4 \mid e$.

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* for "if", write $p = \varpi^e w$ with ϖ a uniformizer of L and w a unit.

25. ⋆ Frey curves

This section is [Sil09, Exercise 8.23], with the conductor of [Mil20, Aside II.3.5]. The LMFDB [LMF25] is the answer key.

Problem 32 (Frey curves are semistable)**.**
An elliptic curve over $\mathbb{Q}$ is semistable if it has good or multiplicative reduction at every prime. Let A, B, C be nonzero integers with $A + B = C$ and $\gcd(A, B, C) = 1$. Let

$$E\colon y^2 = x(x + A)(x - B).$$

(1) Show that $\Delta = 16A^2B^2C^2$ and $c_4 = 16(A^2 + AB + B^2)$.

Solution.

(2) Let p be an odd prime dividing ABC. Show that the equation is minimal at p and that E has multiplicative reduction at p. Show that the reduction is split if and only if $-B$, A or B is a square modulo p, according as p divides A, B or C.

Solution.

(3) Suppose that $A \equiv 0 \pmod{16}$ and $B \equiv 3 \pmod 4$. Show that the substitution $x = 4x'$, $y = 8y' + 4x'$ gives an equation with coefficients in $\mathbb{Z}$,

$$y'^2 + x'y' = x'^3 + \frac{A - B - 1}{4}\, x'^2 - \frac{AB}{16}\, x',$$

with discriminant $(ABC)^2/2^8$ and $c_4 = A^2 + AB + B^2$. Deduce that E has good reduction at 2 if $v_2(A) = 4$, and multiplicative reduction at 2 if $v_2(A) \geqslant 5$. So E is semistable.

SOLUTION.

(4) The conductor of E is $N = \prod_p p^{f_p}$, where $f_p = 0$ if E has good reduction at p, $f_p = 1$ if it has multiplicative reduction, and $f_p \geqslant 2$ if it has additive reduction. Under the hypotheses of part (3), compute N in terms of A, B, C. Find the curves for $(A, B, C) = (16, -1, 15)$ and $(32, -5, 27)$ in the LMFDB, and check their conductors and their split and nonsplit primes against your answers.

SOLUTION.

(5) Suppose that $a^\ell + b^\ell = c^\ell$ with $\ell \geqslant 5$ prime and a, b, c nonzero coprime integers. Show that, after reordering and changing signs, $(A, B, C) = (a^\ell, b^\ell, c^\ell)$ satisfies the hypotheses of part (3), and that the resulting curve has conductor $\prod_{p|abc} p$ and minimal discriminant $(abc)^{2\ell}/2^8$.

SOLUTION.

Part 8. Compactness and inertia

Let E be an elliptic curve over a local field K. The rational points of E with nonsingular reduction form a subgroup $E_0(K)$ of finite index in $E(K)$ [Sil09, Theorem VII.6.1 and Corollary VII.6.2], and E has good reduction if and only if the inertia group acts trivially on its torsion, by the criterion of Néron–Ogg–Shafarevich [Sil09, Theorem VII.7.1]. Problem 33 proves the finiteness of $E(K)/E_0(K)$ by a compactness argument. Problem 34 studies how the inertia group acts on the torsion of a curve with potential good reduction.

Standing notation.

- A finite extension K of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, with normalized valuation v, ring of integers $\mathcal{O}_K$, uniformizer π and residue field $k = \mathcal{O}_K/\pi\mathcal{O}_K$, a finite field of characteristic p. (Silverman's Chapter VII assumes that K and k are perfect, and here both are.)
- A fixed algebraic closure $\overline{K}$ of K.
- A bar denotes reduction modulo π.
- An elliptic curve E over K, given by a minimal Weierstrass equation $F(X, Y, Z) = 0$, with $F \in \mathcal{O}_K[X, Y, Z]$ homogeneous of degree 3. It embeds E in $\mathbb{P}^2$ as $V_+(F)$.
- The primitive coordinates $[X : Y : Z]$ of $P \in \mathbb{P}^2(K)$: coordinates in $\mathcal{O}_K$, not all in $\pi\mathcal{O}_K$. Every P has them, and they are unique up to a factor in $\mathcal{O}_K^\times$.
- The reduction $\bar{P} := [\bar{X} : \bar{Y} : \bar{Z}] \in \mathbb{P}^2(k)$ of $P \in \mathbb{P}^2(K)$, computed from primitive coordinates, hence well defined.
- The reduced curve E_π, defined by $\bar{F} = 0$. If $P \in E(K)$, then $\bar{P} \in E_\pi(k)$.

26. Finiteness by compactness

This section is [Sil09, Exercise 7.6]. The argument uses that k is finite, so it does not apply, for instance, to the completion of the maximal unramified extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$: a field complete with respect to a discrete valuation, with residue field $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$ (item (6)). Yet this is the case that the criterion

of Néron–Ogg–Shafarevich needs: Silverman's proof of it uses the finiteness of $E(K^{\mathrm{unr}})/E_0(K^{\mathrm{unr}})$, where K^{unr} is the maximal unramified extension of K, whose residue field is an algebraic closure of k [Sil09, proof of Theorem VII.7.1].

Definition 26.1 (The topology of K)**.** We give K the topology defined by v: the sets $a+\pi^n\mathcal{O}_K$, for $a\in K$ and $n\in\mathbb{Z}$, form a basis, and each of them is both open and closed. With it, K is a Hausdorff topological field.

Definition 26.2 (The subgroup $E_0(K)$)**.** Let E_π^{ns} be E_π minus its singular point, if it has one. Then

$$E_0(K) \coloneqq \{P\in E(K) : \bar{P}\in E_\pi^{\mathrm{ns}}(k)\}.$$

Definition 26.3 (Regular functions [Poo06, Definition 1.8.3])**.** A function $\psi\in K(E)$ is regular at $Q\in E(\overline{K})$ if $\psi=g/h$ with $g,h\in K[X,Y,Z]$ homogeneous of the same degree and $h(Q)\neq 0$. Then $\psi(Q)\coloneqq g(Q)/h(Q)$, an element of K if $Q\in E(K)$. The functions regular at Q form a discrete valuation ring with fraction field $K(E)$.

Proposition 26.4 ($E_0(K)$ is a subgroup [Sil09, Proposition VII.2.1])**.** *The set $E_0(K)$ is a subgroup of $E(K)$.*

Proposition 26.5 (Compactness [Poo17, §1.1.2])**.** *The ring $\mathcal{O}_K$ is compact: it is complete, and for every n it is covered by the $(\#k)^n$ translates of $\pi^n\mathcal{O}_K$. Equivalently, K is locally compact.*

Proposition 26.6 (Morphisms $E\to E$ over K)**.**
(1) The morphisms $\alpha\colon E\to E$ defined over K are exactly the points $\alpha=[\psi_0:\psi_1:\psi_2]\in E(K(E))$, that is, $\psi_0,\psi_1,\psi_2\in K(E)$, not all zero, with $F(\psi_0,\psi_1,\psi_2)=0$ [Poo17, Proposition 3.6.5(b)].
(2) If $Q\in E(\overline{K})$ and ψ_0,ψ_1,ψ_2 are regular at Q and not all zero there, then $\alpha(Q)=[\psi_0(Q):\psi_1(Q):\psi_2(Q)]$ [Sil09, §I.3].
(3) Replacing each ψ_i by $\phi\psi_i$, for $\phi\in K(E)^\times$, gives the same point of $E(K(E))$, and for every $Q\in E(\overline{K})$ some ϕ makes $\phi\psi_0,\phi\psi_1,\phi\psi_2$ regular at Q and not all zero there: a power of a uniformizer of the discrete valuation ring of Definition 26.3 will do [Sil09, proof of Proposition II.2.1].

Proposition 26.7 (Translations [Sil09, Theorem III.3.6 and Example III.4.7])**.** *Let $P\in E(K)$. The translation $\tau_P\colon E\to E$, $Q\mapsto Q+P$, is an isomorphism defined over K, with inverse τ_{-P}.*

Problem 33 ($E(K)/E_0(K)$ is finite)**.**
Let $q\colon K^3-\{0\}\to\mathbb{P}^2(K)$ be the quotient map. Give $K^3-\{0\}$ the product topology and $\mathbb{P}^2(K)$ the quotient topology: $U\subseteq\mathbb{P}^2(K)$ is open if and only if $q^{-1}(U)$ is open. Let

$$S\coloneqq\{\mathbf{x}=(x_0,x_1,x_2)\in\mathcal{O}_K^3 : x_i\in\mathcal{O}_K^\times \text{ for some } i\}$$

be the set of primitive coordinate vectors.

(1) Show that S is compact and open in $K^3-\{0\}$, and that $q(S)=\mathbb{P}^2(K)$. Deduce that $\mathbb{P}^2(K)$ is compact. Show that $U\subseteq\mathbb{P}^2(K)$ is open if and only if $q^{-1}(U)\cap S$ is open in S.[a]

Solution.

(2) Show that $E(K)=V_+(F)(K)$ is closed in $\mathbb{P}^2(K)$, and deduce that it is compact.

Solution.

(3) Let $g,h\in K[X,Y,Z]$ be homogeneous of the same degree. Show that $W\coloneqq\{Q\in\mathbb{P}^2(K) : h(Q)\neq 0\}$ is open, and that $W\to K$, $Q\mapsto g(Q)/h(Q)$, is continuous. Deduce from Propositions 26.6 and 26.7 that every translation $\tau_P\colon E(K)\to E(K)$ is a homeomorphism.

Solution.

(4) Show that the reduction map $\mathbb{P}^2(K) \to \mathbb{P}^2(k)$, $P \mapsto \bar{P}$, is locally constant. Deduce that $E_0(K)$ is open in $E(K)$, and also closed.

Solution.

(5) Prove that $E(K)/E_0(K)$ is finite.

Solution.

(6) Let K' be a field complete with respect to a discrete valuation whose residue field k' is infinite, for instance algebraically closed. Show that its ring of integers is not compact. Which step of the argument above fails for an elliptic curve over K'?

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* $q^{-1}(U)$ is stable under multiplication by $K^\times$.

27. Inertia acting on torsion

This section is [Sil09, Exercise 7.9], with the hypothesis $m \geqslant 3$ added to its first two parts (item (5) explains why) and a `Magma` check. We use the notation of [Sil09, §VII.4].

Definition 27.1 (Reduction types)**.** The curve E has good reduction if E_π is nonsingular, that is, if $v(\Delta) = 0$, and bad reduction otherwise. It has potential good reduction if it has good reduction over some finite extension of K.

Definition 27.2 (Inertia)**.** Let $\mathrm{Gal}_K := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{K}/K)$, $K^{\mathrm{unr}} \subseteq \overline{K}$ the maximal unramified extension of K, and $I_v := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{K}/K^{\mathrm{unr}})$ the inertia group. A set on which Gal_K acts is unramified if I_v acts trivially on it.

Definition 27.3 (Ramification of finite extensions)**.** For an extension L of K inside $\overline{K}$, let $\mathrm{Gal}_L := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{K}/L)$. If L/K is finite and Galois, the inertia group of L/K is the image of I_v in $\mathrm{Gal}(L/K)$, isomorphic to $I_v/(I_v \cap \mathrm{Gal}_L)$. The extension L/K is unramified if its inertia group is trivial, and tamely ramified if its order is prime to p.

Definition 27.4 (Torsion fields and Tate modules [Sil09, §III.7])**.** For $m \geqslant 1$ with $p \nmid m$, $K(E[m])$ is the field generated over K by the coordinates of the points of $E[m](\overline{K})$, so $\mathrm{Gal}_{K(E[m])}$ is the kernel of the action of Gal_K on $E[m](\overline{K})$. For a prime $\ell \neq p$, the Tate module $T_\ell(E)$ is the inverse limit of the $E[\ell^n](\overline{K})$ along the surjections $[\ell]$, and $\rho_\ell \colon \mathrm{Gal}_K \to \mathrm{Aut}\, T_\ell(E)$ is the action of Gal_K on it.

In the following results, $\ell \neq p$ is a prime and $m \geqslant 1$ is an integer with $p \nmid m$.

Proposition 27.5 (Minimal equations [Sil09, Remark VII.1.1 and §III.1])**.** *A Weierstrass equation with coefficients in $\mathcal{O}_K$ and $v(\Delta) < 12$ is minimal. For $y^2 = x^3 + Ax + B$, $\Delta = -16(4A^3 + 27B^2)$.*

Corollary 27.6 (Torsion [Sil09, Corollary III.6.4(b)])**.** *The group $E[m](\overline{K})$ is isomorphic to $(\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z})^2$.*

Proposition 27.7 (The Tate module [Sil09, Proposition III.7.1(a)])**.** *The Tate module $T_\ell(E)$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}_\ell^2$. Hence each projection $T_\ell(E) \to E[\ell^n](\overline{K})$ is a surjective homomorphism of Gal_K-modules, and its kernel is $\ell^n T_\ell(E)$, since both have index ℓ^{2n}.*

Proposition 27.8 (Good reduction [Sil09, Proposition VII.4.1])**.** *If E has good reduction, then $E[m](\overline{K})$ and $T_\ell(E)$ are unramified.*

Theorem 27.9 (Néron–Ogg–Shafarevich [Sil09, Theorem VII.7.1])**.** *If $T_\ell(E)$ is unramified, then E has good reduction.*

Corollary 27.10 (Potential good reduction [Sil09, Corollary VII.7.3])**.** *The curve E has potential good reduction if and only if $\rho_\ell(I_v)$ is finite.*

Proposition 27.11 (Inertia groups of finite extensions [Sil09, proof of Corollary VII.7.3])**.** *If $H \subseteq I_v$ is a closed normal subgroup of finite index, there is a finite extension K' of K inside $\overline{K}$ whose inertia group $\mathrm{Gal}(\overline{K}/K'K^{\mathrm{unr}}) = I_v \cap \mathrm{Gal}_{K'}$ is H.*

Problem 34 (The inertia group of $K(E[m])/K$)**.**
Suppose that E has potential good reduction, and let J be the subgroup of the elements of I_v that act trivially on $E[m](\overline{K})$ for every $m \geqslant 1$ with $p \nmid m$.

(1) Let ℓ be a prime and $r \geqslant 1$ with $\ell^r \geqslant 3$, and let $g \in \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{Z}_\ell)$ be an element of finite order with $g \equiv I \pmod{\ell^r}$. Show that $g = I$.[a]

Solution.

(2) Show that $J = I_v \cap \ker \rho_\ell$ for every prime $\ell \neq p$, and that J has finite index in I_v.

Solution.

(3) Let $m \geqslant 3$ with $p \nmid m$. Show that $J = I_v \cap \mathrm{Gal}_{K(E[m])}$, and deduce that the inertia group of $K(E[m])/K$ is isomorphic to I_v/J, independently of m.

Solution.

(4) Let $m \geqslant 3$ with $p \nmid m$. Show that $K(E[m])/K$ is unramified if and only if E has good reduction. Which direction holds for every $m \geqslant 1$ with $p \nmid m$, and for every elliptic curve over K?

Solution.

(5) Let $p \geqslant 3$ and $E\colon y^2 = x^3 - \pi^2 x$.

(a) Show that E has bad reduction, potential good reduction, and $K(E[2]) = K$.

Solution.

(b) Show that I_v/J has order 2, and that its nontrivial element acts on every $T_\ell(E)$ as -1.[b]

Solution.

(c) So (3) and (4) fail for $m = 2$. Where did your proofs use $m \geqslant 3$?

Solution.

(6) Suppose that $p \geqslant 5$. Show that $K(E[m])/K$ is tamely ramified for every $m \geqslant 1$ with $p \nmid m$.[c]

Solution.

(7) `Magma` computes $\#(I_v/J)$ for elliptic curves over $\mathbb{Q}_7$:

```
p := 7;
Inertia := func< A, B |
  #InertiaGroup(GaloisRepresentation(EllipticCurve([A, B]), p)) >;
Inertia(-1, 0);                    // 1
Inertia(-p^2, 0);                  // 2
Inertia(0, p);                     // 6
```

Check the first two values against your answers, and the third against (6).

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* reduce to g of prime order q, write $g = I + \ell^s h$ with $h \in M_2(\mathbb{Z}_\ell)$ not divisible by ℓ, and expand g^q.
[b] *Hint:* over $K(\sqrt{\pi})$, E is isomorphic to $y^2 = x^3 - x$.
[c] *Hint:* $\#\,\mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_3) = 48$.

Part 9. Hilbert 90 and Kummer theory

Hilbert's Theorem 90 says that $H^1(k, \mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m}) = 1$. Applied to the Kummer sequence $1 \to \mu_m \to \mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m} \xrightarrow{m} \mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m} \to 1$, it gives an isomorphism $k^\times/k^{\times m} \cong H^1(k, \mu_m)$ with an explicit formula, and, when k contains the m-th roots of unity, a classification of the abelian extensions of k of exponent dividing m. The problems below prove all of this from the definitions in [Sil09, Appendix B]. Problem 35 computes cohomology groups by hand, Problem 36 proves Hilbert 90, Problem 37 unwinds the Kummer sequence and Problem 38 derives Kummer theory. Problems 39 and 40 compute the groups $k^\times/k^{\times m}$ for finite, local and global fields, and cut out a finite subgroup by conditions at the primes. Later, the same sequence for an elliptic curve E will give an injection $E(k)/m \hookrightarrow H^1(k, E[m])$. Then there is no Hilbert 90, and its failure is measured by $H^1(k, E)$.

Standing notation.

- A field k, not assumed perfect, a separable closure k^sep of k, and the absolute Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}_k := \mathrm{Gal}(k^\mathrm{sep}/k)$. For an extension L of k inside k^sep, $\mathrm{Gal}_L := \mathrm{Gal}(k^\mathrm{sep}/L)$. (Silverman's Appendix B assumes k perfect and works with an algebraic closure. Nothing in it changes with k^sep in its place.)
- A profinite group G, often finite, and a discrete G-module A: an abelian group with a left action of G, written $a \mapsto ga$, such that $G \times A \to A$ is continuous for the discrete topology on A. (Silverman writes right actions, $a \mapsto a^\sigma$.)
- Elements g, h of G, and elements σ, τ, γ of a Galois group such as Gal_k or $\mathrm{Gal}(L/k)$. Where σ is a generator of a cyclic group, it keeps that meaning.
- An integer $m \geqslant 1$ with $\mathrm{char}\, k \nmid m$, and the algebraic group μ_m of m-th roots of unity, the kernel of $x \mapsto x^m$ on $\mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m}$. For a field L containing k, $\mu_m(L)$ is the group of m-th roots of unity in L.
- **An abuse of notation.** For a commutative algebraic group A over k, such as $\mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m}$, μ_m or an elliptic curve, we write $H^i(k, A) := H^i(\mathrm{Gal}_k, A(k^\mathrm{sep}))$, the cohomology of the Gal_k-module of k^sep-points of A. For instance,
$$H^1(k, \mathbb{G}_\mathrm{m}) = H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_k, (k^\mathrm{sep})^\times), \qquad H^1(k, \mu_m) = H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_k, \mu_m(k^\mathrm{sep})).$$
This is the only place where A stands for $A(k^\mathrm{sep})$.
- The quotient $B/m := B/mB$ of an abelian group B. For the multiplicative group of a field L it is $L^\times/L^{\times m}$, where $L^{\times m}$ is the subgroup of m-th powers.

28. Cocycles by hand

This section uses the definitions of [Sil09, §§B.1–B.2] and [Poo02, §§2–3]. Its last item is [Sil09, Exercise B.2(a)].

Definition 28.1 (Cohomology in degrees 0 and 1 [Sil09, §§B.1–B.2], [Poo02, §3])**.** Let A be a discrete G-module. Then $H^0(G, A) := A^G$, the subgroup of the $a \in A$ with $ga = a$ for every $g \in G$. A left 1-cocycle, or simply 1-cocycle, is a continuous map $\xi\colon G \to A$, $g \mapsto \xi_g$, such that
$$\xi_{gh} = \xi_g + g\xi_h \qquad \text{for all } g, h \in G.$$
A left 1-coboundary, or simply 1-coboundary, is a map of the form $g \mapsto ga - a$, for some $a \in A$. Both are *left*: they are written for the left action $a \mapsto ga$. Silverman's are the right ones, for $a \mapsto a^\sigma$:

$\xi_{\sigma\tau} = \xi_\sigma^\tau + \xi_\tau$ and $\xi_\sigma = a^\sigma - a$. The 1-cocycles form a group $Z^1(G, A)$ under addition of values, the 1-coboundaries a subgroup $B^1(G, A)$, and $H^1(G, A) \coloneqq Z^1(G, A)/B^1(G, A)$. If G is finite, every map $G \to A$ is continuous. When the group law of A is written multiplicatively, as for $L^\times$ or $\mu_m(L)$, the conditions read $\xi_{gh} = \xi_g \cdot g(\xi_h)$ and $\xi_g = g(a)/a$.

Proposition 28.2 (Trivial action [Sil09, Remarks B.1.1 and B.2.2], [Poo02, §3])**.** *If G acts trivially on A, then $H^0(G, A) = A$ and $H^1(G, A) = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{conts}}(G, A)$, the group of continuous homomorphisms.*

Problem 35 (Computing H^1 from the definition)**.**
In this problem G is finite.

(1) Let $G = \{1, \sigma\}$ have order 2, acting on $\mathbb{Z}$ by $\sigma a = -a$. Compute $H^0(G, \mathbb{Z})$ and $H^1(G, \mathbb{Z})$. Compare with the trivial action of G on $\mathbb{Z}$.

Solution.

(2) Let $G = \langle\sigma\rangle$ be cyclic of order n, and $N \coloneqq 1 + \sigma + \cdots + \sigma^{n-1}$, acting on A. Show that $\xi \mapsto \xi_\sigma$ induces an isomorphism[a]

$$H^1(G, A) \cong \ker(N\colon A \to A)/(\sigma - 1)A.$$

Solution.

(3) Let $G = \mathrm{Gal}(\mathbb{C}/\mathbb{R}) = \{1, c\}$. Use (2) to compute $H^1(G, \mathbb{C}^\times)$ and $H^1(G, \mu_m(\mathbb{C}))$. Compare the order of the second group with that of $\mathbb{R}^\times/\mathbb{R}^{\times m}$.

Solution.

(4) Suppose that G has order n. Show that $nH^1(G, A) = 0$. [b]

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* show that $\xi_{\sigma^i} = (1 + \sigma + \cdots + \sigma^{i-1})\xi_\sigma$ for $i \geqslant 1$.
[b] *Hint:* sum the cocycle condition $\xi_{gh} = \xi_g + g\xi_h$ over $h \in G$.

29. Hilbert 90

This section is [Poo17, Proposition 1.3.15(ii) and Exercises 1.10–1.11], with the proof of [Mil20, Proposition IV.1.3] (also [Mil22, Theorem 5.23]). [Sil09, Proposition B.2.5] states the result and refers to Serre for the proof. Item (2) is the form in which Hilbert stated it.

Theorem 29.1 (Dedekind [Mil22, Theorem 5.14])**.** *Let F be a field and H a group. If $\chi_1, \ldots, \chi_r$ are distinct homomorphisms $H \to F^\times$, then they are linearly independent over F: if $a_1\chi_1 + \cdots + a_r\chi_r = 0$ as a function $H \to F$, with $a_i \in F$, then $a_1 = \cdots = a_r = 0$.*

Definition 29.2 (Norm and trace)**.** Let L/k be a finite Galois extension with group G. The norm and the trace of $a \in L$ are $N_{L/k}(a) \coloneqq \prod_{\sigma\in G} \sigma(a)$ and $\mathrm{Tr}_{L/k}(a) \coloneqq \sum_{\sigma\in G} \sigma(a)$. Both lie in k.

Proposition 29.3 (Infinite Galois theory)**.**
(1) The subgroups Gal_L, for L running over the finite Galois extensions of k inside k^{sep}, are open and normal in Gal_k, and they form a basis of open neighborhoods of 1 [Sil09, §B.2].
(2) The maps $H \mapsto (k^{\mathrm{sep}})^H$ and $L \mapsto \mathrm{Gal}_L$ are inverse bijections between the closed subgroups of Gal_k and the extensions of k inside k^{sep}. The subgroup H is open if and only if $(k^{\mathrm{sep}})^H$ is finite over k, and then $[\mathrm{Gal}_k : H] = [(k^{\mathrm{sep}})^H : k]$. It is normal if and only if $(k^{\mathrm{sep}})^H$ is Galois over k, and then $\mathrm{Gal}((k^{\mathrm{sep}})^H/k) \cong \mathrm{Gal}_k/H$ by restriction. In particular, $(k^{\mathrm{sep}})^{\mathrm{Gal}_k} = k$ [Mil22, Theorem 7.13].

Definition 29.4 (Restriction and inflation [Sil09, §B.2], [Poo02, §4])**.** Let A be a discrete G-module and $H \subseteq G$ a closed subgroup. The restriction $\mathrm{Res}\colon H^1(G,A) \to H^1(H,A)$ maps the class of ξ to the class of $\xi|_H$. If H is normal, the inflation $\mathrm{Inf}\colon H^1(G/H, A^H) \to H^1(G,A)$ maps the class of ξ to the class of the composition $G \to G/H \xrightarrow{\xi} A^H \subseteq A$. A 1-cocycle of G of this form is inflated from G/H.

Problem 36 (Hilbert's Theorem 90)**.**

(1) Let L/k be a finite Galois extension with group G, and $\xi\colon G \to L^\times$ a 1-cocycle. Show that there is a $c \in L^\times$ with

$$b := \sum_{\tau \in G} \xi_\tau \cdot \tau(c) \neq 0,$$

and that then $\xi_\sigma = b/\sigma(b)$ for every $\sigma \in G$. Deduce that $H^1(G, L^\times) = 1$. [a]

Solution.

(2) Suppose moreover that $G = \langle \sigma \rangle$ is cyclic. Show that if $a \in L^\times$ has $N_{L/k}(a) = 1$, then $a = \sigma(b)/b$ for some $b \in L^\times$.

Solution.

(3) Let (x,y) be a rational point of the circle $x^2 + y^2 = 1$. Apply (2) to $\mathbb{Q}(i)/\mathbb{Q}$ to find $u, v \in \mathbb{Q}$, not both 0, with

$$(x,y) = \Big(\frac{u^2 - v^2}{u^2 + v^2}, \frac{2uv}{u^2 + v^2}\Big).$$

Solution.

(4) Let $\xi\colon \mathrm{Gal}_k \to (k^{\mathrm{sep}})^\times$ be a continuous 1-cocycle.

(a) Show that there is a finite Galois extension L of k inside k^{sep} such that ξ takes values in $L^\times$ and $\xi_{\sigma\tau} = \xi_\sigma$ for all $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_k$ and $\tau \in \mathrm{Gal}_L$. So ξ is inflated from a 1-cocycle $\mathrm{Gal}(L/k) \to L^\times$. [b]

Solution.

(b) Deduce that $H^1(k, \mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}) = 1$.

Solution.

(5) ($\star$) Let L/k be finite Galois with group G, and $\xi\colon G \to L$ a 1-cocycle for the additive group of L. Show that $H^1(G, L) = 0$, by a variant of (1). [c]

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* compute $\sigma(b)$ with the cocycle condition.
[b] *Hint:* Gal_k is compact, and $\xi^{-1}(1)$ is open.
[c] *Hint:* take $c \in L$ with $\mathrm{Tr}_{L/k}(c) \neq 0$.

30. The Kummer sequence

This section is the exercise in [Poo02, §3], with the explicit formula of [Sil09, Propositions B.2.5(c) and VIII.2.2]. Hilbert's Theorem 90, $H^1(k, \mathbb{G}_{\mathrm{m}}) = 1$, is Problem 36(4).

Proposition 30.1 (Finite multiplicative groups [Mil22, Exercise 1-3])**.** *Every finite subgroup of the multiplicative group of a field is cyclic.*

Proposition 30.2 (The long exact sequence [Sil09, Propositions B.1.2 and B.2.3], [Poo02, Theorem 1]). *Let $0 \to A \to B \xrightarrow{\psi} C \to 0$ be an exact sequence of discrete G-modules. There is an exact sequence*

$$0 \to A^G \to B^G \to C^G \xrightarrow{\delta} H^1(G, A) \to H^1(G, B) \to H^1(G, C),$$

where, for $c \in C^G$, $\delta(c)$ is the class of $g \mapsto gb - b$ for any $b \in B$ with $\psi(b) = c$.

Proposition 30.3 (Inflation–restriction [Sil09, Proposition B.2.4]). *Let A be a discrete Gal_k-module and L/k a finite Galois extension inside k^{sep}. The sequence*

$$0 \to H^1(\mathrm{Gal}(L/k), A^{\mathrm{Gal}_L}) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Inf}} H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_k, A) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Res}} H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_L, A)$$

is exact.

Problem 37 (The Kummer sequence).
Recall that $\operatorname{char} k \nmid m$, so $m \neq 0$ in k.

(1) Show that $\mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}})$ is cyclic of order m, and that

$$1 \to \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \to (k^{\mathrm{sep}})^\times \xrightarrow{x \mapsto x^m} (k^{\mathrm{sep}})^\times \to 1$$

is an exact sequence of discrete Gal_k-modules. Deduce from Proposition 30.2 that its connecting map induces an isomorphism $\delta\colon k^\times/k^{\times m} \to H^1(k, \mu_m)$.

Solution.

(2) Let $a \in k^\times$ and $\alpha \in k^{\mathrm{sep}}$ with $\alpha^m = a$. Check directly, without Proposition 30.2, that $\xi_\sigma := \sigma(\alpha)/\alpha$ is a continuous 1-cocycle with values in $\mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}})$, whose class does not depend on the choice of α. Show that $a \mapsto [\xi]$ is a homomorphism $k^\times \to H^1(k, \mu_m)$ with kernel $k^{\times m}$. This is the map δ of (1).

Solution.

(3) Show directly from Hilbert 90 that every continuous 1-cocycle $\xi\colon \mathrm{Gal}_k \to \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}})$ is cohomologous to one of the form of (2).

Solution.

(4) Let $m = 2$, with $\operatorname{char} k \neq 2$. Show that $H^1(k, \mu_2) = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{conts}}(\mathrm{Gal}_k, \{\pm 1\})$, and that for $d \in k^\times - k^{\times 2}$, $\delta(d)$ is the homomorphism $\chi_d\colon \sigma \mapsto \sigma(\sqrt{d})/\sqrt{d}$, with kernel $\mathrm{Gal}_{k(\sqrt{d})}$. Deduce that $d \mapsto k(\sqrt{d})$ is a bijection from the nontrivial elements of $k^\times/k^{\times 2}$ to the quadratic extensions of k inside k^{sep}.

Solution.

(5) Let L be an extension of k inside k^{sep}. Show that the restriction $H^1(k, \mu_m) \to H^1(L, \mu_m)$ corresponds, under δ, to the map $k^\times/k^{\times m} \to L^\times/L^{\times m}$ induced by inclusion, and that its kernel corresponds to $(k^\times \cap L^{\times m})/k^{\times m}$. Compute the kernel for $\mathbb{Q}(i)/\mathbb{Q}$ and $m = 2$, and compare it with Proposition 30.3.

Solution.

31. Kummer theory

This section is [Sil09, Exercise 8.4], in the form of [Mil22, Theorem 5.30 and Remark 5.32], together with an example that shows why the roots of unity are needed. In it, $\mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \subseteq k$, except in item (4).

Proposition 31.1 (Characters of a finite abelian group [Mil22, discussion before Theorem 5.30])**.** *If B is a finite abelian group of exponent dividing m, then* $\mathrm{Hom}(B, \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}))$ *has the same order as* B*.*

Problem 38 (Abelian extensions of exponent dividing m)**.**

(1) Suppose that $\mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \subseteq k$. Show that δ is an isomorphism

$$\delta\colon k^\times/k^{\times m} \to \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{conts}}(\mathrm{Gal}_k, \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}})).$$

For $a \in k^\times$ and $\alpha^m = a$, show that $\ker \delta(a) = \mathrm{Gal}_{k(\alpha)}$, and deduce that $k(\alpha)/k$ is Galois and cyclic, of degree the order of a in $k^\times/k^{\times m}$.

Solution.

(2) Suppose that $\mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \subseteq k$. Let Δ be a subgroup of $k^\times$ containing $k^{\times m}$, with $\Delta/k^{\times m}$ finite, and $L \coloneqq k(\Delta^{1/m})$ the extension of k inside k^{sep} generated by the m-th roots of the elements of Δ. Show that L/k is finite and Galois, and that

$$\langle\ ,\ \rangle\colon \mathrm{Gal}(L/k) \times \Delta/k^{\times m} \to \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}), \qquad \langle\sigma, a\rangle \coloneqq \sigma(\alpha)/\alpha \quad (\alpha^m = a),$$

is a well defined bilinear pairing, and that it is perfect: the induced maps

$$\mathrm{Gal}(L/k) \to \mathrm{Hom}(\Delta/k^{\times m}, \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}})), \qquad \Delta/k^{\times m} \to \mathrm{Hom}(\mathrm{Gal}(L/k), \mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}))$$

are isomorphisms. Deduce that $\mathrm{Gal}(L/k)$ is abelian of exponent dividing m and that $[L : k] = (\Delta : k^{\times m})$.[a]

Solution.

(3) Suppose that $\mu_m(k^{\mathrm{sep}}) \subseteq k$. Show that $\Delta \mapsto k(\Delta^{1/m})$ is a bijection from the subgroups Δ as in (2) to the finite abelian extensions of k inside k^{sep} of exponent dividing m, with inverse $L \mapsto \Delta_L \coloneqq k^\times \cap L^{\times m}$.[b]

Solution.

(4) ($\star$) Let $k = \mathbb{Q}$, $m = 3$, $\zeta \in \overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ a primitive cube root of unity, and $F \coloneqq \mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$. Here $\mu_3(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \not\subseteq \mathbb{Q}$.

(a) Show that $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[3]{2})/\mathbb{Q}$ is not Galois, although $2 \notin \mathbb{Q}^{\times 3}$. Which step of (1) fails?

Solution.

(b) Show that $\mathbb{Q}^\times/\mathbb{Q}^{\times 3} \to F^\times/F^{\times 3}$ is injective.[c]

Solution.

(c) Let $a \in \mathbb{Q}^\times - \mathbb{Q}^{\times 3}$, $\alpha^3 = a$, and $L \coloneqq F(\alpha)$. Show that $L/\mathbb{Q}$ is Galois of degree 6, and that conjugation by any $\tau \in \mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q})$ with $\tau(\zeta) = \zeta^{-1}$ acts on $\mathrm{Gal}(L/F) \cong \mu_3(F)$, the isomorphism of (1) over F, as inversion. Deduce that $\mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q}) \cong S_3$. Check with `Magma`:

```
R<x> := PolynomialRing(Rationals());
G := GaloisGroup(x^3 - 2);
#G, IsAbelian(G);                    // 6 false
F<zeta> := CyclotomicField(3);
S<y> := PolynomialRing(F);
#GaloisGroup(y^3 - 2);               // 3
```

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* show that both maps are injective, then count with Proposition 31.1.
[b] *Hint:* for L given, compute $\Delta_L/k^{\times m}$ with Problem 37(5) and Proposition 30.3.
[c] *Hint:* Proposition 30.3 and Problem 35(4).

32. Computing $k^\times/k^{\times m}$

This section computes $k^\times/k^{\times m} \cong H^1(k, \mu_m)$ for finite fields, $\mathbb{Q}_p$ and $\mathbb{Q}$, and then cuts out a finite subgroup by conditions at the primes, as in [Poo02, §§9–10]. The last item is [Sil09, proof of Proposition VIII.1.6], with a `Magma` check.

Lemma 32.1 (Hensel's lemma [Sil09, Lemma IV.1.2])**.** *Let $F \in \mathbb{Z}_p[w]$ and $a \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ with $F(a) \in p^n\mathbb{Z}_p$ for some $n \geqslant 1$ and $F'(a) \in \mathbb{Z}_p^\times$. Then F has a root $b \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ with $b \equiv a \pmod{p^n}$.*

Definition 32.2 (Unramified classes [Poo02, §§4 and 9])**.** Let p be a prime. Embed $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ in an algebraic closure $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$ of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, so that restriction is an injection $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}_p} := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p/\mathbb{Q}_p) \hookrightarrow \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$. Let ${\mathbb{Q}_p}^{\mathrm{unr}} \subseteq \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$ be the maximal unramified extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, the union of its finite unramified extensions. A finite extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$ inside $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$ is unramified if and only if it lies in ${\mathbb{Q}_p}^{\mathrm{unr}}$. The inertia group is $I_p := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p/{\mathbb{Q}_p}^{\mathrm{unr}}) \subseteq \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}_p}$. A class $\xi \in H^1(\mathbb{Q}, A)$, for a commutative algebraic group A over $\mathbb{Q}$, is unramified at p if its image in $H^1(I_p, A(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p))$ is trivial. For a finite set S of primes, $H^1(\mathbb{Q}, A; S)$ is the subgroup of the classes unramified at every prime $p \notin S$.

Proposition 32.3 (Unramified Kummer extensions [Sil09, proof of Proposition VIII.1.6])**.** *Let p be a prime with $p \nmid m$, $a \in {\mathbb{Q}_p}^\times$ and $\alpha \in \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$ with $\alpha^m = a$. Then $\mathbb{Q}_p(\alpha)/\mathbb{Q}_p$ is unramified if and only if $v_p(a) \equiv 0 \pmod{m}$.*

Problem 39 (Finite and local fields)**.**

(1) Let q be a power of a prime not dividing m. Show that $\mathbb{F}_q^\times/\mathbb{F}_q^{\times m}$ is cyclic of order $\gcd(m, q-1)$. If $m \mid q-1$, so that $\mu_m(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_q) \subseteq \mathbb{F}_q$, compare the subgroups of $\mathbb{F}_q^\times/\mathbb{F}_q^{\times m}$ with the extensions of $\mathbb{F}_q$ of degree dividing m, as Problem 38(3) predicts.

Solution.

(2) Let p be odd and $u \in \mathbb{Z}_p^\times$ a unit whose reduction is not a square in $\mathbb{F}_p$. Show that ${\mathbb{Q}_p}^\times/{\mathbb{Q}_p}^{\times 2}$ has order 4, with representatives $1, u, p, up$. List the quadratic extensions of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, and say which one is unramified.[a]

Solution.

(3) Show that a unit $v \in \mathbb{Z}_2^\times$ is a square if and only if $v \equiv 1 \pmod 8$. Deduce that $\mathbb{Q}_2^\times/\mathbb{Q}_2^{\times 2}$ has order 8, with representatives $\pm 1, \pm 2, \pm 5, \pm 10$. `Magma` counts the quadratic extensions of $\mathbb{Q}_p$:

```
#AllExtensions(pAdicRing(3, 20), 2);    // 3
#AllExtensions(pAdicRing(5, 20), 2);    // 3
#AllExtensions(pAdicRing(2, 20), 2);    // 7
```

Check these against your answers.[b]

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* every element of ${\mathbb{Q}_p}^\times$ is $p^n v$ with $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $v \in \mathbb{Z}_p^\times$, and Lemma 32.1 decides which units are squares.
[b] *Hint:* for $v \equiv 1 \pmod 8$, apply Lemma 32.1 to $F(w) = w^2 + w - (v-1)/4$, then look at $(2w+1)^2$.

Definition 32.4 (The group $k(S,m)$ [Sil09, Theorem X.1.1(c)])**.** Let k be a number field, S a finite set of places of k containing the archimedean ones, and

$$k(S,m) := \{a \in k^\times/k^{\times m} : v(a) \equiv 0 \pmod{m} \text{ for all } v \notin S\},$$

where v runs over the normalized valuations of k. Let $\mathcal{O}_S$ be the ring of S-integers, the $a \in k$ with $v(a) \geqslant 0$ for all $v \notin S$, and $\mathrm{Cl}(\mathcal{O}_S)$ its ideal class group. For $k = \mathbb{Q}$ we list only the primes in S, and in [Poo02, §10], $\mathbb{Q}(S,2)$ is written $\langle -1, S\rangle$.

Proposition 32.5 (Finiteness [Sil09, proof of Proposition VIII.1.6])**.** *The group* $\mathrm{Cl}(\mathcal{O}_S)$ *is finite, and* $\mathcal{O}_S^\times$ *is finitely generated (Dirichlet's* S*-unit theorem).*

Problem 40 (Classes unramified outside S)**.**

(1) Show that $\mathbb{Q}^\times/\mathbb{Q}^{\times 2}$ is an $\mathbb{F}_2$-vector space with basis the classes of -1 and of the primes. In particular, it is infinite.

Solution.

(2) Let S be a finite set of primes. Show that $\mathbb{Q}(S,2)$ is the subgroup generated by -1 and the primes in S, of order $2^{\#S+1}$.

Solution.

(3) Let p be an odd prime and $a \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$. Show that $\delta(a) \in H^1(\mathbb{Q},\mu_2)$ is unramified at p if and only if $v_p(a)$ is even. Deduce that $\mathbb{Q}(S,2) = \delta^{-1}H^1(\mathbb{Q},\mu_2;S)$ for every finite set S of primes containing 2.

Solution.

(4) ($\star$) Let k be a number field and S as in Definition 32.4. Construct an exact sequence[a]

$$1 \to \mathcal{O}_S^\times/\mathcal{O}_S^{\times m} \to k(S,m) \to \mathrm{Cl}(\mathcal{O}_S)[m] \to 0,$$

and deduce that $k(S,m)$ is finite. For $k = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-5})$, $m = 2$ and S the archimedean place, show that $k(S,2) = \langle -1, 2\rangle$, of order 4, and check with `Magma`:

```
K<s> := QuadraticField(-5);
OK := Integers(K);
#ClassGroup(OK);                        // 2
G, m := pSelmerGroup(2, {PowerIdeal(OK)|});
#G;                                     // 4
[K | G.i @@ m : i in [1..Ngens(G)]];  // [ -1, 2 ]
```

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* the prime ideals of $\mathcal{O}_S$ are those of the places outside S. If a represents an element of $k(S,m)$, then $a\mathcal{O}_S = \mathfrak{a}^m$ for a fractional ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ of $\mathcal{O}_S$.

Part 10. The Kummer pairing and weak Mordell–Weil

The weak Mordell–Weil theorem says that $E(K)/mE(K)$ is finite for an elliptic curve E over a number field K. The proof in [Sil09, §VIII.1] has three steps. The Kummer pairing turns the finiteness of $E(K)/mE(K)$ into the finiteness of the field L generated by the m-th divisors of the rational points. This field is abelian of exponent m and unramified outside a finite set of places

S. And Kummer theory shows that such fields are finite. This worksheet runs the argument for $m = 2$ and $K = \mathbb{Q}$, on curves whose points of order two are rational. Then the class group and the S-unit theorem disappear, and the injectivity of reduction on the 2-torsion becomes elementary. Problem 41 sets up the pairing. Problem 42, the heart of the worksheet, proves that L is unramified outside S and deduces a bound for $E(\mathbb{Q})/2E(\mathbb{Q})$. Problem 43 tests the bound on $y^2 = x^3 - x$.

Standing notation.

- An elliptic curve E over $\mathbb{Q}$, given by
$$y^2 = (x - e_1)(x - e_2)(x - e_3)$$
with distinct $e_1, e_2, e_3 \in \mathbb{Z}$, and its points of order two $T_i := (e_i, 0)$. So $E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) = \{O, T_1, T_2, T_3\} \subseteq E(\mathbb{Q})$.
- The finite set of primes $S := \{2\} \cup \{p : p \mid (e_1 - e_2)(e_1 - e_3)(e_2 - e_3)\}$, and $s := \#S$.
- The absolute Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}} := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}/\mathbb{Q})$, with elements σ, τ, γ. For an extension F of $\mathbb{Q}$ inside $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$, $\mathrm{Gal}_F := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}/F)$.
- For $Q \in E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$, the field $\mathbb{Q}(Q)$ generated by the coordinates of Q, and the point $\sigma(Q)$, obtained by applying $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$ to the coordinates.
- The compositum L of the fields $\mathbb{Q}(Q)$ for $Q \in E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ with $2Q \in E(\mathbb{Q})$. Silverman writes $L = \mathbb{Q}([2]^{-1}E(\mathbb{Q}))$.
- The quotient $B/2 := B/2B$ of an abelian group B, and the group $\mathbb{Q}^\times/\mathbb{Q}^{\times 2}$ of classes of rational numbers modulo squares.

33. The Kummer pairing

This section is [Sil09, Proposition VIII.1.2], for $m = 2$ and $K = \mathbb{Q}$, and its reinterpretation in [Sil09, §VIII.2], with cohomology as in [Sil09, §§B.1–B.2].

Definition 33.1 (The Kummer pairing [Sil09, §VIII.1])**.** The Kummer pairing is the map
$$\kappa\colon E(\mathbb{Q}) \times \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}} \to E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$$
defined as follows. Let $P \in E(\mathbb{Q})$ and $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$. Choose $Q \in E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ with $2Q = P$, and set $\kappa(P, \sigma) := \sigma(Q) - Q$. That this lands in $E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$, and does not depend on Q, is Problem 41(1).

Proposition 33.2 (Infinite Galois theory [Mil22, Theorem 7.13])**.** *For a closed subgroup H of $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$, let $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}^H$ be its fixed field. The maps $H \mapsto \overline{\mathbb{Q}}^H$ and $F \mapsto \mathrm{Gal}_F$ are inverse bijections between the closed subgroups of $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$ and the extensions of $\mathbb{Q}$ inside $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$. The subgroup H is normal if and only if $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}^H$ is Galois over $\mathbb{Q}$, and then $\mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}^H/\mathbb{Q}) \cong \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}/H$ by restriction. In particular, $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}^{\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}} = \mathbb{Q}$.*

Definition 33.3 (Cohomology in degree 1 [Sil09, §§B.1–B.2])**.** Let A be a discrete $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$-module. A 1-cocycle is a continuous map $\xi\colon \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}} \to A$, $\sigma \mapsto \xi_\sigma$, with $\xi_{\sigma\tau} = \xi_\sigma + \sigma\xi_\tau$ for all σ, τ. For $a \in A$, the map $\sigma \mapsto \sigma a - a$ is a 1-cocycle, and the 1-cocycles of this form are the 1-coboundaries. Then $H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, A)$ is the group of 1-cocycles modulo the 1-coboundaries. For an elliptic curve or its 2-torsion, we abuse notation and write $H^1(\mathbb{Q}, E[2]) := H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}))$.

Proposition 33.4 (The long exact sequence [Sil09, Propositions B.1.2 and B.2.3])**.** *Let $0 \to A \to B \xrightarrow{\psi} C \to 0$ be an exact sequence of discrete $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$-modules. For $c \in C^{\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}}$, choose $b \in B$ with $\psi(b) = c$, and let $\delta(c) \in H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, A)$ be the class of $\sigma \mapsto \sigma b - b$. This does not depend on b, and the sequence*
$$0 \to A^{\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}} \to B^{\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}} \to C^{\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}} \xrightarrow{\delta} H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, A) \to H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, B)$$
is exact.

Proposition 33.5 (Trivial action [Sil09, Remark B.2.2]). *If* $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$ *acts trivially on* A*, then*

$$H^1(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, A) = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{conts}}(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, A),$$

the group of continuous homomorphisms.

Problem 41 (The Kummer pairing).

(1) Show that $\kappa(P,\sigma) \in E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$, and that it does not depend on the choice of Q.

Solution.

(2) Let $P, P' \in E(\mathbb{Q})$ and $\sigma, \tau \in \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$. Show that $\kappa(P+P',\sigma) = \kappa(P,\sigma) + \kappa(P',\sigma)$ and

$$\kappa(P,\sigma\tau) = \kappa(P,\sigma) + \sigma\big(\kappa(P,\tau)\big).$$

Deduce that κ is bilinear. Where does the hypothesis $E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \subseteq E(\mathbb{Q})$ enter?

Solution.

(3) Show that $\kappa(P,\cdot) = O$ if and only if $P \in 2E(\mathbb{Q})$, and that $\kappa(\cdot,\sigma) = O$ if and only if $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_L$. Deduce that $L/\mathbb{Q}$ is Galois and that κ induces a perfect pairing

$$E(\mathbb{Q})/2 \times \mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q}) \to E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}),$$

that is, both $E(\mathbb{Q})/2 \to \mathrm{Hom}(\mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q}), E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}))$ and $\mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q}) \to \mathrm{Hom}(E(\mathbb{Q})/2, E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}))$ are injective. Conclude that $E(\mathbb{Q})/2$ is finite if and only if $L/\mathbb{Q}$ is finite.

Solution.

(4) Show that $0 \to E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \to E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \xrightarrow{2} E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}) \to 0$ is an exact sequence of discrete $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$-modules, and that its connecting map $\delta\colon E(\mathbb{Q}) \to H^1(\mathbb{Q}, E[2])$ sends P to the class of $\kappa(P,\cdot)$. Show that $H^1(\mathbb{Q}, E[2]) = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{conts}}(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}))$, and recover from Proposition 33.4 the injectivity of $E(\mathbb{Q})/2 \to \mathrm{Hom}(\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}, E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}}))$.

Solution.

34. Unramified outside S

This section is [Sil09, Proposition VIII.1.5], for $m = 2$ and $K = \mathbb{Q}$. Its argument is that of [Sil09, Proposition VII.4.1(a)], applied to the halves of rational points instead of torsion points. The last item adds Kummer theory, as in [Sil09, proof of Proposition VIII.1.6]. In this section p is a prime, and $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ is embedded in an algebraic closure $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$ of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, so that restriction is an injection $\mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}_p} := \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p/\mathbb{Q}_p) \hookrightarrow \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}}$. The residue field of the valuation ring of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$ is an algebraic closure $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$ of $\mathbb{F}_p$, and a bar denotes reduction modulo its maximal ideal.

Definition 34.1 (Inertia [Sil09, §VII.4]). An element $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}_p}$ preserves the valuation ring of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$, so it induces an automorphism $\bar{\sigma}$ of $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$. The inertia group $I_p \subseteq \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}_p}$ is the subgroup of the σ with $\bar{\sigma} = 1$. If ${\mathbb{Q}_p}^{\mathrm{unr}} \subseteq \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$ is the maximal unramified extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$, then $I_p = \mathrm{Gal}(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p/{\mathbb{Q}_p}^{\mathrm{unr}})$. A Galois extension F of $\mathbb{Q}$ inside $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ is unramified at p if $I_p \subseteq \mathrm{Gal}_F$, that is, if I_p fixes F.

Proposition 34.2 (Good reduction [Sil09, §III.1 and Remark VIII.1.3]). *The Weierstrass equation of* E *has discriminant*

$$\Delta = 16(e_1-e_2)^2(e_1-e_3)^2(e_2-e_3)^2.$$

If $p \nmid \Delta$*, the equation is minimal at* p *and its reduction* E_p *is an elliptic curve over* $\mathbb{F}_p$*.*

Proposition 34.3 (Reduction [Sil09, Proposition VII.2.1]). *Suppose that $p \nmid \Delta$. Every $Q \in E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p)$ has projective coordinates $[X : Y : Z]$ in the valuation ring of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p$, not all in its maximal ideal, and $\bar{Q} \coloneqq [\bar{X} : \bar{Y} : \bar{Z}] \in E_p(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p)$. The reduction map $E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p) \to E_p(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p)$, $Q \mapsto \bar{Q}$, is a homomorphism, and $\overline{\sigma(Q)} = \bar{\sigma}(\bar{Q})$ for $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}_{\mathbb{Q}_p}$.*

Proposition 34.4 (Kummer theory [Sil09, Exercise 8.4]). *Let F be a Galois extension of $\mathbb{Q}$ inside $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ with $\mathrm{Gal}(F/\mathbb{Q})$ abelian of exponent dividing 2. Let $D \subseteq \mathbb{Q}^\times/\mathbb{Q}^{\times 2}$ be the subgroup of the classes of the $d \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$ that are squares in F. Then $F = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d} : d \in D)$.*

Proposition 34.5 (Unramified quadratic extensions [Sil09, proof of Proposition VIII.1.6]). *Let p be an odd prime and $d \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$. Then $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$ is unramified at p if and only if $v_p(d)$ is even.*

Definition 34.6 (The group $\mathbb{Q}(S, 2)$ [Sil09, Theorem X.1.1(c)]). The subgroup $\mathbb{Q}(S, 2) \subseteq \mathbb{Q}^\times/\mathbb{Q}^{\times 2}$ consists of the classes of the $d \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$ with $v_p(d)$ even for every prime $p \notin S$. It is generated by the classes of -1 and of the primes in S, so it has order 2^{s+1}.

Problem 42 ($L/\mathbb{Q}$ is unramified outside S).

(1) Show that $\mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q})$ is abelian of exponent dividing 2. Let $D \subseteq \mathbb{Q}^\times/\mathbb{Q}^{\times 2}$ be the subgroup of the classes of the $d \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$ that are squares in L. Deduce that $L = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d} : d \in D)$.

Solution.

(2) Let $p \notin S$. Show that E has good reduction at p, and that O, T_1, T_2, T_3 reduce to four distinct points of $E_p(\mathbb{F}_p)$. Deduce that reduction is injective on $E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$.

Solution.

(3) Let $p \notin S$, $Q \in E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ with $2Q \in E(\mathbb{Q})$, and $\sigma \in I_p$. Show that $\sigma(Q) - Q$ reduces to $\bar{O}$, and deduce that $\sigma(Q) = Q$. Conclude that $L/\mathbb{Q}$ is unramified at p.

Solution.

(4) Show that $D \subseteq \mathbb{Q}(S, 2)$. Deduce that $\#\,\mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q}) \leqslant 2^{s+1}$ and $\#E(\mathbb{Q})/2E(\mathbb{Q}) \leqslant 4^{s+1}$.

Solution.

35. An example

This section runs Problem 42 on $y^2 = x^3 - x$, that is, $(e_1, e_2, e_3) = (0, 1, -1)$. The images of its points of order two under the explicit form of the Kummer map are [Sil09, Proposition X.1.4].

Problem 43 (The curve $y^2 = x^3 - x$).
In this problem, E is the curve $y^2 = x^3 - x$, with $T_1 = (0, 0)$, $T_2 = (1, 0)$ and $T_3 = (-1, 0)$. `Magma` finds its rank and its torsion subgroup, and checks that the halves of each T_i are defined over $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_8)$:

```
E := EllipticCurve([-1, 0]);
Rank(E);                          // 0 true
TorsionSubgroup(E);               // Z/2 + Z/2
K<z> := CyclotomicField(8);
EK := ChangeRing(E, K);
[#DivisionPoints(EK ! [e, 0], 2) : e in [0, 1, -1]];   // [ 4, 4, 4 ]
```

So $E(\mathbb{Q}) = E[2](\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$.

(1) Compute S and the bound of Problem 42(4).

Solution.

(2) For $i = 1, 2, 3$, find the four $Q \in E(\overline{\mathbb{Q}})$ with $2Q = T_i$, and show that $L = \mathbb{Q}(i, \sqrt{2}) = \mathbb{Q}(\zeta_8)$.[a]

Solution.

(3) Let $\sigma, \tau \in \mathrm{Gal}(L/\mathbb{Q})$ with $\sigma(i) = -i$, $\sigma(\sqrt{2}) = \sqrt{2}$, $\tau(i) = i$ and $\tau(\sqrt{2}) = -\sqrt{2}$. Compute $\kappa(T_i, \sigma)$ and $\kappa(T_i, \tau)$ for $i = 1, 2, 3$, and deduce that no T_i lies in $2E(\mathbb{Q})$. Compute $\#E(\mathbb{Q})/2E(\mathbb{Q})$ and compare it with the bound of (1).

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* for $Q = (x, y)$ with $y \neq 0$, the duplication formula on this curve reads $x(2Q) = (x^2 + 1)^2/(4y^2)$.

Part 11. Heights on abelian groups

The Mordell–Weil theorem has two steps. The weak Mordell–Weil theorem says that $E(K)/mE(K)$ is finite, and a height function turns this into finite generation [Sil09, §VIII.3]. The second step does not use the curve: it works for any abelian group with a height that is quadratic up to a bounded error. This worksheet is about such heights on an abstract abelian group: which functions are heights of which kind, what their $O(1)$ constants are, and how a quadratic height behaves. Problem 44 sets up the definitions and the first estimates. Problem 45, the heart of the worksheet, proves the descent theorem and shows, on $\mathbb{Q}$ and on a direct sum of copies of $\mathbb{Z}$, that its hypotheses are needed. Problem 46 is the algebra of quadratic heights.

Standing notation.

- An abelian group A, written additively, with elements P, Q, R, torsion subgroup A_{tors}, and, for an integer $m \geqslant 2$, the quotient $A/m \coloneqq A/mA$.
- For real functions f, g on a set X, the notation $f = g + O(1)$, meaning that $f - g$ is bounded on X. An inequality $f \leqslant g + c$ that holds for one constant c holds for every larger one, so the constants that bound heights are taken non-negative, and a lower bound is written $-c$ with $c \geqslant 0$.

36. Heights and the parallelogram law

This section is the vocabulary of [Sil09, §VIII.3], and the estimates [Sil09, Corollary VIII.6.4] that the heights on an elliptic curve satisfy, proved here for any height that satisfies the parallelogram law up to a bounded error [HS00, §B.4].

Definition 36.1 (Heights [Sil09, §§VIII.3, VIII.6])**.** A height on a set X is a function $h\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$. Two heights h, h' on X are equivalent, written $h = h' + O(1)$, if $h - h'$ is bounded on X. A height h has the Northcott property if $\{x \in X : h(x) \leqslant C\}$ is finite for every $C \in \mathbb{R}$. The defect of a height h on A is the function

$$\delta_h(P, Q) \coloneqq h(P + Q) + h(P - Q) - 2h(P) - 2h(Q)$$

on $A \times A$. The height h is quasi-quadratic if δ_h is bounded, and quadratic if $\delta_h = 0$ (the parallelogram law).

Problem 44 (Heights and the parallelogram law)**.**

(1) Show that equivalence of heights on a set X is an equivalence relation. Show that the Northcott property depends only on the equivalence class, and that a height with the Northcott property is bounded below. Give a height on $\mathbb{Z}$ that is bounded below and does not have the Northcott property.

Solution.

(2) Let h be a quasi-quadratic height on A, and let $c \geqslant 0$ be a constant with $|\delta_h| \leqslant c$. Show that $|h(0)| \leqslant c/2$, that $|h(-P) - h(P)| \leqslant 2c$, and that $|h(2P) - 4h(P)| \leqslant 3c/2$ for every $P \in A$.

Solution.

(3) Let h be a quasi-quadratic height on A, and let $c \geqslant 0$ be a constant with $|\delta_h| \leqslant c$. Show that for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ there is a constant $d_n \geqslant 0$ with $|h(nP) - n^2 h(P)| \leqslant d_n$ for all $P \in A$, and give a recursion for d_n in terms of c.[a] Suppose moreover that $h \geqslant -c'$ for a constant $c' \geqslant 0$. Show that for every $Q \in A$ there is a constant $C(Q) \geqslant 0$ with $h(P+Q) \leqslant 2h(P) + C(Q)$ for all $P \in A$, and give $C(Q)$ explicitly.

Solution.

(4) Let $f\colon A \to \mathbb{R}$ be a homomorphism. Show that the height f^2 on A is quadratic. Show that a sum of quadratic heights on A is quadratic.

Solution.

(5) Let $A = \mathbb{Z}^2$, $q(x,y) \coloneqq x^2 + y^2$ and $q'(x,y) \coloneqq x^2 + (x+y)^2$. Show that q and q' are quadratic heights with the Northcott property, that $q \leqslant 3q'$ and $q' \leqslant 3q$, and that they are not equivalent.

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* apply the parallelogram law to the pair (nP, P) and induct on $n \geqslant 0$.

37. The descent theorem

This section is [Sil09, Theorem VIII.3.1] and its proof, for an abstract abelian group, and the examples of groups that fail one of its hypotheses. The count of rational numbers of bounded height is [HS00, Theorem B.2.3].

Theorem 37.1 (Descent theorem [Sil09, Theorem VIII.3.1])**.** *Let h be a height on A with the following properties.*

(1) For every $Q \in A$ there is a constant $C_1(Q)$ with $h(P+Q) \leqslant 2h(P) + C_1(Q)$ for all $P \in A$.
(2) There are an integer $m \geqslant 2$ and a constant C_2 with $h(mP) \geqslant m^2 h(P) - C_2$ for all $P \in A$.
(3) The height h has the Northcott property.

If A/m is finite for the m of (2), then A is finitely generated.

Problem 45 (The descent theorem)**.**

(1) Let h be a quasi-quadratic height on A with the Northcott property. Show that h satisfies the hypotheses of Theorem 37.1 for every $m \geqslant 2$.

Solution.

(2) Let h be a height on A with the Northcott property, let $m \geqslant 2$ be an integer, and let $0 < a < b$ be real numbers. Suppose that for every $Q \in A$ there is a constant $C_1(Q) \geqslant 0$ with $h(P+Q) \leqslant a\,h(P) + C_1(Q)$ for all P, and that there is a constant $C_2 \geqslant 0$ with $h(mP) \geqslant$

$b\,h(P) - C_2$ for all P. Suppose also that A/m is finite, let $Q_1, \dots, Q_s$ represent its cosets, and let $C := \max_i C_1(-Q_i) + C_2$. Show that A is generated by $Q_1, \dots, Q_s$ and the finitely many $P \in A$ with $h(P) \leqslant 1 + C/(b-a)$.

Solution.

(3) Let $A = \mathbb{Q}$, as an additive group, with the logarithmic Weil height

$$h(u/w) := \log \max(|u|, |w|),$$

for u/w in lowest terms. Show that h has the Northcott property, that $h(x+y) \leqslant h(x) + h(y) + \log 2$, with equality for $x = y = 1$, that $h(mx) \leqslant h(x) + \log m$ and $\mathbb{Q}/m = 0$ for every integer $m \geqslant 2$. Which hypothesis of (2) fails, for every $m \geqslant 2$ and every $b > 1$? Is h quasi-quadratic?

Solution.

(4) Let $A = \bigoplus_{i \geqslant 1} \mathbb{Z}$, let $w_1, w_2, \dots$ be positive real numbers, and $h(x) := \sum_i w_i x_i^2$. Show that h is quadratic. For which weights w_i does h have the Northcott property? For such weights, which hypothesis of Theorem 37.1 fails for A?

Solution.

38. Quadratic heights and their pairing

This section is [HS00, Lemma B.5.2], the algebra of a height that satisfies the parallelogram law exactly, which [Sil09, Theorem VIII.9.3(c)] states for the canonical height on an elliptic curve.

Definition 38.1 (The pairing of a quadratic height [HS00, §B.5])**.** Let q be a quadratic height on A. Its pairing is

$$\langle P, Q \rangle_q := q(P+Q) - q(P) - q(Q).$$

Problem 46 (Quadratic heights and their pairing)**.**
Let q be a quadratic height on A.

(1) Show that $q(0) = 0$, $q(-P) = q(P)$ and $q(2P) = 4q(P)$, and that $\langle\ ,\ \rangle_q$ is symmetric and bilinear.[a] Deduce that $\langle P, P \rangle_q = 2q(P)$ and $q(nP) = n^2 q(P)$ for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Conversely, show that for a symmetric bilinear map $B\colon A \times A \to \mathbb{R}$, the function $P \mapsto \frac{1}{2}B(P,P)$ is a quadratic height with pairing B.

Solution.

(2) Let $T \in A_{\mathrm{tors}}$. Show that $q(T) = 0$, that $\langle P, T \rangle_q = 0$ for every $P \in A$, and that $q(P+T) = q(P)$. So q and its pairing factor through A/A_{tors}.

Solution.

(3) Let $A = \mathbb{Z}^r$ with standard basis $e_1, \dots, e_r$. Show that every quadratic height on A is $q(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^{\mathsf{T}}Gx$ for a unique real symmetric $r \times r$ matrix G, and that every symmetric G arises. Show that if G is positive definite, then q has the Northcott property.

Solution.

[a] *Hint:* write the parallelogram law for the pairs $(P+R, Q)$, $(P, R-Q)$, $(P+Q, R)$ and (R, Q).

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